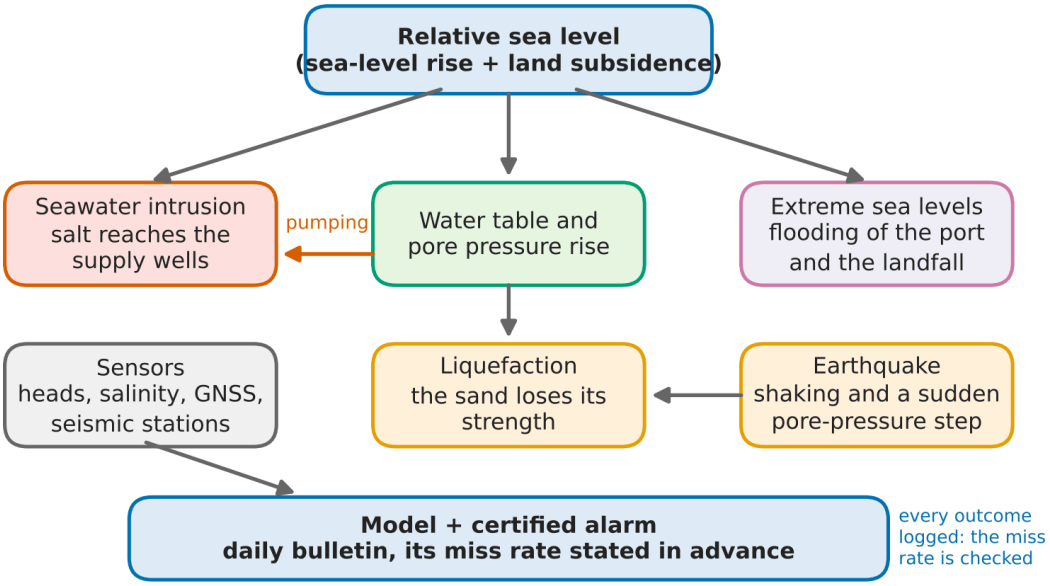
CERTAIN-COAST

Certified early warning to protect water, port and energy infrastructure on a sinking Adriatic coast

Additional files

State of the art · technical annex · three notes of the preparatory work · decisions in extreme events · the project at a glance · CVs of the two Project Directors



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INNOVATION What is new in each part

State of the art Part 1	Organised by the shared variables, not by hazard: the review follows relative sea level and the water table through the three hazards, and its gap matrix marks, in each empty cell, the CERTAIN-COAST innovation that fills it: warnings for the wellfields, the port and the energy landfall that come from one physical model, are issued fast enough to act on, and carry a stated, verifiable bound on how often they miss.
Decision map Part 2	Four dimensionless numbers, computed from the site records before any simulation, choose the method for random forcing, boundaries, initial state and propagation, so the workflow is fixed by data rather than by habit and each approximation comes with a stated error. The results are known; their use as one decision map for a coastal aquifer is the contribution.

Nine contributions Part 3	Nine new contributions, each derived and tested before the project: from guarantees for quantities nobody measures and the value of a sensor to a boundary that learns the aquifer beyond the model and which aquifer feels an earthquake (Table 3 of the annex).
ASSEMBLY-GO Part 4	The placement of the wells is stated first, and the adjoint of its constraint, the chloride at the supply screen, decides how the equations are assembled. On the test, the goal-graded assembly runs a 30-year forecast 2.5 times faster than the complete one and ranks the 25 layouts as it does (rank correlation 0.997).
BEYOND-GO Part 5	A boundary condition that learns what lies beyond the model. Every member of its class is a physical exterior and every linear exterior is a member, so the learned boundary cannot be unphysical, cannot destabilise the model and loses nothing in generality.
SHOCK-GO Part 6	Which aquifer feels the earthquake: the static step of a layer under the free surface follows its own shear modulus, centimetres in soft surface sand and up to a metre in a confined aquifer. Its relaxation, a free pumping test, identifies the leakage time 5.8 times more sharply than a year of seasonal heads.
Decisions in extremes Part 7	The decision is part of the assembled system: one set of equations carries the hazards, the certified warnings and the decisions of every operator, and a deep reinforcement learning agent recommends only decisions inside the certified safe window. When no decision is safe, a rule agreed before the season shows the trade-off between the hazards to the people who decide.
Work plan Part 8	A work plan built around evidence gates: each certified result is tested at a gate with a pass test and a fallback fixed in advance before the next work package relies on it, and the gates stand on the critical path. The figures are drawn from the tables of the form, so the two cannot disagree.

About these files

- Parts 1 and 2 set out the state of the art: what the 2020–2026 literature has done and has not done, and the method chosen for each mathematical question. The technical annex (Part 3) explains how the methods work, the preparatory tests, and the gates of the project with their fallbacks. Parts 4 to 6 give the equations, the proofs and the numerical checks behind it; every number in them is computed by the scripts of the preparatory work of the NPD's team. Part 7 states the decisions the operators must take in extreme events, writes the equations as one final assembled system and adds deep reinforcement learning kept inside the certified limits; each of Parts 1 to 6 opens with what it gives to that agent. Part 8 shows the work plan in five figures, and Parts 9 and 10 are the CVs of the two Project Directors.
- The equations of Parts 1 to 7 are set as native Word math. Equations set in red are new in this proposal, results of the preparatory work of the NPD's team; equations in black are standard. The names of the preparatory experiments are given in English (BEYOND-GO, SHOCK-GO, ASSEMBLY-GO, ...).
- Every figure is a result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project (MATLAB, also runs in the free GNU Octave) is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model: https://github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, archived on Zenodo with the DOI 10.5281/zenodo.24148762.

PART 1

State of the art: what has been done and what CERTAIN-COAST brings

What has been done (32 key papers, 2020–2026, Caltech, MIT, Harvard, Oxford), what has not been done, and what CERTAIN-COAST brings in mathematics and physics.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part

The gaps of this review are where a learning agent needs guarantees. CERTAIN-COAST trains a deep reinforcement learning agent on the assembled system of Part 7 and lets it recommend only decisions inside the certified safe window, so every recommendation carries the stated miss rates of the warnings.

CERTAIN-COAST — State of the Art

Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

What has been done (32 key papers, 2020–2026, Caltech, MIT, Harvard, Oxford), what has not been done, and what CERTAIN-COAST brings in mathematics and physics

1. The problem: three hazards, two shared variables, one lever

On a subsiding coast, seawater intrusion at the wellfields, liquefaction at the port and the energy landfall, and extreme sea levels at both are usually studied by different communities with different models. Physically they are one system, because they share two state variables:

- **Relative sea level** $R(t) = \eta(t) - u_z(t)$, the sea level η minus the vertical motion of the land u_z. It sets the seaward boundary of the aquifer, and therefore the position of the saline wedge (by the Ghyben–Herzberg relation the interface lies about 40 times deeper than the fresh head above sea level, so each centimetre of R raises it by up to about 40 cm), and it sets the base of every extreme water level at the port and the landfall.
- **Pore pressure and water-table depth** $z_w(x, t)$. It drives intrusion (the fresh head), compaction (the change in effective stress $\sigma' = \sigma - p$ compacts the clays and lowers the land) and liquefaction: in the simplified procedure the cyclic stress ratio $\mathrm{CSR} = 0.65\,(a_{\max}/g)(\sigma_v/\sigma'_v)r_d$ grows as the water table rises, so the factor of safety $\mathrm{FS} = \mathrm{CRR}/\mathrm{CSR}$ falls when the ground is wetter.

Pumping is the lever that moves all three at once, and in opposite directions. Lowering the water table thickens the unsaturated crust and reduces liquefaction susceptibility, but it draws the saline wedge inland and compacts the clays; the compaction lowers the land, raises $R(t)$, and so raises both the intrusion boundary and every extreme sea level. Sea-level rise works the other way round: it lifts the coastal water table, which brings liquefiable sand back into saturation. A warning system that treats one hazard at a time will recommend actions that worsen the others. This coupled chain is the object of CERTAIN-COAST.

The setting is concrete. The Adriatic coastal plain of Albania, a NATO member, combines wellfields in layered alluvium and the main port at Durrës, and the landfall of the Trans Adriatic gas pipeline near Fier, on soft deltaic and lagoonal sediments, with active thrust faults near Durrës (the 26 November 2019 Mw 6.4 earthquake caused liquefaction along this coast [L1]) and the Adriatic exposure to storm surges. Water supply, port logistics and energy supply are critical infrastructure; their joint exposure is a security question, not only an environmental one.

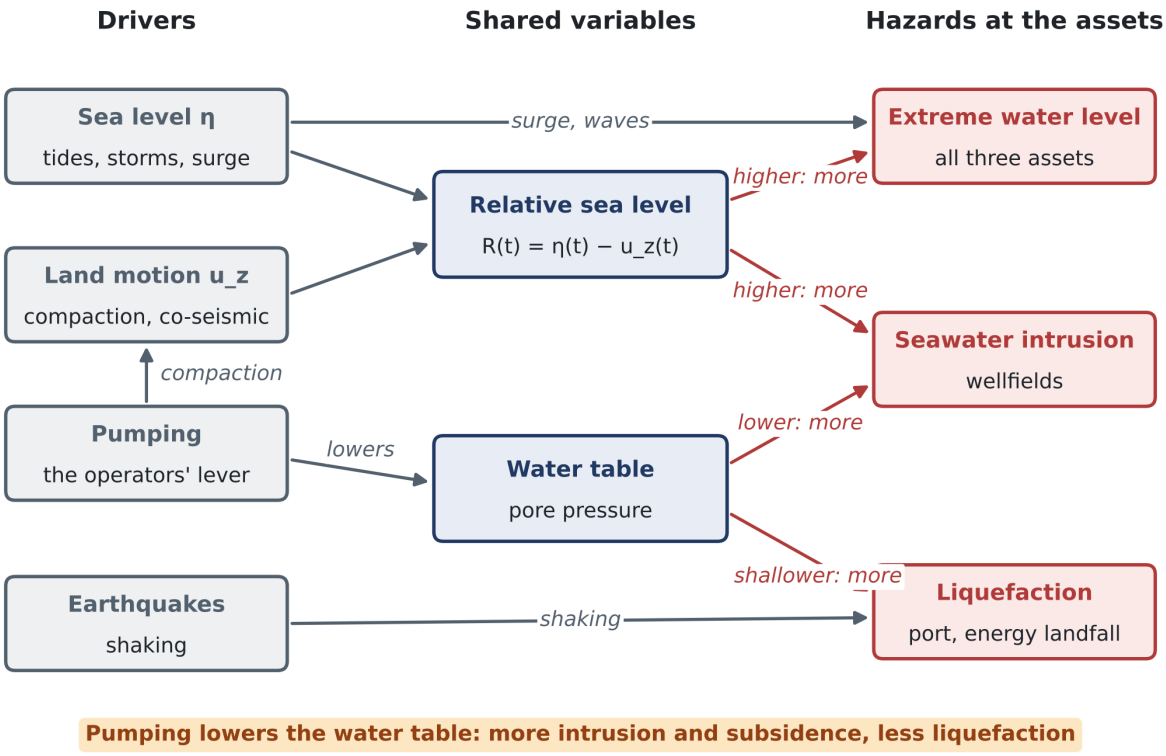


Figure 1. The coast as one system: four drivers act through two shared variables, relative sea level and the water table, on the three hazards at the three assets.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

2. State of the art

For seawater intrusion, CERTAIN-COAST builds on the preparatory work of the consortium, a coupled variable-density model with salt memory in clay layers, ion exchange, goal-oriented monitoring design and an extreme-aware alarm, and on the methods reviewed below.

2.1 Subsidence and relative sea level: the amplifier

Space geodesy now measures what pumping does to the land. Thirty years of InSAR in the Hollywood Basin, combined with pumping records, gave a sustainable yield of 1.44–1.67 million m³/yr, less than half the operating safe yield, without any water-level data [1]. In the Sacramento Valley the 2020–2022 drought caused an abrupt switch from reversible to irreversible compaction, decimetres per year above the elastic rate, that the well network alone did not reveal [2]. Groningen showed how elastic seasonal cycles and inelastic long-term compaction can be separated in geodetic data [3]. At the coast, land motion at tide gauges is not a constant trend: it changes with groundwater and hydrocarbon withdrawal and with earthquakes, and treating it as linear gives median projection errors of up to 7.6 mm/yr at seismic sites [4]. Probabilistic reconstructions now separate the causes of relative sea-level change since 1900 [5].

2.2 Extreme sea levels

Human-driven sea-level rise has already made the historical 1-in-100-year extreme a 1-in-8-year event at the median tide gauge, and the driver is mean relative sea level, not surge or tide [6]. Physics-based compound models of rainfall and surge show the same dominance of sea-level rise for a major port city [7]. For ports, a third of expected annual losses in Europe come from compound events, and ignoring hazard interactions underestimates them [8]; worldwide, flooding and earthquakes are the main threats to port assets and trade [9]. What is missing at the scale of one port is the step from a return period to an operational warning whose miss rate is guaranteed,

with measured, time-varying land motion inside it and with the earthquake and groundwater pathways coupled rather than added.

2.3 Liquefaction and the foundations of port and landfall

Liquefaction hazard is mapped statistically: a latent Gaussian process now gives spatially correlated maps of liquefaction manifestation conditioned on a regional proxy [10]. Fibre-optic sensing images shallow shear-wave velocity along 10 km of telecom cable and shows ground motion varying at sub-kilometre scale with soft sediments [11]. Borehole data show near-surface shear-wave velocity changing by about 25% in the top 6 m with the water table [12], the physical link between groundwater and liquefaction. For offshore and landfall foundations, the PISA programme produced validated 1-D design models in clay, sand and layered soils and a lifetime model of ratcheting under storms [13–15]; its one failing case, very soft clay over dense sand, is the typical deltaic sequence of the Adriatic coast [14]. After the 2019 Durrës earthquake, liquefaction was mapped at lagoons, estuaries and the southern Durrës coast [L1].

2.4 Continuous sensing of groundwater and soil

Ambient seismic noise tracks groundwater: space-time maps of velocity change near Los Angeles follow well water tables and InSAR deformation over 2000–2020 [16]. Telecom fibre resolves recharge pulses and a drought loss of about 0.25 m/yr of water in the unsaturated zone [17]. Twenty years of velocity changes at about 700 stations separate wet winters, droughts and decade-long postseismic signals [18]. These sensors are cheap, continuous and depth-resolved.

2.5 The mathematics of certified warning

Distribution-free methods now control more than coverage: conformal risk control bounds the expected value of any monotone loss, such as a false-negative rate, at a chosen level α [19]. Online conformal methods keep long-run coverage for arbitrary, even adversarial, sequences [20], and discounted adaptive learning forgets the past at the right speed under nonstationarity [21]; adaptive conformal sets have been embedded in control loops [22]. For physics surrogates, a risk-controlling quantile neural operator gives a finite-sample guarantee on the fraction of the domain outside its band [23], and conformal Bayesian computation gives frequentist coverage even for misspecified models [24]. On the modelling side, neural operators approximate solution operators of PDEs universally [25], Gaussian-process solvers treat nonlinear PDEs and inverse problems with convergence guarantees [26], optimal uncertainty quantification gives worst-case risk as the radius of a minimum enclosing ball [27], ensemble Kalman methods have a mean-field theory [28], dimension reduction can be certified by a computable bound [29], and optimal experimental design has a unified theory [30].

2.6 Causal structure and causal effects

Which variable drives which can itself be learned. Observational data identify a causal graph only up to a Markov equivalence class; interventions split that class, choosing the interventions is a problem of experimental design, and that design with hidden confounders, together with feedback loops, is named as open [31]. When the outcome is not measured but predicted from other measurements, a treatment effect computed on the predictions is valid if the predictor is conditionally calibrated with respect to the treatment and the adjustment set; a constraint on the learned representation transfers this validity from a similar annotated experiment, although it cannot be verified on the target without labels [32].

3. What has not been done

The table sets out, for each component, what the literature has achieved, what it has not, and the step CERTAIN-COAST takes.

Component	Done (papers)	Not done	CERTAIN-COAST
Seawater intrusion at the wellfields	Variable-density models, management optimisation and monitoring design exist; the preparatory work of this proposal adds a coupled model, a goal-oriented design and an extreme-aware alarm	No intrusion warning with a guaranteed miss rate; subsidence and earthquakes absent from the seaward boundary; no pumping test designed for the decision it informs	**Certified intrusion alarm** on the coupled model, with the relative-sea-level boundary $R(t)$; **safe pumping tests** chosen for the years they add (M6)
Land subsidence and vertical land motion	Measured from InSAR/GNSS; sustainable pumping set from 30 years of InSAR; abrupt switch to irreversible compaction detected [1–3]; land motion at tide gauges shown to vary in time with fluid withdrawal and earthquakes [4]	Measured subsidence is not used as a time-varying boundary condition in intrusion, flooding and liquefaction models at the same site	**One relative sea level** $R(t) = \eta(t) - u_z(t)$ **from InSAR/GNSS drives all three hazard models**
Extreme sea levels	Probabilistic sea-level reconstructions with causes and land motion [5]; extremes attributed to relative sea-level rise [6]; physics-based compound flooding [7]; compound and multi-hazard risk to ports [8, 9]	Land motion enters local extremes as a straight-line trend; port risk is expected annual damage, not a warning; earthquake and flood pathways added, not coupled	**Nonstationary extremes with InSAR land motion as covariate**, calibrated by conformal risk control
Liquefaction	Spatially correlated, data-driven liquefaction maps [10]; sub-kilometre site effects imaged by fibre [11]; water table shown to control near-surface stiffness [12]; Durrës 2019 liquefaction mapped [L1]	Susceptibility is static and scenario-based; the water table, which pumping and the sea move, is fixed	**Factor of safety FS(t) driven by the modelled, time-varying water table**, updated by seismic sensing
Port and landfall foundations	Validated 1-D design models for piles in clay, sand and layered soils, and lifetime ratcheting under storms [13–15]	No seismic shaking, pore-pressure build-up, liquefaction or subsidence; no monitoring or warning	**Stability check of the landfall combining shaking, liquefaction, scour-free water level and subsidence**
Groundwater sensing	Groundwater levels mapped from ambient seismic noise [16]; soil moisture from telecom fibre [17]; droughts, floods and earthquakes separated in 20 years of dv/v [18]	Never used to warn of intrusion or liquefaction; not part of any sensor-design problem	**dv/v and fibre as observation types** in a goal-oriented design and as liquefaction-susceptibility sensors
Certified uncertainty and alarms	Distribution-free risk control [19]; online and adaptive conformal prediction with long-run guarantees [20–22]; conformal coverage for neural-operator surrogates [23]; conformal Bayes [24]	Guarantees assume exchangeable data or hold only on time average; never applied to slow physics models of coastal hazards; the first method for levels beyond the record (extreme conformal prediction, 2026) not yet used for them	**Certified multi-hazard alarm**: surrogate error bound + online conformal margin + extreme-value extension beyond the record
Causes of the salinity (pumping, drought, source)	Causal graphs learned from data up to equivalence classes that interventions refine [31]; valid treatment effects from predicted outcomes, transferred between similar experiments [32]; hidden confounders inferred from treatment histories [X5]	Not applied to an aquifer; interventions not chosen for a warning; calibration of predicted outcomes not tested on the target without labels	**Physics-fixed causal graph, safe pumping tests as interventions, and pumping effects from predicted chloride tested on laboratory samples** (M6, M8)

Component	Done (papers)	Not done	CERTAIN-COAST
Fast models and assimilation	Neural operators with universal approximation [25]; kernel/GP solvers for nonlinear PDEs [26]; optimal UQ by minimum enclosing ball [27]; ensemble Kalman theory [28]; certified dimension reduction [29]; experimental design review [30]	Approximation guarantees, not per-forecast certificates, for coupled variable-density and poroelastic models	**Error-certified surrogate of the coupled model**, with sensors chosen jointly for the three warnings

Three gaps cut across the table. First, **no early warning treats the three hazards as one system**, although they share relative sea level and pore pressure and are moved by the same pumping lever. Second, **no warning for any of them carries a guarantee**: the certified methods of [19–24] assume exchangeable data or hold on time average, none has been applied to a slow physics model of a coastal hazard, and the first method that reaches levels beyond the observed record (extreme conformal prediction, 2026; Methodology, Section 5.3) has not been used for them. Third, **the new sensors (InSAR time series, seismic noise, fibre) are measured but not designed**: no study chooses them jointly with wells and chemical samples to minimise the miss probability of the warnings, and our search found no pumping-test design chosen for the decision it informs, and no causal graph of a coastal aquifer learned from the pumping it already carries out.



Figure 2. Gap matrix: what the 2020–2026 literature has done for each component, and the CERTAIN-COAST innovation that closes each gap (codes as in Section 4). Assessment from the papers in Section 5 and the table above.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

4. What CERTAIN-COAST brings

Mathematical innovations

• **M1. Certified multi-hazard alarm.** For each hazard k (intrusion at a wellfield, liquefaction at the port or landfall, extreme water level) the alarm fires when the forecast indicator exceeds its threshold minus a margin m_k. The margin adds three parts: the a-posteriori error bound of the fast surrogate [23, 27], an online conformal term that keeps the long-run miss rate at α_k under nonstationarity [19–21], and an extreme-value extension for events rarer than the observed

record, stress-tested on storylines (Methodology, Section 5.3). In our preparatory synthetic tests on a coupled variable-density model, an extreme-aware margin kept the share of seasons above the chloride limit at 4–9% across drought, human-feedback and compound storylines, where a static alarm allowed 13–21%.

• **M2. A joint guarantee across hazards.** Because the three alarms share inputs, their miss events are dependent; CERTAIN-COAST controls the probability that any of them is missed (at most $\sum_k \alpha_k$ by a union bound, tightened by joint calibration) and allocates the α_k by consequence, so that a water-supply alarm and a landfall alarm are not held to the same tolerance by accident.

• **M3. Multi-hazard goal-oriented sensor design.** InSAR, GNSS, piezometers, chloride samples, seismic noise, fibre and temporary nodes are chosen together to maximise the expected reduction in the miss probability of the three alarms, extending goal-oriented design [30] from one quantity and one sensor type to several hazards and sensor types. Each sensor is also valued by the years of safe operation it adds before the certified safe window of P3 closes: in a synthetic test, a GNSS station and corner reflectors added 5–6 years although they narrow none of today's forecasts (Methodology, Section 7.4). A sensor is valued by the guaranteed band it removes, recalibrated with the choice, not by the spread an ensemble promises: in a synthetic test a tide gauge that the ensemble said would narrow the recharge band by 15% widened the guaranteed band by 16–21%.

• **M4. An error-certified surrogate of the coupled model.** A neural or kernel operator of the coupled variable-density, poroelastic model [25, 26], whose error is bounded a posteriori and calibrated conformally [23], makes thousands of storylines and real-time updates affordable without losing the guarantee. For long storylines a generative copy of the model [X4] is used to explore and to choose the full runs; in a synthetic test its statistics alone put the closing year 2–8 years after the true one, so closing years are certified from full runs (Methodology, Section 4.2).

• **M5. Nonstationary extremes with measured land motion.** Extreme water levels are modelled with InSAR/GNSS land motion as a time-varying covariate of the location parameter, instead of a linear trend [4, 5].

• **M6. Safe pumping tests chosen for the years they add.** Routine operation keeps the water table in a narrow band, so the records never show how chloride responds near the onset of intrusion, and that response sets the certified boundary of the safe window of P3. Short pumping and dewatering tests approach the onset under a chloride safety filter and are chosen for the years they add to the certified closing year, extending active identification of nonlinear systems with guarantees [X3] from the accuracy of all parameters to one decision. In a second synthetic test they raised the certified closing year from 10.8 to 31.9 years (true value 45) with chloride below 123 mg/L in 95% of runs, while unconstrained tests chosen for parameter accuracy passed 250 mg/L in 42% of runs (Methodology, Sections 6 and 7.6).

• **M7. Guarantees for the inputs and boundaries nobody measures.** The recharge coefficient, the vadose delay, the sea-level and inland boundaries and the dispersion width are known only through rain and heads. CERTAIN-COAST calibrates their bands on simulated aquifers that carry the errors of the rain product and on measured anchor periods, so the guarantee holds when the simulator or the rain product is wrong; it matches the calibration to the forecast horizon under drift and computes a floor below which no valid band can go, extending conformal risk control [19–21] from observed outcomes to quantities never observed. In preparatory tests the raw ensemble missed 17–20% of the weeks where the calibrated bands met their 10% target; at least 9 anchors gave an average guarantee, and the bands held up to 20 years ahead under drift.

• **M8. Pumping effects and counterfactual salinity free of hidden drought demand.** Pumping responds to the same dryness that lowers the recharge, so its effect on salinity is confounded by a demand nobody records. Substitutes built from the history of the treatments [X5] cannot see the weekly news of such a confounder. CERTAIN-COAST reads the recharge, the path of every hidden cause, from the heads after adding back the measured drawdown, rejects any substitute that fails a calibrated physics check, and computes the salinity under a drier recharge regime with guaranteed bands. In preparatory tests the bias of the summed well effects was 0.59 without adjustment, 0.56 with a history substitute and 0.00 with the heads; on the calibrated Fushë-Kuqe chloride model, 40% less recharge grew the shallow area above 250 mg/L from 31 to 65 km² (band 15–49 km²). The causal graph behind these effects is fixed by physics except for the edges that change a warning, such as which source feeds the chloride and whether a leaky layer connects the sea; the safe pumping tests of M6 are interventions with known targets and each earthquake one with unknown targets, so together they split the equivalent graphs of [31] where the warning needs it. Between laboratory samples the chloride is predicted from the loggers, and an effect is computed on those predictions only after the predictor passes a conditional-calibration test with respect to the pumping and the recharge read from the heads [32], checked on the laboratory samples of each wellfield.

• **M9. A monitoring network that corrects its own sensors.** Unvented piezometers read the air pressure through their barometric efficiency, and the loggers of one hub drift together. Robust designs guard against such correlated errors [X6] but never remove them, while records are corrected one by one with a nearby barometer [X7]. CERTAIN-COAST makes a barometer and a sealed reference channel on each logger hub design candidates beside the piezometers, removes the correctable interference by marginalisation, chooses the network against the worst plausible sensor error and certifies its distance from the best network. In a preparatory test with 12 sensors the worst-case information rose by 52% against the classical design, with a certified gap of 18%, and the correction restored the coverage of 90% forecast intervals from 49–62% to 88–93%.

• **M10. Warnings for what happens between samples.** Laboratory samples arrive every few weeks or months, so a warning issued only at the sampling dates misses the crossings between them. Neural jump ODEs learn the online forecast from irregular, incomplete records [X8], and robust finance bounds a path-dependent price over all models that fit the observed prices [X9]. CERTAIN-COAST reports the probability that chloride crosses its limit at any time in the season as a band over all models consistent with the records, widens it by a conformal margin calibrated on simulated aquifers and anchor periods, and adds the observation that closes the band (a logger, or samples paired a few days apart). In a preparatory test a crossing within the season was 34 times likelier than an exceedance on a sampling date (0.78 against 0.023); quarterly samples left the band at 0.18–1 and a daily logger at 0.76–0.80, and for skewed chloride the margin restored a coverage of 90.3% (74% without).

Physical innovations

• **P1. One relative-sea-level boundary for all three hazards**, $R(t) = \eta(t) - u_z(t)$, with u_z from InSAR/GNSS after removal of loading signals [1–5].

• **P2. A time-varying liquefaction factor of safety**, $\mathrm{FS}(x, t) = \mathrm{CRR/CSR}(z_w(x, t))$, with the water table z_w taken from the calibrated groundwater model and checked by seismic velocity [12, 16–18], instead of a fixed design water table.

• **P3. A certified safe operating window and the year it closes.** Pumping raises intrusion and subsidence but lowers liquefaction susceptibility, so CERTAIN-COAST computes the set of pumping and dewatering decisions that keeps all hazards within certified limits at once, and the sea level and year at which this set closes, a multi-hazard adaptation tipping point. Warnings then recommend actions that do not shift the risk from one asset to another. In a synthetic test

the certified window closed after 38 years, while plans that watch one hazard believed they had 43–97 years (Methodology, Section 7).

- **P4. The compaction tipping point as a warning in itself**: the switch from elastic to inelastic compaction [2, 3] is irreversible and permanently raises $R(t)$; detecting it early is a warning for all three hazards.
- **P5. Seismic velocity as a pore-pressure sensor in saturated coastal sediments** at the port and the landfall, transferring [11, 16–18] from dry or inland basins to the coastal setting where it matters for liquefaction.

Decision innovation

- **V1. A certified value of the warning for each user.** The cost-loss model gives the relative economic value of a forecast for a user who can protect at cost C against a loss L [X1, X2], but only after the fact, from verification data. Because CERTAIN-COAST certifies the miss rate of each alarm, the relative value has a guaranteed lower bound, known before live operation for every cost-loss ratio; it is reported for each operator's own decision (Impact).

Together these give what no study has delivered: warnings for the wellfields, the port and the energy landfall that come from one physical model, are issued fast enough to act on, and carry a stated, verifiable bound on how often they miss.

5. The 32 key papers (2020–2026)

Caltech 12, MIT 9, Harvard 5, Oxford 6. For each: where to download it, what it did, and the step CERTAIN-COAST takes beyond it. [L1] is a local study, not from the four universities.

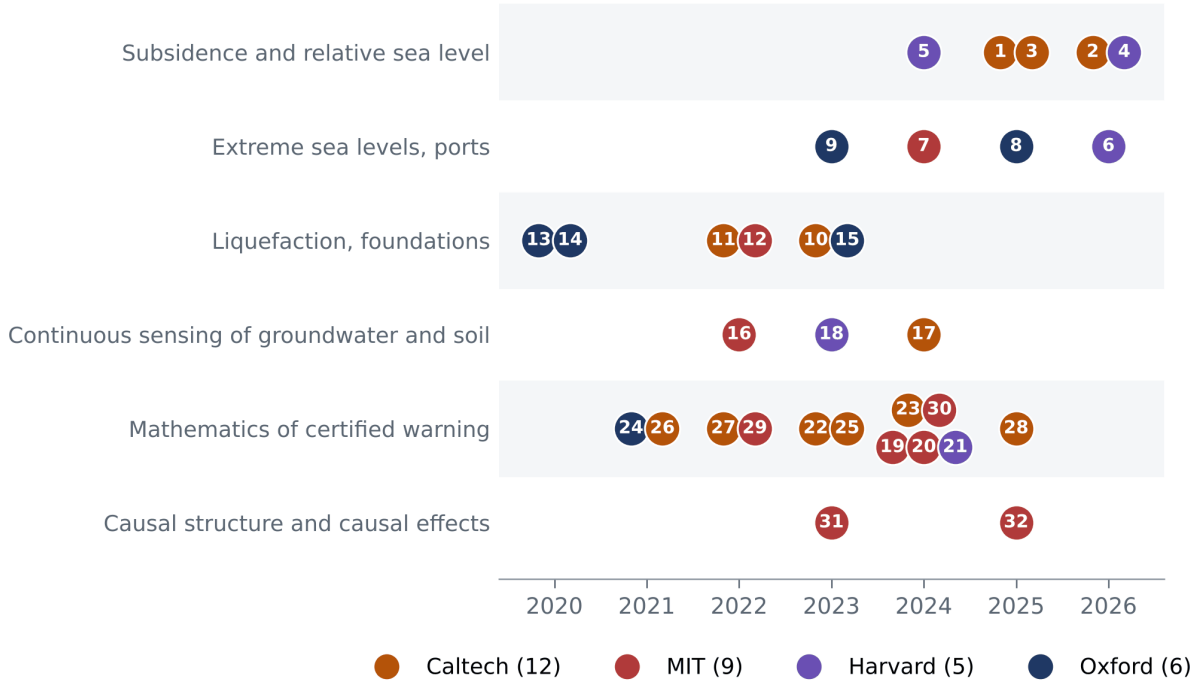


Figure 3. The 32 key papers by topic and year; colour: university (number of papers). Numbers are the reference numbers used throughout the proposal.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

A. Subsidence and relative sea level

[1] Zheng, Y. and Simons, M. (2025). Integrating long-term InSAR monitoring into local groundwater management: insights from the Hollywood Basin, California. Water Resources Research 61(11), e2024WR039161.

Caltech doi.org/10.1029/2024WR039161 | free: ESS Open Archive

Done: About 30 years of InSAR with pumping records give a sustainable yield of 1.44–1.67 million m³/yr against an operating safe yield of 3.70 million m³/yr; ICA separates deep and shallow aquifer signals without water-level data.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The sustainable yield becomes one constraint among three: CERTAIN-COAST sets pumping so that subsidence, intrusion and liquefaction alarms stay within their certified miss rates together.

[2] Larochelle, S., Chanard, K., Dalaison, M., Fortin, J., et al., including Avouac, J.-P. (2026). Abrupt transition to irreversible damage in the overdrafted Sacramento Valley aquifer system. PNAS 123(31), e2526041123.

Caltech doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2526041123 | free: CaltechAUTHORS record

Done: InSAR, GNSS and wells (2016–2022) show an abrupt switch to irreversible compaction during the 2020–2022 drought, decimetres per year above the elastic rate; space geodesy proposed as early warning.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The switch is turned into a formal alarm (P4) and its consequence, a permanent rise of relative sea level, is propagated into the intrusion and flooding warnings.

[3] Li, Y., Acosta, M., Sirorattanakul, K., Bourne, S. and Avouac, J.-P. (2025). Geodetic monitoring of elastic and inelastic deformation in compacting reservoirs due to subsurface operations. Journal of Geophysical Research: Solid Earth 130(3), e2024JB030794.

Caltech doi.org/10.1029/2024JB030794 | free: CaltechAUTHORS record

Done: Over Groningen and Norg (2009–2022), inelastic compaction reaches about 20% of the total at Groningen, while a 20 mm seasonal storage cycle at Norg is purely elastic.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The elastic/inelastic split is applied to a coastal wellfield, where seasonal pumping should leave an elastic cycle; its loss is the early sign of the tipping point.

[4] Dangendorf, S., Oelsmann, J., Mitrovica, J.X., Törnqvist, T.E., Piecuch, C.G., Creel, R., Coronel, W., Thompson, P.R., Ebinger, C. and Wahl, T. (2026). Variable contributions of vertical land motion to sea-level change inferred at tide gauges. Nature Geoscience 19, 814–821.

Harvard doi.org/10.1038/s41561-026-02005-1 | *paywalled; free copy due at par.nsf.gov in June 2027*

Done: Vertical land motion at tide gauges changes its rate with fluid withdrawal and earthquakes; treating it as linear gives median projection errors up to 7.6 mm/yr at seismic sites. Venice is among the cases.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Land motion enters as a measured, time-varying input (P1, M5), at the scale of a port, instead of a linear trend at a tide gauge.

[5] Dangendorf, S., Sun, Q., Wahl, T., Thompson, P., Mitrovica, J.X. and Hamlington, B. (2024). Probabilistic reconstruction of sea-level changes and their causes since 1900. Earth System Science Data 16, 3471–3494.

Harvard doi.org/10.5194/essd-16-3471-2024 | free: open access

Done: Near-global probabilistic reconstruction of relative sea level and its causes, 1900–2021; global mean rise 1.5 ± 0.19 mm/yr, consistent with observations only once local land motion is included.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Its regional climate component supplies $\eta(t)$ with uncertainty; CERTAIN-COAST adds the local $u_z(t)$ from InSAR to obtain $R(t)$ at the assets.

B. Extreme sea levels, compound flooding and ports

[6] Dangendorf, S., Sun, Q., Maduwantha, P., Wahl, T., Marcos, M., Marzeion, B., Slangen, A.B.A. and Mitrovica, J.X. (2026). Human-driven sea-level rise has quadrupled the frequency of coastal sea-level extremes since 1900. Nature Climate Change 16(7), 796–803.

Harvard (Mitrovica) doi.org/10.1038/s41558-026-02659-0 | free: MARUM repository record

Done: Long tide-gauge records with climate-model attribution (1900–2005): the median historical 1-in-100-year extreme is now about a 1-in-8-year event; human forcing alone made such events about four times more likely; the driver is mean relative sea level, not surge or tide.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Since the driver is relative sea level, a subsiding coast moves its extremes faster than the global attribution shows; CERTAIN-COAST puts the measured land motion into the local extreme-value model (M5).

[7] Sarhadi, A., Rousseau-Rizzi, R., Mandli, K., Neal, J., Wiper, M.P., Feldmann, M. and Emanuel, K. (2024). Climate change contributions to increasing compound flooding risk in New York City. Bulletin of the American Meteorological Society 105(2), E337–E356.

MIT (Emanuel) doi.org/10.1175/BAMS-D-23-0177.1 | free: DSpace@MIT (open access)

Done: Physics-based coupled rainfall and surge models driven by synthetic tropical and extratropical cyclones: a Sandy-scale compound flood (about 1-in-150 years now) becomes about 1-in-60 by mid-century and 1-in-30 by 2100; sea-level rise alone raises the hazard more than changes in storms.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The same physics-based compound approach, with Adriatic storms instead of tropical cyclones, plus the two terms it lacks for a subsiding coast: land motion and the groundwater rise that the surge pushes inland.

[8] Fernandez-Perez, A., Verschuur, J., Lara, J.L., Losada, I.J. and Hall, J.W. (2025). Compound climate risks to European ports. Environmental Research: Climate 5(1), 015005.

Oxford (Hall) doi.org/10.1088/2752-5295/ae26bc | free: Oxford ORA (open access)

Done: A compound-event risk framework for 406 European ports: expected annual losses about €1.05 bn, more than one third from compound events; ignoring hazard interactions underestimates losses by about €100 M, more so for extreme events.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Hazard interactions matter at the continental scale; CERTAIN-COAST resolves them physically at one port, including the interactions this framework does not carry: subsidence, groundwater and liquefaction.

[9] Verschuur, J., Koks, E.E., Li, S. and Hall, J.W. (2023). Multi-hazard risk to global port infrastructure and resulting trade and logistics losses. Communications Earth & Environment 4, 5.

Oxford (Hall) doi.org/10.1038/s43247-022-00656-7 | free: open access (journal)

Done: An asset-level analysis of about 1,340 ports for cyclone wind, coastal, river and pluvial flooding and earthquakes: port-specific risk US$7.5bn per year, 58.663.1 bn of trade at risk per year.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Earthquakes and flooding are counted side by side but not coupled; CERTAIN-COAST couples them at the port through the water table and relative sea level, and turns expected annual damage into a warning.

C. Liquefaction and the foundations of port and landfall

[10] Bullock, Z., Zimmaro, P., Lavrentiadis, G., Wang, P., Ojomo, O., Asimaki, D., Rathje, E.M. and Stewart, J.P. (2023). A latent Gaussian process model for the spatial distribution of liquefaction manifestation. Earthquake Spectra 39(2), 1189–1213.

Caltech (Asimaki) doi.org/10.1177/87552930231163894 | free: eScholarship

Done: A latent Gaussian process adds spatial correlation to a geospatial liquefaction proxy fitted to observed liquefaction and generates random maps conditioned on the areal fraction that liquefied; developed for regional gas-system risk.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The statistical field is conditioned on physics: the water table from the groundwater model and the seismic velocity from fibre or noise, so susceptibility changes with the season, the pumping and the sea (P2).

[11] Yang, Y., Atterholt, J.W., Shen, Z., Muir, J.B., Williams, E.F. and Zhan, Z. (2022). Sub-kilometer correlation between near-surface structure and ground motion measured with distributed acoustic sensing. Geophysical Research Letters 49(1), e2021GL096503.

Caltech (Zhan) doi.org/10.1029/2021GL096503 | free: CaltechAUTHORS record

Done: About three months of traffic noise on a telecom fibre image shallow shear-wave velocity along about 10 km; aftershock shaking varies at sub-kilometre scale and is stronger in soft-sediment micro-basins.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The same fibre principle is moved to saturated port and landfall sediments and used continuously, so that site amplification and the water table are monitored together (P5).

[12] Qin, L., Steidl, J.H., Qiu, H., Nakata, N. and Ben-Zion, Y. (2022). Monitoring seasonal shear wave velocity changes in the top 6 m at Garner Valley in Southern California with borehole data. Geophysical Research Letters 49, e2022GL101189.

MIT (Nakata) doi.org/10.1029/2022GL101189 | free: OSTI record

Done: Borehole earthquake and cross-hole data show shear-wave velocity varying by about 25% in the top 6 m and about 10% at 2–5 m, following the water-table depth.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The measured link between water table and stiffness becomes the bridge from the groundwater model to the liquefaction factor of safety, and a check on it.

[13] Byrne, B.W., Houlsby, G.T., Burd, H.J., Gavin, K.G., Igoe, D.J.P., Jardine, R.J., et al. (2020). PISA design model for monopiles for offshore wind turbines: application to a stiff glacial clay till. Géotechnique 70(11), 1030–1047.

Oxford (Byrne, Houlsby, Burd, Martin) doi.org/10.1680/jgeot.18.P.255 | free: TU Delft portal

Done: A 1-D pile design model calibrated on 3-D finite-element analyses and field tests, matching 3-D results at a fraction of the cost within its calibration space.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: A fast, validated foundation model is the template; CERTAIN-COAST adds what it lacks for a landfall on a seismic, subsiding coast: shaking, pore-pressure build-up and a changing water level.

[14] Burd, H.J., Abadie, C.N., Byrne, B.W., Houlsby, G.T., Martin, C.M., McAdam, R.A., et al. (2020). Application of the PISA design model to monopiles embedded in layered soils. Géotechnique 70(11), 1067–1082.

Oxford doi.org/10.1680/jgeot.20.PISA.009 | free: Imperial Spiral

Done: Soil-reaction curves from uniform soils work for layered profiles, except some combinations of very soft clay and very dense sand.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The failing case is the deltaic and lagoonal sequence of the Adriatic coast; the landfall check of CERTAIN-COAST is built for it, with liquefaction of the sand layers included.

[15] Abadie, C.N., Beuckelaers, W.J.A.P., Byrne, B.W., Burd, H.J. and McAdam, R.A. (2023). Modeling lifetime performance of monopile foundations for offshore wind applications. Journal of Geotechnical and Geoenvironmental Engineering 149(8), 04023051.

Oxford doi.org/10.1061/JGGEFK.GTENG-9833 | free: Oxford ORA

Done: Couples the PISA model with a ratcheting model to predict permanent rotation over a short storm, a 35-hour storm and the full lifetime.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Storm loading is joined by the other two hazards of the landfall, seismic liquefaction and the rising relative sea level, in one assessment with stated uncertainty.

D. Continuous sensing of groundwater and soil

[16] Mao, S., Lecointre, A., van der Hilst, R.D. and Campillo, M. (2022). Space-time monitoring of groundwater fluctuations with passive seismic interferometry. Nature Communications 13, 4643.

MIT doi.org/10.1038/s41467-022-32194-3 | free: PubMed Central

Done: Ambient-noise velocity changes map groundwater fluctuations over 2000–2020 near Los Angeles, following well water tables and InSAR, with better time and depth resolution.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Seismic noise becomes a designed observation (M3) and a pore-pressure sensor at the port and landfall (P5), not only a hydrogeological map.

[17] Shen, Z., Yang, Y., Fu, X., Adams, K.H., Biondi, E. and Zhan, Z. (2024). Fiber-optic seismic sensing of vadose zone soil moisture dynamics. Nature Communications 15, 6432.

Caltech (Zhan, Fu) doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-50690-6 | free: open access

Done: Traffic noise on about 10 km of telecom fibre resolves recharge pulses and a drought loss of about 0.25 m/yr of water in the unsaturated zone over about 5 years.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Moved from an arid vadose zone to a shallow coastal water table, the fibre becomes a recharge and liquefaction-susceptibility sensor along the coast road.

[18] Clements, T. and Denolle, M.A. (2023). The seismic signature of California's earthquakes, droughts, and floods. Journal of Geophysical Research: Solid Earth 128(1), e2022JB025553.

Harvard doi.org/10.1029/2022JB025553 | free: EarthArXiv

Done: dv/v at about 700 stations (1999–2021) separates wet winters, multiyear droughts and decade-long postseismic signals; diffusivity is low in basins; site variations match subsidence and uplift.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The separation of hydrological and earthquake signals is what a coastal warning needs after the next earthquake, when the water table and the soil both change.

E. Mathematics of certified warning

[19] Angelopoulos, A.N., Bates, S., Fisch, A., Lei, L. and Schuster, T. (2024). Conformal risk control. International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2024).

MIT (Bates, Fisch) proceedings.iclr.cc/paper_files/paper/2024/hash/f3549ef9b5ff520a7e41ff3cc306ab2b-Abstract-Conference.html | free: arXiv

Done: Extends split conformal prediction to any monotone bounded loss: the calibrated threshold guarantees $\mathbb{E}[L(\hat{\lambda})] \leq \alpha$ under exchangeability, tight to $O(B/n)$; a false-negative (miss) rate is a special case.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The miss rate of each alarm is the controlled loss; CERTAIN-COAST removes the exchangeability assumption by the online and extreme-value terms of M1.

[20] Angelopoulos, A.N., Barber, R.F. and Bates, S. (2024). Online conformal prediction with decaying step sizes. Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning, PMLR 235, 1616–1630.

MIT (Bates) proceedings.mlr.press/v235/angelopoulos24a.html | free: arXiv

Done: Online quantile tracking with decaying steps keeps long-run coverage for arbitrary sequences and converges to the true quantile when the data are i.i.d.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Long-run coverage is not enough for rare, clustered extremes; it is combined with a margin that widens when forcing leaves the record.

[21] Zhang, Z., Bombara, D. and Yang, H. (2024). Discounted adaptive online learning: towards better regularization. Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning, PMLR 235, 58631–58661.

Harvard (Yang) proceedings.mlr.press/v235/zhang24e.html | free: arXiv

Done: An adaptive algorithm for discounted regret that forgets history gracefully in nonstationary environments; applied to online conformal prediction it gives instance-dependent coverage guarantees.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The forgetting rate is tied to physics: it is set by the memory time of the aquifer and the clays, not tuned on generic benchmarks.

[22] Dixit, A., Lindemann, L., Wei, S.X., Cleaveland, M., Pappas, G.J. and Burdick, J.W. (2023). Adaptive conformal prediction for motion planning among dynamic agents. Proceedings of the 5th Learning for Dynamics and Control Conference, PMLR 211, 300–314.

Caltech (Burdick) proceedings.mlr.press/v211/dixit23a.html | free: arXiv

Done: Online adaptive conformal sets for multistep-ahead predictions, without exchangeability, feed a model-predictive controller.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The same closed loop, prediction set to action, is built for pumping and port operations, with sets from a physics surrogate instead of a data-driven predictor.

[23] Ma, Z., Pitt, D., Azizzadenesheli, K. and Anandkumar, A. (2024). Calibrated uncertainty quantification for operator learning via conformal prediction. Transactions on Machine Learning Research, August 2024.

Caltech (Anandkumar) openreview.net/forum?id=cGpegxy12T | free: arXiv

Done: A risk-controlling quantile neural operator gives, with probability at least 1 − δ, an expected fraction of domain points outside the band of at most α; it alone reached the 98% target on a 3-D task.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The surrogate guarantee is the first of the three margin terms of M1; CERTAIN-COAST extends it from a fraction of the domain to the asset points where the alarms are issued.

[24] Fong, E. and Holmes, C. (2021). Conformal Bayesian computation. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 34 (NeurIPS 2021).

Oxford (Holmes) proceedings.neurips.cc/paper/2021/hash/97785e0500ad16c18574c64189ccf4b4-Abstract.html | free: proceedings PDF

Done: Full conformal prediction for Bayesian models from existing posterior samples, with finite-sample coverage even under misspecification; extends to hierarchical data.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The Bayesian calibration of the coupled model keeps its posterior, and conformal Bayes turns it into intervals with frequentist coverage; hierarchical data match several wells and sites.

[25] Kovachki, N., Li, Z., Liu, B., Azizzadenesheli, K., Bhattacharya, K., Stuart, A. and Anandkumar, A. (2023). Neural operator: learning maps between function spaces with applications to PDEs. Journal of Machine Learning Research 24(89), 1–97.

Caltech (Stuart, Anandkumar) www.jmlr.org/papers/v24/21-1524.html | free: arXiv

Done: Defines discretisation-invariant neural operators and proves universal approximation of continuous nonlinear operators.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The coupled variable-density, poroelastic model is learned as an operator from forcing to hazard indicators, with the a-posteriori certificate approximation theory does not give.

[26] Chen, Y., Hosseini, B., Owhadi, H. and Stuart, A.M. (2021). Solving and learning nonlinear PDEs with Gaussian processes. Journal of Computational Physics 447, 110668.

Caltech (Owhadi, Stuart) doi.org/10.1016/j.jcp.2021.110668 | free: arXiv

Done: Nonlinear PDEs solved as the MAP of a Gaussian process conditioned at collocation points, with Gauss–Newton in a few iterations and convergence guarantees; inverse problems solved jointly.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The kernel route gives the coupled model an alternative surrogate with built-in uncertainty, for the small, data-poor coastal domains where neural operators are hard to train.

[27] Hamze Bajgiran, H., Batlle, P., Owhadi, H., Samir, M., Scovel, C., Shirdel, M., Stanley, M. and Tavallali, P. (2022). Uncertainty quantification of the 4th kind; optimal posterior accuracy-uncertainty tradeoff with the minimum enclosing ball. Journal of Computational Physics 471, 111608. (DOI not confirmed.)

Caltech (Owhadi, Scovel) arxiv.org/abs/2108.10517 | free: CaltechAUTHORS PDF

Done: Combines robust optimisation, Bayesian inference and hypothesis testing: the optimal estimate and its worst-case risk are the centre and radius of the minimum enclosing ball of a likelihood region mapped to the quantity of interest.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The worst-case radius gives the storyline test of M1 a rigorous form: beyond the record, the extrapolated margin is checked against the enclosing-ball radius over the plausible forcing set.

[28] Calvello, E., Reich, S. and Stuart, A.M. (2025). Ensemble Kalman methods: a mean-field perspective. Acta Numerica 34, 123–291.

Caltech (Stuart) doi.org/10.1017/S0962492924000060 | free: arXiv

Done: A unifying analysis of ensemble Kalman methods for filtering, inversion and sampling as particle approximations of mean-field models, exact in the linear-Gaussian case.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Ensemble Kalman assimilation of heads, chloride, InSAR and dv/v updates the coupled state; its non-Gaussian error is absorbed by the conformal layer rather than ignored.

[29] Zahm, O., Cui, T., Law, K., Spantini, A. and Marzouk, Y. (2022). Certified dimension reduction in nonlinear Bayesian inverse problems. Mathematics of Computation 91(336), 1789–1835.

MIT (Marzouk) www.ams.org/journals/mcom/2022-91-336/S0025-5718-2022-03737-6/ | free: arXiv

Done: Approximates the likelihood by a ridge function chosen to minimise a computable upper bound on the KL divergence between exact and approximate posteriors, which certifies the approximation.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: The certified reduction makes calibration of the coupled model tractable and gives the error budget that enters the alarm margin.

[30] Huan, X., Jagalur, J. and Marzouk, Y. (2024). Optimal experimental design: formulations and computations. Acta Numerica 33, 715–840.

MIT (Marzouk) doi.org/10.1017/S0962492924000023 | *free version: check the authors' pages or arXiv*

Done: A unified review of optimal experimental design, Bayesian and goal-oriented criteria, and their computation.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Extended in M3 from one goal and one sensor type to the joint miss probability of three warnings and seven sensor types.

F. Causal structure and causal effects

[31] Squires, C. and Uhler, C. (2023). Causal structure learning: a combinatorial perspective. Foundations of Computational Mathematics 23(5), 1781–1815.

MIT (Uhler) doi.org/10.1007/s10208-022-09581-9 | free: open access (journal)

Done: Reviews how causal graphs are learned from data: the search space of directed acyclic graphs and of graphs with hidden variables, the Markov equivalence classes that observational data cannot split, how interventions refine them (interventional Markov equivalence), and the open problems of experimental design with hidden confounders and of feedback loops.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: In a coastal aquifer most of the graph is fixed by physics (sea level to boundary head to chloride; pumping to head to compaction to land motion to relative sea level). CERTAIN-COAST searches only the edges that change a warning, such as which source feeds the chloride, and chooses its safe pumping tests (M6) as interventions that split the remaining equivalent graphs, with each earthquake as a free intervention with unknown targets (Part 6); written in time, the feedback loops of the coupled system leave an acyclic graph.

[32] Cadei, R., Demirel, I., De Bartolomeis, P., Lindorfer, L., Cremer, S., Schmid, C. and Locatello, F. (2025). Prediction-powered causal inferences. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 38 (NeurIPS 2025), 82200–82229.

MIT (Demirel), ETH Zurich and ISTA doi.org/10.52202/085713-2479 | free: arXiv

Done: Treatment effects when the outcome is not annotated but predicted from complex measurements: conditional calibration of the predictor with respect to the treatment and the adjustment set gives identification and doubly robust estimation with valid intervals; a causal-lifting constraint on the representation, enforced by deconfounded empirical risk minimisation, transfers validity from a similar annotated experiment; on a real ecological experiment without target annotations it gave valid effects with every pre-trained model, where standard training failed and invariant training was sometimes invalid.

Beyond it in CERTAIN-COAST: Chloride is measured in the laboratory a few times a year and predicted between samples from loggers, heads and geophysics. CERTAIN-COAST computes the effect of pumping on salinity from those predictions only after the predictor passes a conditional-calibration test with respect to the pumping and the recharge read from the heads (M8), checked on the laboratory samples of the target wellfield, and removes the bias measured on them; the transfer between the wellfields of Durrës and Fushë-Kuqe becomes a tested condition instead of an assumption.

Local study (not from the four universities)

[L1] Mavroulis, S., Lekkas, E. and Carydis, P. (2021). Liquefaction phenomena induced by the 26 November 2019, Mw = 6.4 Durrës (Albania) earthquake and liquefaction susceptibility assessment in the affected area. Geosciences 11(5), 215. doi.org/10.3390/geosciences11050215

Other references cited (V1, M4, M6, M8, M9, M10)

[X1] Richardson, D. S. (2000). Skill and relative economic value of the ECMWF Ensemble Prediction System. Quarterly Journal of the Royal Meteorological Society 126, 649–667. www.ecmwf.int/en/elibrary/76153-skill-and-relative-economic-value-ecmwf-ensemble-prediction-system

[X2] Murphy, A. H. (1977). The value of climatological, categorical and probabilistic forecasts in the cost-loss ratio situation. Monthly Weather Review 105(7), 803.

[X3] Mania, H., Jordan, M. I. and Recht, B. (2022). Active learning for nonlinear system identification with guarantees. Journal of Machine Learning Research 23, 1–30. http://jmlr.org/papers/v23/20-807.html

[X4] Gao, H., Kaltenbach, S. and Koumoutsakos, P. (2024). Generative learning for forecasting the dynamics of high-dimensional complex systems. Nature Communications 15, 8904. doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-53165-w

[X5] Bica, I., Alaa, A. M. and van der Schaar, M. (2020). Time Series Deconfounder: estimating treatment effects over time in the presence of hidden confounders. Proceedings of the 37th International Conference on Machine Learning, PMLR 119. proceedings.mlr.press/v119/bica20a.html

[X6] Chowdhary, A., Attia, A. and Alexanderian, A. (2025). Robust optimal experimental design of infinite-dimensional Bayesian nonlinear inverse problems. arXiv:2409.09137. arxiv.org/abs/2409.09137

[X7] Rasmussen, T. C. and Crawford, L. A. (1997). Identifying and removing barometric pressure effects in confined and unconfined aquifers. Ground Water 35(3), 502–511. doi.org/10.1111/j.1745-6584.1997.tb00111.x

[X8] Krach, F., Nübel, M. and Teichmann, J. (2026). Optimal estimation of generic dynamics by path-dependent neural jump ODEs. Stochastic Processes and their Applications. doi.org/10.1016/j.spa.2026.105058

[X9] Gierjatowicz, P., Sabate-Vidales, M., Šiška, D., Szpruch, L. and Žurič, Ž. (2020). Robust pricing and hedging via neural SDEs. Working paper, SSRN 3646241. ssrn.com/abstract=3646241

Verification: each entry was checked against publisher, proceedings or institutional-repository records through web search; publisher sites could not be opened directly from this environment. Gaps are stated in the entry (the DOI of [27]). Some free links are repository records whose full text was not checked.

6. What is new in this review

• **Organised by the shared variables, not by hazard.** The review follows relative sea level and the water table through the three hazards (Figure 1), which is where the gaps appear.

• **Every gap is closed by a named innovation.** The gap matrix (Figure 2) marks what the literature has done and, in each empty cell, the CERTAIN-COAST innovation that fills it.

• **Every paper has a role.** Each of the 32 papers states what it did and the step CERTAIN-COAST takes beyond it; no paper is cited for decoration.

• **Open where possible.** Each entry gives a DOI and, where one exists, a free copy, so evaluators can check every claim.

• **Claims updated as the frontier moves.** Where a 2026 method now does what was a gap (extreme conformal prediction beyond the record), the review says so and states the remaining step.

PART 2

Mathematical state of the art: forcing, boundaries, initial state, propagation

Random forcing, boundaries, initial state and propagation of uncertainty in a stochastic coastal aquifer: what the literature answers, what remains open, and the four numbers that choose the method. Supplement to WP2 and WP3.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part

The laws of the random forcing and the decision map of this part fix the simulator on which the agent of Part 7 is trained: the rain, the sea and the earthquakes of its training episodes are drawn from them.

CERTAIN-COAST — Mathematical state of the art

Mathematical state of the art: random forcing, boundaries, initial state and propagation of uncertainty in a stochastic coastal aquifer

NATO SPS Multi-Year Project, call 2027-1. Supplement to the methods of WP2 and WP3. Equations are native Word math; references were checked in Crossref; Tables 2–4 are computed in closed form and checked numerically.

A model that issues warnings for a coastal aquifer must answer four mathematical questions before its probabilities can be trusted. Is the model, driven by random rain, sea level and pumping, well posed? How are the sea and the rivers represented when they are themselves uncertain? How much does the unknown initial state matter? And how are the probabilities of rare events computed at an affordable cost? This note summarises how the literature answers each question, with emphasis on 2023–2026, states what remains open, and gives the rule by which CERTAIN-COAST chooses a method for each question at Fushë-Kuqe (WP2, WP3). The numbers in Tables 2–4 come from closed-form results checked numerically; they are illustrative, not results at the site.

Table 1. The four questions, the mathematical tool that answers each, the number that decides the method, and the point that remains open.

Question	Mathematical tool	Deciding number	Open point
1. Random forcing	Pathwise and entropy solutions; shot-noise law of storm recharge	$\Pi = \lambda\tau$, storms per aquifer memory	Which law of the forcing to use
2. Boundaries	Conductance (Robin) condition with coloured noise; boundary corrections in the state vector	$\Gamma = CL/T$, boundary conductance number	Three-dimensional variable-density aquifer with a moving interface
3. Initial state	Modal memory; ensemble Kalman filter; 4D-Var; Bayesian inversion in function space	t/τ_1, record length over aquifer memory	Assimilation theory for non-additive, non-Gaussian forcing
4. Propagation	Multilevel Monte Carlo with smoothed indicators and surrogate control variates	$\beta - \gamma$, variance decay against cost growth	Rates for threshold probabilities of coupled models

1. The equations

The water table h of an unconfined coastal aquifer obeys the Boussinesq equation, and the unsaturated zone the Richards equation:

$$S_y \frac{\partial h}{\partial t} = \nabla \cdot (Kh \nabla h) + R(x,t) - Q(x,t) \tag{1}$$

$$\frac{\partial \theta(\psi)}{\partial t} = \nabla \cdot (K(\psi) \nabla(\psi + z)) + R(x,t) \tag{2}$$

Both are degenerate: the diffusion coefficient Kh vanishes where the aquifer runs dry, and $K(\psi)$ collapses in dry soil. With $u = h$ and $m = 2$, the Boussinesq equation is a porous-medium equation, and with random forcing it reads

$$du = \Delta(u^m)dt + \sigma(u)\, dW_t + R\, dt, \quad m > 1 \tag{3}$$

where W is a noise in time: white, with long memory, or rough. The sea enters at the coast and the rivers along their beds; the interface between fresh and salt water is a moving boundary.

2. Random forcing

2.1 Existence, uniqueness and stability

For noise that is additive or linear in u, the substitution $u = e^{\mu W_t} v$ turns the stochastic equation into a porous-medium equation with random coefficients, which can be solved path by path. Pathwise well-posedness is proved for stochastic porous-medium and fast-diffusion equations with conservative noise (Fehrman and Gess, 2019), and on bounded domains with Dirichlet data, where the solution depends continuously on the driving noise (Clini, 2023). For nonlinear noise that is correlated in space, stochastic kinetic solutions give well-posedness (Fehrman and Gess, 2024; Popat, 2025). For a given path of the forcing, the porous-medium operator is accretive in L^1, so two solutions driven by the same forcing contract (Vázquez, 2006):

$$\|u_1(t) - u_2(t)\|_{L^1} \le \|u_1(0) - u_2(0)\|_{L^1}, \tag{4}$$

Together with the continuity in the driving noise, this means that an error in the forcing has a controlled effect on the heads. For forcing rougher than Brownian motion, Wong–Zakai regularisation and splitting give fully discrete schemes with error bounds (He, 2023; Nie et al., 2025).

2.2 Heads that stay nonnegative

A finite-volume discretisation with two-point fluxes and implicit time steps gives an M-matrix, and the discrete maximum principle then keeps $h \ge 0$ in cells that dry out. For multiplicative noise, splitting the noise step from the diffusion step and solving the noise step exactly preserves positivity (Bréhier et al., 2024); finite-element schemes that keep the stochastic porous-medium equation nonnegative converge (Grillmeier and Grün, 2019), and convergent schemes now cover singular-degenerate stochastic equations that include it (Baňas et al., 2024).

2.3 The law of the forcing

What the theory does not decide is the law of the forcing. Rain falls as storms: at the scale of an aquifer, recharge is a marked Poisson process with storm rate λ and storm sizes Y_i of mean μ, written as the rise in head they cause. If the aquifer drains like a linear reservoir with response time τ, the head above its drainage level is shot noise:

$$h(t) = \sum_{t_i \le t} Y_i \, e^{-(t - t_i)/\tau} \tag{5}$$

For exponential storm sizes its stationary law is exactly a Gamma law, with shape $\Pi = \lambda\tau$, the number of storms within one aquifer memory, and scale μ (the Laplace transform of (5) is $(1 + s\mu)^{-\lambda\tau}$; the same law describes soil moisture in Rodriguez-Iturbe et al., 1999; for the water table, Laio et al., 2009):

$$h \sim \mathrm{Gamma}(\Pi, \mu), \quad \mathbb{E}[h] = \Pi\mu, \quad \mathrm{Var}[h] = \Pi\mu^2, \quad \mathrm{skewness} = 2/\sqrt{\Pi} \tag{6}$$

A Gaussian with the same mean and variance is exact only as $\Pi \to \infty$. Table 2 shows how far it is from the exact law in the tails that warnings use. The Gaussian underestimates high levels by an order of magnitude when few storms fall within one aquifer memory, and still by a factor of two at $\Pi = 100$; it overstates low levels, which matter for pumping limits. Means and variances are right at any Π; tails are not. A search of the 2023–2026 literature for this note found no study that compares the two laws in the tails of groundwater levels.

Table 2. Tail probabilities of the head under the exact Gamma law and under a Gaussian with the same mean and variance (sd: standard deviation).

Π = λτ	P[h > mean + 3 sd], exact	Gaussian	Ratio	P[h < mean − 2 sd], exact	Gaussian
1	1.83%	0.135%	13.6	0	2.28%
2	1.41%	0.135%	10.4	0	2.28%
10	0.67%	0.135%	5.0	0.46%	2.28%
100	0.28%	0.135%	2.0	1.71%	2.28%

3. Boundaries

3.1 The sea and the rivers as conductance boundaries

The sea at the coast and the rivers along their beds are written as a Robin (conductance) condition,

$$-T\frac{\partial h}{\partial n} = C(h - H_b(t)), \qquad H_b(t) = \bar{H} + \delta + \xi(t), \tag{7}$$

with transmissivity T, boundary conductance C, mean stage $\bar{H}$, an unknown datum correction δ and a fluctuation ξ. The problem is well posed for $C \geq 0$, because the bilinear form is coercive (Lax–Milgram), and the number $\Gamma = CL/T$ decides how the boundary acts: for $\Gamma \to \infty$ it is a fixed head, for $\Gamma \to 0$ a no-flow boundary. A stochastic porous-medium equation with Robin boundary conditions, gravity-driven infiltration and multiplicative noise is treated in Ciotir et al. (2025), and a rule for when boundary uncertainty must enter the estimation of aquifer properties is given in Peeters and Turnadge (2019). For a strip of length L with a conductance boundary at the coast and a divide inland, the slowest decay rate solves $k_1 L \tan(k_1 L) = \Gamma$, and the aquifer memory is $\tau_1 = S/(Tk_1^2)$. Table 3 shows that a sea or river boundary behaves as a fixed head within 2% only for $\Gamma \geq 100$.

Table 3. Memory of the aquifer with a conductance boundary, relative to a fixed head at the coast.

Γ = CL/T	k_1L	τ_1 relative to a fixed head
0.1	0.311	25.5
1	0.860	3.33
10	1.429	1.21
100	1.555	1.02
∞	π/2	1

White noise imposed directly as fixed-head data is too rough for classical solutions. The fluctuation of the sea is therefore taken as a coloured (Ornstein–Uhlenbeck) process, with correlation time τ_ξ and intensity σ_ξ estimated from the tide gauge:

$$d\xi = -\frac{\xi}{\tau_\xi}\,dt + \sigma_\xi\,dW_t \tag{8}$$

3.2 The interface between fresh and salt water

In the sharp-interface approximation, the depth of the interface below sea level is $\zeta = \rho_f h/(\rho_s - \rho_f) \approx 40\,h$ (Ghyben–Herzberg), and a single potential turns the regional interface problem into one equation over the whole aquifer (Strack, 1976). With random fluxes the interface is a stochastic free boundary of Stefan type. Such problems have local solutions after a transformation to a fixed domain (Müller, 2018), and maximal solutions up to stopping times (Antonopoulou et al., 2025); none of them yet covers a variable-density aquifer.

3.3 A wrong boundary is read as wrong recharge

Write the heads as $y = G_R r + G_B b + e$, with r the recharge and b the boundary data. If b is fixed with an error δb, the least-squares estimate of the recharge is shifted by

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{r}] - r = \left(G_R^\top G_R\right)^{-1} G_R^\top G_B\,\delta b, \tag{9}$$

so a boundary error is read as a recharge error; a related non-uniqueness lets a wrong recharge field fit the heads (Erdal and Cirpka, 2016). The remedy is to put the datum and stage corrections into the state vector, $z = (h, r, \delta_{\text{sea}}, \delta_{river})$, and estimate them with the heads, as ensemble history matching already does for sea-level and recharge ensembles of an island aquifer (Coulon et al., 2024). The boundary and recharge uncertainty that remains then sets the floor of the predictive uncertainty, which more head data alone do not remove.

4. Initial state

4.1 How long the aquifer remembers

In the linearised aquifer, the head is a sum of decaying modes plus the response to the forcing:

$$h(x,t) = \sum_{k\geq 1} a_k\, e^{-t/\tau_k}\, \varphi_k(x) + h_f(x,t), \qquad \tau_1 = \frac{4SL^2}{\pi^2 T}, \tag{10}$$

for a fixed head at the coast and a divide at distance L. An error in the initial state decays as e^{-t/τ_1}, so a spin-up of $\tau_1 \ln 10 \approx 2.3\,\tau_1$ leaves 10% of it. The same time scale limits what data can say about the initial state: with observation noise of intensity σ^2, the Fisher information on a_1 from data after time t is

$$I_{a_1}(t) = \frac{1}{\sigma^2}\int_t^\infty e^{-2s/\tau_1}\, ds = \frac{\tau_1}{2\sigma^2}\, e^{-2t/\tau_1}, \tag{11}$$

so the initial state is forgotten, and becomes unidentifiable, on the same time scale. Either the model is spun up for $2.3\,\tau_1$, or the initial heads are estimated from the first part of the record, shorter than τ_1.

4.2 Ensemble Kalman filtering

The ensemble Kalman filter (Evensen, 1994) updates each member of the ensemble with

$$x^a = x^f + K\big(y - Hx^f\big), \qquad K = P^f H^\top (HP^f H^\top + R)^{-1}. \tag{12}$$

It is exact in the linear-Gaussian case as the ensemble grows, and recent mean-field analysis bounds its error when the forecast is close to Gaussian or the dynamics close to linear (Carrillo et al., 2024; Calvello et al., 2026), within a mean-field framework for ensemble Kalman methods (Calvello et al., 2025); non-asymptotic analysis explains when a small ensemble suffices (Al-Ghattas and Sanz-Alonso, 2024). In practice its accuracy is monitored through the skewness and kurtosis of the forecast ensemble; transport-map filters extend it when the forecast is far from Gaussian (Spantini et al., 2022).

4.3 Variational estimation

4D-Var estimates the initial state by minimising

$$J(x_0) = 1/2\,\|x_0 - x_b\|^2_{B^{-1}} + 1/2\sum_k \|y_k - H\,\mathcal{M}_k(x_0)\|^2_{R^{-1}}, \tag{13}$$

with the gradient from the adjoint model. For a nonlinear aquifer model, the Gauss–Newton iteration needs safeguards: plain Gauss–Newton may fail to converge from a poor starting point, line-search and regularised variants restore convergence (Cartis et al., 2024), and Levenberg–Marquardt methods with inexact steps converge globally (Bergou et al., 2016).

4.4 Bayesian inversion in function space

Bayesian inversion in function space (Stuart, 2010) gives posteriors for initial heads and parameters that do not degrade as the mesh is refined; Laplace approximations with low-rank or hierarchical Hessians make them scalable (Hartland et al., 2023; Kim et al., 2023), and goal-oriented real-time Bayesian inference now serves early warning, for tsunamis (Henneking et al., 2026).

5. Propagation of uncertainty

5.1 Multilevel Monte Carlo

The probabilities that warnings need, of heads below a pumping threshold or of chloride above a limit, are expectations of functionals P of the solution. Multilevel Monte Carlo writes the expectation on the finest mesh as a telescoping sum over meshes $l = 0, \ldots, L$ (Giles, 2008):

$$\mathbb{E}[P_L] = \mathbb{E}[P_0] + \sum_{l=1}^{L} \mathbb{E}[P_l - P_{l-1}]. \tag{14}$$

If the weak error decays as $2^{-\alpha l}$, the variance of the corrections as $2^{-\beta l}$ and the cost of one sample grows as $2^{\gamma l}$, the cost of a root-mean-square accuracy ε is (Giles, 2015)

$$\mathrm{Cost}(\varepsilon) \propto \begin{cases} \varepsilon^{-2}, & \beta > \gamma, \\ \varepsilon^{-2}(\log \varepsilon)^2, & \beta = \gamma, \\ \varepsilon^{-2-(\gamma-\beta)/\alpha}, & \beta < \gamma, \end{cases} \tag{15}$$

so when the corrections shrink faster than the cost grows, a probability on the finest mesh costs as much, in order, as an average of independent numbers (for groundwater flow with random coefficients, Istratuca and Teckentrup, 2025).

5.2 Probabilities of crossing a threshold

For a probability the functional is an indicator, $P = \mathbf{1}\{h < h_{\min}\}$, which is discontinuous and lowers β. Smoothing the indicator, by a conditional expectation over the last step or by a kernel, restores the rate (Haji-Ali et al., 2022; Bayer et al., 2024). Surrogates enter as control variates on the coarse levels (Peherstorfer et al., 2016; Gruber et al., 2023).

5.3 Model error apart from forcing

Model error is kept apart from the forcing by writing $x_{k+1} = \mathcal{M}(x_k, r_k) + \eta_k$, with η_k estimated apart from the recharge r_k; otherwise the filter attributes model bias to the rain. Weak-constraint 4D-Var estimates η_k as part of the control variable (Trémolet, 2007), and its covariance can be chosen as a regularisation parameter (Babyale et al., 2025); but model error and initial state separate only under specific conditions (Laloyaux et al., 2020), and in hydrology rainfall and structural errors can be poorly identifiable (Renard et al., 2010).

5.4 Sampling and averaging

Averaging a process with correlation time τ over intervals of length Δ changes its correlation. For an Ornstein–Uhlenbeck process with variance σ^2, the block means satisfy

$$\mathrm{Var}(\bar{A}) = 2\sigma^2 \frac{\tau}{\Delta}\left[1 - \frac{\tau}{\Delta}(1 - e^{-\Delta/\tau})\right], \quad \mathrm{Cov}(\bar{A}_k, \bar{A}_{k+1}) = \sigma^2 \frac{\tau^2}{\Delta^2}(1 - e^{-\Delta/\tau})^2, \tag{16}$$

so the lag-one correlation of monthly means is not $e^{-\Delta/\tau}$, and a response time read from monthly means is biased upwards (Table 4). The bias of estimators for a time-integrated Ornstein–Uhlenbeck process is derived in econometrics (Hoyos, 2025), and averaging recessions is known to bias recession parameters in hydrology (Jachens et al., 2020), but we found no study that quantifies the effect on groundwater response times. Daily logger data avoid the bias.

Table 4. Response time of the aquifer estimated from monthly means (Δ = 30 days) against the true value.

True response time τ (days)	Estimated from monthly means (days)	Overestimate
2	9.0	4.5 ×
5	13.0	2.6 ×
10	19.8	2.0 ×
30	49.1	1.6 ×
90	138.9	1.5 ×

6. What is new: four numbers that choose the method

The literature answers each question separately. CERTAIN-COAST joins the answers through four dimensionless numbers computed from the records of Fushë-Kuqe before any simulation (Table 5). Each number selects the method for one question, so the workflow is fixed by data rather than by habit, and each approximation comes with a stated error: the exact Gamma law of Section 2.3 is the reference against which the Gaussian forcing is checked (Table 2), and the averaging bias of Section 5.4 is the reason the network of WP4 records daily (Table 4). The individual results are known; their use as one decision map for a coastal aquifer is the contribution.

Table 5. The decision map: four numbers, computed from data, that choose the method for each question.

Number	Computed from	Rule and method chosen
Π = λτ	Storm rate from the rain gauge; response time from head recessions	Π ≥ 20 and only means and variances needed: Gaussian recharge noise. Otherwise shot-noise forcing; tail probabilities always from the exact Gamma law.

Number	Computed from	Rule and method chosen
$\Gamma = CL/T$	Conductance of the river beds and of the coast; transmissivity	$\Gamma \geq 100$: fixed head with an uncertain datum. $\Gamma \leq 0.1$: no flow. Between: conductance condition with the stage correction in the state vector.
t/τ_1	Storage, transmissivity and length of the model; length of the record	Record before the forecast $\geq 2.3\ \tau_1$: spin-up. Otherwise: initial heads estimated from the first part of the record.
$\beta - \gamma$	Pilot runs on three meshes	$\beta > \gamma$: standard multilevel Monte Carlo. $\beta \leq \gamma$: smoothed indicators and surrogate control variates.

7. What remains open

No well-posedness theorem covers a three-dimensional, variable-density coastal aquifer with random recharge, random sea level and a moving interface at once; most results are one-dimensional, periodic or with homogeneous Dirichlet conditions. Rainfall generators with temporal clustering have no theory for the aquifer response beyond the shot-noise case. The theorems on assimilation assume bounded dynamics and additive Gaussian forcing, so the multiplicative, heavy-tailed forcing of Section 2 lies outside them. The decision map keeps each method of CERTAIN-COAST where its theory holds.

8. Where this enters the work plan

T2.3, calibration: the law of the recharge chosen by Π; datum and stage corrections in the state vector where Γ requires it; initial heads by spin-up or estimation according to t/τ_1. **T3.2, alarms:** tail probabilities from the exact law and multilevel Monte Carlo with smoothed indicators. **T4.1, network design:** daily loggers (Table 4), a local rain gauge for the storm rate, and the tide gauge for the fluctuation of the sea. **WP5, live operation:** the non-Gaussianity of the forecast ensemble is monitored at every update.

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PART 3

Technical annex

How the methods work, the preparatory tests, the gates with their fallbacks and the nine new contributions.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part

The certified margins (6)–(7) and the safe operating window (10) of this annex are the shield of the agent of Part 7: every decision it recommends is projected onto the window before it is issued with a bulletin.

CERTAIN-COAST — Technical annex

Certified early warning to protect water, port and energy infrastructure on a sinking Adriatic coast

How the methods work, what was tested before the project, and what is new. This annex supplements the fields "How will the project reach the planned end state?" and "Work-plan" of the application form; work packages (WP), tasks (T), deliverables (D), months and milestones (MS) are those of the form. Test results come from synthetic test systems and preparatory models, not from measurements made by the project at the sites.

1. Two sites, three coupled hazards

The project protects two sites on the Albanian Adriatic coastal plain: at Durrës, the wellfields that supply drinking water and the port; near Fier, the landfall of the Trans Adriatic Pipeline (TAP). The demonstration runs on the project's monitoring network on the coast of Durrës and Fushë-Kuqe, with the Institute of Geosciences (IGJEO) of the Polytechnic University of Tirana as the end-user, which monitors earthquakes, weather and waters in Albania; the port and the landfall are assessed from satellite radar, GNSS and public data only. Both sites stand on low ground near active faults, and at Durrës the land is sinking; the earthquake of 26 November 2019 caused liquefaction near the coast (Mavroulis, Lekkas and Carydis, 2021). Three hazards threaten these assets, and they are coupled through two variables, the relative sea level and the water table. Sea level enters the aquifer at its seaward boundary and sets how far seawater advances; the water table sets the effective stress in the sands and so their resistance to liquefaction; subsidence raises the relative sea level at every asset. Pumping lowers the water table: it increases seawater intrusion and, below the preconsolidation head, permanent subsidence, but it raises the factor of safety against liquefaction. No hazard can be managed alone, so one indicator is defined per hazard, oriented so that larger means more dangerous (Table 1).

Table 1. Hazard indicators, thresholds and lead times.

Hazard (assets)	Indicator	Threshold	Lead time, cadence
Seawater intrusion (Durrës wellfields)	I_1: chloride at the monitoring wells next to each wellfield	From the drinking-water standard, agreed with the end-user (for example 250 mg/L)	Weeks to months; weekly
Liquefaction (Durrës port; TAP landfall)	I_2: liquefaction potential index under the design shaking at the current water table	Class boundary of the design codes, agreed with the end-user	Daily; recomputed at once after an earthquake
Extreme water level (all assets)	I_3: total water level at each asset	Design or operational level of each asset	Hours to days for storms; return levels yearly

An alarm is missed when the indicator exceeds its threshold within the lead time and no alarm was issued; the long-run miss rate is the quantity the project certifies. Earthquakes are not forecast: the liquefaction alarm states how the ground would respond if the design earthquake struck now, a state that changes with the water table. In a preparatory test at a synthetic port, the chance that the liquefaction potential index exceeded 5 if the design earthquake struck on a given day moved between 0.16 in late July and 0.26 in early February.

2. The method chain

Six steps turn data into bulletins (Figure 1). Each step has a pass test and a fallback (Section 7). Three loops close the chain: verified outcomes update the alarm margins, new data are assimilated into the model, and the certified safe window of Section 6 tells the network how many years of safe operation each sensor adds.

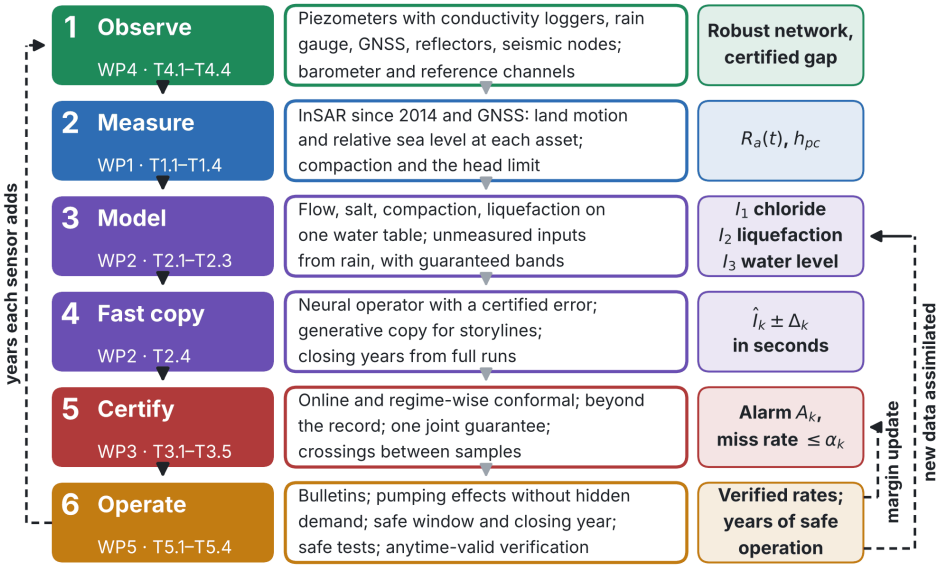


Figure 1. The CERTAIN-COAST method chain for the Durrës wellfields and port and the TAP landfall near Fier. Solid arrows: from data to bulletins. Dashed arrows: the three feedback loops. Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

3. Observe and measure (WP1, WP4)

3.1 Relative sea level at each asset (WP1, T1.1–T1.4)

Sentinel-1 ascending and descending time series since 2014 give the vertical and east components of land motion; a trajectory model separates trend, season, the coseismic step of 26 November 2019 and the postseismic transient. Corner reflectors and GNSS at the assets (T1.2) give stable radar targets on soft ground and tie the solution to a global frame. The tide gauge records sea level η_{TG} relative to its own benchmark, which also moves, so the relative sea level at asset a adds the differential vertical land motion u_z, propagated with its full covariance (target vertical-velocity uncertainty 1–2 mm/yr; Ohenhen et al., 2023):

$$R_a(t) = \eta_{\mathrm{TG}}(t) + u_z^{\mathrm{TG}}(t) - u_z^{a}(t) \tag{1}$$

Elastic and inelastic compaction fitted to the InSAR and head records give the head limit h_{pc} above which pumping causes no new permanent subsidence (Lees, Knight and Smith, 2022). The same $R_a(t)$ drives all three hazard models, so the warnings cannot disagree about where the sea is.

3.2 A network designed for the warnings, which corrects its own sensors (WP4, T4.1–T4.4)

The network is designed before it is bought (D4.1, Month 6). Candidates are piezometers with conductivity loggers, a local rain gauge, GNSS, corner reflectors, seismic nodes and, where access allows, fibre-optic sensing; the candidate sites are boreholes on public land and existing wells whose owners agree. Each candidate is valued by goal-oriented Bayesian design (Attia, Alexanderian and Saibaba, 2018) in two currencies: the guaranteed width it removes from the warning bands, and the years of certified safe operation it adds (Eq. (12)). A sensor is bought only if its guaranteed value is positive: in a preparatory test, a tide gauge that a standard ensemble rated as narrowing the recharge band by 15% widened the guaranteed band by 16–21%.

Loggers respond to air pressure (Rasmussen and Crawford, 1997) and drift. A barometer and a sealed reference channel on each logger hub are therefore design candidates beside the piezometers; their errors are removed by marginalisation, and the network is chosen against the worst plausible error model, with a certified distance from the best network (robust design; Chowdhary, Attia and Alexanderian, 2025). In a preparatory test with 12 sensors the worst-case information was 5.59 nats against 3.67 for the classical design (+52%), with a certified optimality gap of 18%; 90% forecast intervals covered 88–93% of outcomes after correction and 49–62% without, and corrected heads were within 2.9 cm root-mean-square against 7.6 cm raw.

Near the port and the TAP landfall, T4.2 places corner reflectors, a GNSS station and a seismic station on public land. Ambient seismic noise tracks the water table (Clements and Denolle, 2018), also on unused telecommunication fibre (Rodríguez Tribaldos and Ajo-Franklin, 2021); once calibrated against piezometers

(T4.4), velocity changes measure the water table between wells, also near the port and the landfall, and a drop after an earthquake measures the softening of the ground.

4. Model and certify (WP2)

4.1 One coupled model (T2.1–T2.3)

One model, set up for the two sites on one coastal motion field (T2.1), couples variable-density flow, salt transport with memory in clays, the sea as a moving boundary driven by $R_a(t)$, compaction, the total water level at each asset, and liquefaction triggering with the water table taken from the flow model at every time step (Seed and Idriss, 1971; Boulanger and Idriss, 2014). Groundwater rise under sea-level rise is a hazard in its own right (Befus et al., 2020) and raises liquefaction severity where water tables are shallow (Grant et al., 2021); here one water table drives all three hazards, so a pumping decision is checked against all of them at once. Parameters are estimated jointly from heads, conductivity, chloride, InSAR and seismic velocity by an ensemble smoother (Emerick and Reynolds, 2013); the model is differentiable, so adjoint gradients of every indicator are available (Shen et al., 2023). Priors are stated so that an expert can read and dispute them (Simpson et al., 2017; Fuglstad et al., 2019) and are checked after calibration for prior-data conflict (Evans and Moshonov, 2006).

4.2 Guarantees for the inputs and boundaries nobody measures (T2.3)

Recharge, vadose delay, storage, the sea-level and inland boundaries, the initial head and the dispersion width are never measured, yet every warning depends on them. They are reconstructed from rain and heads by a function-space diffusion prior with an ensemble update through the exact solver, with the errors of the rain product simulated in the prior. Their bands are calibrated by conformal risk control (Angelopoulos, Bates, Fisch, Lei and Schuster, 2024) on simulated aquifers that carry these errors, and checked on measured anchor periods, so the guarantee does not depend on the simulator. With a loss $L_i(\lambda)$ between 0 and 1 for calibration case i and its mean $\hat{R}_n(\lambda)$ over n cases:

$$\hat{\lambda} = \inf\left\{ \lambda : \frac{n}{n+1}\hat{R}_n(\lambda) + \frac{1}{n+1} \le \alpha \right\} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathrm{E}\left[L_{n+1}(\hat{\lambda})\right] \le \alpha \tag{2}$$

For α = 10%, at least 9 anchor periods give the average guarantee and 22 a 90% certificate. Under drift the calibration is matched to the forecast horizon, and a computable floor shows how far each band is from the narrowest valid one. In the preparatory test the raw ensemble missed 17–20% of the weeks and the calibrated bands 9.5–10% (target 10%); the risk stayed at 0.003–0.082 up to 20 years ahead under drift.

4.3 The boundary where the model is cut (T2.3, T4.1)

Every model of the aquifer ends somewhere inland, at a cut that geology does not mark. A fixed head, a prescribed inflow or a general-head boundary does not respond to pumping or to the sea as the aquifer beyond does, and the choice decides the answers. In the preparatory test, the fresh water lost to a 0.5 m rise of the sea over 20 years was 49 m³ per metre of coast with a prescribed inflow, 462 with a fixed head and 154 in the full aquifer (Werner and Simmons, 2009). For any linear aquifer beyond the cut, heterogeneous, leaky or closed, the exact boundary is a conductance plus positive storage compartments. With $u = h - \bar{h}$ the head at the cut above its reference and q_{in} the inflow from rain, the outward flux is

$$q_n = -q_{in}(t) + C\,u + \sum_{m=1}^{M} w_m (u - y_m) \quad \text{and} \quad \dot{y}_m = \mu_m (u - y_m) \quad \text{and} \quad C,\ w_m \ge 0 \tag{3}$$

Conversely, every such network is the exact boundary of some physical aquifer, so a learned boundary cannot be unphysical; the same positive memory describes diffusion into the silt and clay lenses inside the model (Haggerty and Gorelick, 1995). With $C, w_m \ge 0$ the boundary is passive: the model loses energy whatever its other parameters, as passive models of an external electrical network do (Gustavsen and Semlyen, 2001). A negative conductance that was stable in a 2 km test grew without bound in a 6 km model. The rates μ_m sit on a fixed logarithmic grid, three to four per decade of period. The weights are learned from two piezometers between the wellfields and the cut (T4.1), which separate the boundary from everything else in the model, on the band of periods that changes of pumping excite. A neural network may supply q_{in} from rain and monotone conductances, never the storages, and a prior learned from simulated geology fills the periods the data do not reach. In the test, six compartments reproduced the full aquifer to 7.8 mm root-mean-square over 20 years (best general-head boundary: 148 mm). Learned from the two piezometers while the pumping varied, the boundary predicted an unseen drought with doubled pumping to 6 mm (372 mm), and the

fresh water lost to the sea-level rise within 4%. The proofs and the six checks are in the BEYOND-GO theory note, the third document of these files.

4.4 The earthquake in the aquifer (T2.2, T4.4, T5.4)

An earthquake changes the pore pressure at once, so the liquefaction indicator uses the pore pressure of that moment: below the water table of the day, $u = \gamma_w (z - z_w)_+ + f \Delta p_0$, where f is the share of the step left at the end of the shaking (close to zero in sand within a few metres of the water table, one in sand below clay). The static step follows from the published fault models of the 2019 earthquake (Ganas et al., 2020; Govorčin et al., 2020; Matraku et al., 2023; van der Heiden et al., 2026) through the horizontal strain at the surface (Okada, 1985). A soft layer under the free surface takes that strain and adjusts vertically, so for an undrained layer with shear modulus G, Skempton coefficient B and undrained Poisson ratio ν_u

$$\Delta p_0 = -\kappa \, (\Delta \varepsilon_{xx} + \Delta \varepsilon_{yy}) \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa = \frac{2GB}{3} \frac{1 + \nu_u}{1 - \nu_u} \tag{4}$$

A soft saturated sand (ν_u near 1/2) deforms at almost constant volume, so its step scales with G, which the seismic nodes measure as shear-wave velocity (T4.4). With the four source models the step was 7–12 cm of head in soft surface sand (G = 50 MPa) and 0.6–1.0 m in a stiffer confined aquifer (G = 0.5 GPa); the usual estimate, BK_u times the volumetric strain of the half-space, gave 35 times the soft-sand value. For liquefaction the water table of the day dominates: in an example profile the index fell from 20.2 to 9.3 as the water table deepened from 0.8 to 2.6 m. The cone-penetration resistance keeps the value it had when it was measured; re-normalising it with the stress of the day understated that slope by 33%. The step matters in the confined aquifer, and its relaxation is a free pumping test: 20 days of logger data after a 0.3 m step pinned the leakage time 5.8 times more sharply than a year of seasonal heads. The post-event protocol (T5.4) therefore reads the leakage of the confined aquifer from the loggers, and well records of November 2019 are sought where they exist. The mapped liquefaction of 2019 (Mavroulis, Lekkas and Carydis, 2021) cannot test the step: on a synthetic plain even 480 sites gave a power below 50%. The code and the checks are in the SHOCK-GO report, the fourth document of these files.

4.5 A fast copy with a certified error (T2.4)

Warnings need thousands of model runs a day. A neural operator (Li et al., 2021; Lu et al., 2021) is trained on runs of the coupled model, and its error on each forecast is bounded conformally (Ma et al., 2024), with the score normalised by the goal-oriented dual-weighted residual η_k (Becker and Rannacher, 2001), so the bound is tight where the copy is right about the quantity that triggers the alarm:

$$\Delta_k(\xi) = \hat{q}_{1-\delta} \, \eta_k(\xi) \quad \text{and} \quad \Pr\left[\left| I_k(\xi) - \hat{I}_k(\xi) \right| \le \Delta_k(\xi) \right] \ge 1 - \delta \tag{5}$$

Forecasts whose bound is too wide are recomputed with the full model on a reduced domain. A generative copy (Gao, Kaltenbach and Koumoutsakos, 2024) explores long storylines of sea-level rise, subsidence, droughts and pumping and chooses which of them the full model runs; in a preparatory test its statistics alone put the closing year of the safe window 2–8 years too late, so closing years are always certified from full runs with the exact binomial bound (Clopper and Pearson, 1934).

5. Certified alarms (WP3)

5.1 Alarm rule, calibration under shift and beyond the record (T3.1–T3.2)

Thresholds τ_k and tolerable miss rates α_k are agreed with the end-user (T3.1). Alarm k fires when the forecast at lead time L_k comes within a margin m_k of its threshold. The margin adds the certified copy error to a forecast error γ_k that rises after a miss and falls slightly otherwise; with a constant step λ the long-run miss rate stays within $C_k/(\lambda T)$ of its target for any sequence of data (Gibbs and Candès, 2021, 2024; Angelopoulos, Barber and Bates, 2024):

$$A_k(t) = \mathbf{1}\{ \hat{I}_k(t + L_k) \ge \tau_k - m_k(t) \} \quad \text{and} \quad m_k(t) = \Delta_k(t) + \gamma_k(t) \tag{6}$$

$$\gamma_k(t+1) = \gamma_k(t) + \lambda_t \, [\, \mathrm{miss}_k(t) - \alpha_k \,] \quad \text{and} \quad \left| \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^{T} \mathrm{miss}_k(t) - \alpha_k \right| \le \frac{C_k}{\lambda T} \tag{7}$$

The guarantee also holds within each regime (drought, storm season, after an earthquake, each asset) by conformal prediction with conditional guarantees (Gibbs, Cherian and Candès, 2025), and for events rarer than the record by extreme conformal prediction (Pasche, Lam and Engelke, 2026). Still-water extremes use a

generalised Pareto tail (Coles, 2001) whose threshold moves with the measured relative sea level of Eq. (1). In preparatory tests on a coupled variable-density model, an extreme-aware margin kept the share of seasons above the chloride limit at 4–9% across drought, human-feedback and compound storylines, where a static alarm allowed 13–21%.

5.2 One guarantee for the three assets (T3.3)

The alarms share inputs, so their misses are dependent. The probability that any alarm is missed is bounded by the sum of the tolerances, which are allocated where tightening them costs least in consequence-weighted false alarms, within caps agreed with the users. The margins are calibrated together by Learn then Test (Angelopoulos, Bates, Candès, Jordan and Lei, 2025), so every certified rate holds at once with probability at least $1-\beta$. The national authorities receive one joint guarantee for the wellfields, the port and the landfall.

5.3 Warnings for what happens between samples (T3.2)

Chloride is sampled weeks or months apart. Sparse samples pin the distribution of chloride on the sampling dates but not its time scale, so a well can turn salty between two samples that both look safe. The warning is therefore the probability that chloride crosses its limit $c^\star$ at any time in the season T, reported as a band over the set $\mathcal{M}$ of all models consistent with the records, in the spirit of robust bounds over calibrated models (Gierjatowicz et al., 2020) and of online forecasts from irregular records (Krach, Nübel and Teichmann, 2026):

$$\underline{p} = \inf_{P\in\mathcal{M}} P\left[\max_{t\in T} c(t) > c^\star\right] \quad \text{and} \quad \overline{p} = \sup_{P\in\mathcal{M}} P\left[\max_{t\in T} c(t) > c^\star\right] \tag{8}$$

The band is widened by a conformal margin calibrated on simulated aquifers and anchor periods and issued online as the conditional probability given the irregular samples and the daily heads; the network design adds the observation that closes it (a logger, or samples paired 1, 3 and 7 days apart). In the preparatory test the chance of a crossing within the season was 0.78, against 0.023 on a sampling date (34 times); the band was 0.18–1 with quarterly samples and 0.76–0.80 with a daily logger; for skewed chloride the margin restored 90.3% coverage (74% without), and a head logger raised the warning skill from 7% to 20%.

5.4 Back-testing and verification in operation (T3.4–T3.5)

The chain is replayed over the record since 2014 with the system frozen at each issue time, under a protocol published with a DOI before the results (D3.2, Month 27). At 95% confidence, verifying a 10% miss rate needs 29 exceedance events with no miss, 46 with one or 61 with two; a 5% rate needs 59, 93 or 124. In operation the ledger is published every quarter, so each miss rate is looked at many times, and a fixed-sample bound recomputed at every look loses its guarantee: in a simulation of six calibrated alarms it flagged at least one as broken in 68% of runs. Verification therefore uses e-processes, which stay valid however often they are checked (Ville, 1939; Vovk and Wang, 2021; Ramdas et al., 2023), with $x_i = 1$ if event i was missed:

$$E_k(n) = \sum_j \pi_j \prod_{i=1}^{n} \left(\frac{q_j}{\alpha_k}\right)^{x_i} \left(\frac{1-q_j}{1-\alpha_k}\right)^{1-x_i} \quad \text{and} \quad \Pr\left(E_k(n) \geq 1/\beta \ \text{ for some } n\right) \leq \beta \tag{9}$$

In the simulation the e-process flagged a calibrated alarm in 2.2% of runs (at most 5% is guaranteed) and detected an alarm whose miss rate had risen to 25% in 84% of runs within 100 events.

6. Operate and decide (WP5)

Twelve months of live bulletins (T5.2) follow a dry run (T5.1). Each bulletin states, per asset, the forecast, the margin, the alarm state, the certified miss rate and the distance to the closing of the safe window, and is logged with its inputs and code version so that it can be reproduced and audited. A post-event protocol agreed with the end-user (T5.4) remeasures heads, chloride, GNSS and seismic velocity within days of a strong earthquake or storm, updates the model and recomputes the alarms and the window.

6.1 The effect of pumping without the hidden drought demand (T5.3)

In droughts the wellfields pump more while recharge falls, so a hidden cause drives both the pumping and the salinity, and substitutes for hidden confounders inferred from the treatment history (Bica, Alaa and van der Schaar, 2020) can miss it. CERTAIN-COAST measures the confounding path instead: the heads, after the drawdown estimated from the abstraction records is added back, read the recharge, and a calibrated physics check rejects any substitute that misses a confounder before an effect is reported. In the preparatory test the bias of the summed well effects was 0.59 unadjusted, 0.56 with a history substitute and 0.00 with the heads; the check had a size of 6% and a power of 99–100%. On the calibrated chloride model of Fushë-Kuqe, 40%

less recharge would grow the shallow area above 250 mg/L from 31 to 65 km² (effect +33 km², conformal band 15–49 km²).

6.2 The certified safe operating window and the year it closes (T5.3)

Pumping moves the hazards in opposite directions, and sea-level rise and subsidence tighten all of them. At each bulletin and over the adaptation horizon the project computes the set of decisions u (wellfield pumping Q_w, port dewatering) that meets the demand D, keeps every hazard within its certified limit and causes no new permanent subsidence, and the relative sea level and year at which this set becomes empty:

$$W_\alpha(R) = \left\{ u : \; Q_w \geq D, \quad \Pr_\theta \left[I_k(u, R; \theta) > \tau_k \right] \leq \alpha_k \;\; (k = 1,2,3), \quad h(\mathbf{x}, u, R) \geq h_{\mathrm{pc}}(\mathbf{x}) \right\} \tag{10}$$

$$R_\alpha^\star = \text{largest } R \text{ with } W_\alpha(R) \neq \varnothing \quad \text{and} \quad t_\alpha^\star = \text{first } t \text{ with } W_\alpha(R(t)) = \varnothing \tag{11}$$

This is a certified, multi-hazard adaptation tipping point (Kwadijk et al., 2010; Haasnoot et al., 2013); tipping points exist for seawater intrusion alone (Mazi, Koussis and Destouni, 2013). At the closing point the least dewatering that keeps liquefaction within its limit, A, meets the most dewatering the wellfield tolerates, B, and one multiplier μ converts any change of a margin, from a sensor, a better model or a pumping test, into years:

$$\mu = -\left[\frac{d\,(B - A)}{dt} \right]^{-1}_{t = t_\alpha^\star} \quad \text{and} \quad \Delta t_\alpha^\star \approx \mu\,(\Delta B - \Delta A) \tag{12}$$

On a synthetic transect with the three hazards of Durrës and illustrative values, the certified window closed at a relative sea level of 0.41 m, after 38 years; plans that watch one hazard believed they had 43 to 97 years, and the margins cost 84 years against the window without them. Valued in years by preposterior analysis, with Eq. (12) as a first-order shortcut, a sentinel piezometer between the wellfield and the sea added 21.6 years, and a GNSS station and two corner reflectors 5.6 and 5.0 years, where the classical criterion values them at zero because they narrow none of today's forecasts. For one managed head the window between liquefaction and intrusion has a closed form, $\eta + m_{int} \leq h \leq z_s - z^\star(a)$, with $z^\star(a)$ the water-table depth that keeps the index below 5 for 90% of the profiles under the design acceleration a and m_{int} the fresh head that keeps the interface 20 m deep. At a synthetic port it closed at 0.29 m of relative sea-level rise for 0.20 g and was already closed at 0.22 g, so the design acceleration chosen for the port decides the closing year.

6.3 Safe pumping tests chosen for the years they add (T5.3)

Routine pumping keeps the water table in a narrow band, so the records say little about how chloride responds near the onset of intrusion, which decides when the window closes. Short pumping and dewatering tests, each approved by the operator of the wells and by the permitting authority, would approach that onset safely; within the project they are planned and checked on the model, and run only where the well operator agrees. The response is linear in unknown coefficients of hinge features of the head, with a confidence set that holds in every week (Abbasi-Yadkori, Pál and Szepesvári, 2011). A test is chosen for the years it adds to the certified closing year, as in active identification with guarantees (Mania, Jordan and Recht, 2022) but for the decision, and only if the upper confidence bound of chloride stays below a test limit in every week of the test and the recovery (Koller et al., 2018). In the preparatory test the campaign raised the certified closing year from 10.8 to 31.9 years (true value 45) with chloride below 123 mg/L in 95% of runs, whereas tests chosen for parameter accuracy alone passed 250 mg/L in 42% of runs; the certificate held in all 1,000 runs. The years rest on the prior from the calibrated model, so the certified year is reported for the prior error radius S and for $2S$ (doubling it cost 17.3 of the 31.9 years), for readers who trust the model less (Andrews and Shapiro, 2021).

6.4 Pumping rule and the value of the warning for each user (T5.3, D5.1)

Within the window, the pumping and drought rule supplies as much water as possible; it is checked for a sudden pumping stop, after which the water table recovers and the factor of safety falls, computed with the fast copy, confirmed with the full model and prepared for the authorities that issue water-use permits. Because each miss rate is certified, the value of a warning to each user in the cost-loss model (Murphy, 1977; Richardson, 2000) has a guaranteed lower bound for every cost-loss ratio agreed in T3.1, reported in D5.1.

6.5 Pumping before the source of the chloride is known (T4.1, T5.3)

Rising chloride at a wellfield need not be seawater. Deep brine drawn up under the wells, a drought that concentrates the recharge, or irrigation return flow and wastewater fit the same chloride record, and each calls for a different change of pumping. On a synthetic test bed with three wellfields and an alternative supply, acting on the wrong source let the blend exceed 250 mg/L with probability up to 100%, and the usual assumption of seawater intrusion up to 98%. CERTAIN-COAST therefore decides before the source is known. Tracer data y (Br/Cl ratios, water isotopes, depth profiles from multilevel wells, nitrate and boron; Davis, Whittemore and Fabryka-Martin, 1998) give each candidate source k an e-value. The sources that the data cannot exclude form a set that contains the true source with probability at least $1-\beta$, for any sample size and without a prior (Vovk and Wang, 2021):

$$E_k(y)=\frac{1}{K-1}\sum_{j\neq k}\frac{p_j(y)}{p_k(y)} \quad \text{and} \quad S(y)=\{\,k:\ E_k(y)<1/\beta\,\} \quad \text{and} \quad \Pr_k\,[\,k\notin S(y)\,]\le\beta \tag{13}$$

The set keeps every source whose posterior under a flat prior exceeds $\beta/(K-1+\beta)$, and it is never empty. Where the end-member signatures are uncertain, the denominator is replaced by its supremum over them (universal inference; Wasserman, Ramdas and Balakrishnan, 2020). The pumping of the wellfields and the use of the alternative supply are then chosen at least social cost, safe for every source left in the set:

$$\min_u\ c(u) \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \Pr_k\,[\,\mathrm{Cl}_{\mathrm{blend}}(u)>250\ \text{mg/L}\,]\le\alpha \ \text{ for every } k\in S(y) \quad \Rightarrow \quad \Pr\,[\,\text{exceed}\,]\le\alpha+\beta \tag{14}$$

The bound holds whatever the true source is. The prior of experts and users is used only to choose which tracers to buy, by the cost of the decision they change (T4.1). Monthly samples multiply the e-values, so the set can be read at every steering meeting and acted on at any time without losing the guarantee (Ville, 1939). A ledger shows what not knowing the source costs the water supply, the farmers and the wetland. In the preparatory test the rule kept every source at or below 6.9% against a 10% budget, at €3.31 million. Pumping safe for all sources without tests cost €4.16 million, and €2.87 million if the source were known. Bayesian rules after the same tests reached 12.3% for the sources the prior did not favour. Monthly updates dropped the true source in 1.2–1.5% of cases, against 22% for an ordinary test repeated every month. A truth that mixes seawater and upconing breaks a list of pure sources (16.8%); admitting mixtures as hypotheses restores safety at a higher cost.

7. Gates, pass tests and fallbacks

Table 2. What each step must achieve before the next starts, and what happens if it does not.

Step and gate	Pass test	Fallback
Network design (WP4; MS1, Month 6)	Approved by the steering committee; certified optimality gap of at most 25%	Design re-run with the remaining budget; seismic nodes if fibre is not available
Network and coastal motion (WP4, WP1; MS2, Month 12)	At least 90% data availability; corrected heads within 3 cm root-mean-square of manual dips; vertical-velocity uncertainty of about 1–2 mm/yr at asset points	Corner reflectors and scatterers on structures where radar coherence is lost
Coupled model and unmeasured inputs (WP2; MS3, Month 18)	Held-out heads, chloride, InSAR and seismic velocity inside the 90% predictive intervals at close to the nominal rate; band for crossings at most 0.25 wide for each wellfield; the learned inland boundary passive	Model built in stages; two-dimensional sections through each asset with a wider error bound; a wider simulation-calibrated band, reported as such, if anchors are too few; a general-head boundary with a widened band if the inland boundary is not identified
Certified copy and alarm prototype (WP2, WP3; MS4, Month 22, go/no-go)	Error bound met on test runs; the prototype passes a dry run with the end-user	Full model on a reduced domain for flagged forecasts
Back-testing (WP3; MS5, Month 27)	Each miss rate at or below its target with a 95% confidence bound, crossings between samples included, under the pre-registered protocol	Margin widened: the miss target is kept and the extra false alarms are reported
Live operation (WP5; MS6, Month 34)	Twelve months of logged bulletins; no e-process reaches 1/β; safe window reported for each asset with a plan of safe pumping tests and the years it would add; the plausible chloride sources and the pumping in force published every month	If no strong event occurs, verification rests on back-testing and storylines; the window from routine records and the post-earthquake relaxation

Step and gate	Pass test	Fallback
Hand-over (WP6, WP7; MS7, Month 36)	An operating procedure for the bulletins agreed with IGJEO; its trained staff use the bulletins in Months 34–36 with the project team only in support; at least four of its staff trained; agreement on keeping and maintaining the sensors signed by Month 33 (D6.2); open software and data with a DOI reproduced outside the team (D6.1, Month 33)	Extra training and tasks reassigned within the consortium; procedures restated jointly with the end-user; the university hosts the system until the agreement on the sensors is in place

8. What is new beyond the state of the art

The alarms assemble published methods of 2021–2026 (online and conditional conformal prediction, extreme conformal prediction, Learn then Test and anytime-valid verification); their joint use for coupled coastal hazards is an application and is not claimed as new. Nine contributions were derived and tested before the project (Table 3); the novelty statements rest on our literature search to date.

Table 3. The nine new contributions, the result of their preparatory test and where they are used.

Contribution	What is new	Preparatory test	Where
(i) Guarantees for quantities nobody measures	Bands for recharge, vadose delay, boundaries and dispersion that stay valid when the simulator or the rain product is wrong, with a computable floor	Raw ensemble missed 17–20% of weeks; calibrated bands 9.5–10% (target 10%)	T2.3; D2.1, MS3
(ii) The value of a sensor	The guaranteed band a sensor removes and the years of safe operation it adds	GNSS and corner reflectors: 5.6 and 5.0 years, where the classical criterion gives zero; a tide gauge rated useful widened the band by 16–21%	T4.1; D4.1, MS1
(iii) Pumping effects free of hidden confounding	The confounding path measured by the heads, with a calibrated check of every substitute	Bias 0.00 with the heads, against 0.56–0.59; check size 6%, power 99–100%	T5.3
(iv) Certified safe window and safe pumping tests	One window for three hazards and the year it closes; tests chosen for the years they add, with a chloride safety filter	Window closes after 38 years where single-hazard plans assume 43–97; tests: 10.8 to 31.9 years, chloride below 123 mg/L in 95% of runs	T5.3; D5.1, MS6
(v) A network that corrects its own sensors	Barometer and reference channels placed by design; robust choice with a certified optimality gap	+52% worst-case information; gap 18%; interval coverage 88–93% against 49–62%	T4.1–T4.3; D4.1
(vi) Warnings for what happens between samples	A certified band for a crossing at any time in the season, and the observation that closes it	Crossing 0.78 against 0.023 on a sampling date (34 times); band 0.18–1, narrowed to 0.76–0.80 by a logger	T3.2; D2.1, D3.2
(vii) Pumping before the source of the chloride is known	The sources that tracer e-values cannot exclude, kept without a prior; pumping safe for all of them; tracers bought for the decision they change; monthly updates valid at any time	Every source at or below 6.9% against a 10% budget (assuming seawater: up to 98%); €3.31 million against €4.16 million without tests; true source dropped in 1.2–1.5% of cases against 22%	T4.1, T5.3; MS6
(viii) A boundary that learns the aquifer beyond the model	A conductance plus positive storage compartments: exact for any linear aquifer beyond the cut, passive whatever the rest of the model, learned from two piezometers while the pumping varies	Six compartments 7.8 mm against 148 mm for the best general-head boundary; unseen drought with doubled pumping 6 mm against 372 mm; fresh water lost to sea-level rise within 4% (prescribed inflow: 3.1 times too little)	T2.3, T4.1; D2.1, MS3
(ix) Which aquifer feels an earthquake	The pore-pressure step of each layer from its own stiffness, in the liquefaction indicator with the pore pressure of the day; the step of the confined aquifer used as a free pumping test	Step 7–12 cm in soft sand and 0.6–1.0 m in a confined aquifer, where the usual estimate is 35 times the soft-sand value; leakage time 5.8 times sharper than from a year of seasons	T2.2, T4.4, T5.4; D2.1

Together they answer questions that no current coastal warning answers for its users: how often a warning will be missed and so what silence means; how many years of safe pumping and dewatering remain as the sea rises and the land sinks; which sensor or pumping test buys more of them; how the aquifer beyond the model answers new pumping and a rising sea; which layer an earthquake loads and what its relaxation reveals; and how to pump safely before anyone knows where the salt comes from. The system starts at TRL 3, each component shown in preparatory tests, and ends at TRL 6, demonstrated through twelve months of live operation on the project's monitoring network with the Institute of Geosciences (IGJEO) as end-user; at the port and the landfall the warnings run on satellite, GNSS and public data.

Software and data. The NPD builds the model and the alarm algorithm and writes the code. The model, fast copies, alarms, safe window, test planner and network design are written in MATLAB, run also in the free GNU Octave (no licence is needed to use them) and are released under the Apache License 2.0 with tests (D6.1), public from the start on GitHub (https://github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast) and archived on Zenodo with a DOI (https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.24148762). Data shared by the owners of wells and records are used under the access agreements of T7.2; derived products, the bulletin log and the verification ledger are released openly following FAIR principles, and the preparatory tests are scripted and released with the software.

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PART 4

Technical note: the assembled system and the placement of the wells

Assembling the equations of a coastal aquifer, with the placement of recharge and pumping wells as the final goal. Preparatory work of the NPD's team, October 2026; corrected 8 November 2026.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part

The goal-graded assembly of this note makes the coupled model fast enough for the many training episodes of the agent of Part 7, and its adjoint gives the gradient of the cost with respect to the decisions.

TECHNICAL NOTE · THE ASSEMBLED SYSTEM · OCTOBER 2026

Assembling the equations of a coastal aquifer, with the placement of recharge and pumping wells as the final goal

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Faculty of Geology and Mining, Polytechnic University of Tirana, Albania. Assembles the equations of the author's series into one system for the Fushë-Kuqe aquifer, states the placement of recharge and pumping wells as its final goal, and adds the innovation ASSEMBLY-GO.

Abstract. This note assembles into one system every equation the author's series has written for the Fushë-Kuqe coastal aquifer. The equations are: the flow equation with the two terms added to it (the memory of the silt and clay lenses, through a kernel κ_h and its tail K_h, and a learned closure Ψ); the salt equations with immobile zones; the long equation of seven ions with cation exchange, calcite, sulfate reduction and electro-diffusion; the toe and its mobility; the wells; and every boundary and initial condition. The assembled differential-algebraic system carries 31 unknowns per cell. Its block Jacobian couples flow and salt both ways and everything else one way, and its exact discrete adjoint gives the gradient of any goal in one backward sweep. The final goal is the placement of recharge and pumping wells. This is a chance-constrained, mixed-integer problem whose constraint is the chloride in the supply screen and whose safe yield is an order statistic of critical pumping rates. The innovation, ASSEMBLY-GO, lets this goal decide the assembly in four steps: one forward and one adjoint run weigh every term; the ion block is cut exactly, and terms below 2% of the limit are cut; the mesh is graded by the dual-weighted residual; the error that remains is calibrated into the constraint. On a vertical section with a 50-year pumping history the goal cut the memory of the lenses and the sea-level rise (weights at most 2.1×10^{-5}, a five-hundredth of the limit) and kept the immobile zones, dispersion, buoyancy and the same-step coupling (weights 3.0×10^{-3} to 2.6×10^{-2}); the one-pass split of flow and salt was 16% below the coupled screen chloride at half-year steps. The goal-guided assembly runs a 30-year forecast 2.5 times faster than the complete assembly, ranks the 25 layouts as it does (rank correlation 0.997) and, with its calibrated margin, chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.95 m²/d per metre of coast, whose risk judged on 25 draws of the complete assembly is 8% (2 of 25; 95% interval 1–26%), against a target of 10% and a guarantee of 20%, the target plus the calibration level. Run once afterwards, the ion block leaves the chloride goal unchanged and keeps sodium at the screen at 125 mg/L.

Keywords: seawater intrusion; variable-density flow; memory kernel; multi-species reactive transport; saltwater toe; equation assembly; discrete adjoint; goal-oriented error estimation; managed aquifer recharge; well placement; chance constraint; Fushë-Kuqe

1. What this note does

The series has written the equations of the Fushë-Kuqe coastal aquifer piece by piece: the variable-density flow of the base paper [1], the two terms added to the flow equation in reviews 42 and 43 and their synthesis, a memory of the silt and clay lenses and a learned closure [2–4], the long equation of

multi-species transport with cation exchange, immobile zones and reactions that follows it [4], the salt equations and the chloride standard [5, 6], the mobility of the saltwater toe [7], the boundary and initial conditions [7–9], and the objectives that place monitoring, recharge and supply wells [1, 6, 10, 11]. Review 60 collected twenty papers from Oxford, Caltech, Harvard and MIT for the next step [12]. This note takes that step: it **assembles** all the equations into one system, and it states the placement of recharge and pumping wells as the **final goal** of the assembly.

Section 2 writes every equation in one notation, with the two added flow terms, the salt equations, the long multi-species equation, the toe and its mobility, the wells and every boundary and initial condition. Section 3 assembles them: the state, the discrete operators, the assembled differential-algebraic system, its block Jacobian and the order in which the blocks depend on one another. Section 4 states the final goal as a chance-constrained, mixed-integer problem constrained by the assembled system, and derives its adjoint. Section 5 is the innovation, ASSEMBLY-GO, an assembly set by the placement goal. Section 6 tests it on a vertical section of a coastal aquifer, solving the assembled system in full and in the assembly the goal chooses, and placing a recharge well and a supply well with both. Section 7 gives the recipe for Fushë-Kuqe, and Section 8 lists the system at a glance.

Table 1. Map of the note. The equation numbers refer to this note; the last column gives where each group was first written in the series.

Group of equations	Equations	Block of the assembled system	Source in the series
Flow with the two added terms (memory, closure), Darcy, density	(1)–(6)	flow block h, memory states h_k	base paper; reviews 42–43; synthesis
Salt (sea fraction) with immobile zones, dispersion, screen chloride	(7)–(12)	salt block c, immobile states c_k	base paper; chloride study; synthesis
The long equation: seven ions, exchange, reactions, electro-diffusion, invariants	(13)–(21)	ion block C, exchanger β	reviews 30, 42, 43; synthesis; leak note
Toe and its mobility	(22)–(25)	diagnostic X(t)	review 45 (BOUNDARY-GO); this note
Wells	(26)–(28)	controls u	complete-system note; review 60
Boundary conditions	(29)–(32)	boundary data b(t)	reviews 44–45; assimilation note
Initial conditions	(33)–(35)	initial state y_0	reviews 44–45; assimilation note
Assembly	(36)–(43)	all	this note
Final goal: placing the wells	(47)–(53)	controls u, adjoint λ	complete-system note; review 60; this note
ASSEMBLY-GO	(54)–(57)	the assembly itself	this note

INNOVATION **ASSEMBLY-GO**. The usual order is to assemble the most complete model one can and then optimise the wells on it. ASSEMBLY-GO reverses the order: the placement of recharge and pumping wells is stated first, and the adjoint of its constraint, the chloride at the supply screen, decides how the equations are assembled. One forward and one adjoint run of the complete system give the **weight** of every term for the decision. Blocks that the goal cannot see are cut exactly: the seven ions, the exchanger and the reactions (Theorem M1). Terms whose weight is below a small fraction of the chloride limit are cut, and their removal is predicted to first order. The mesh is graded by the dual-weighted residual of the goal. The error left by the cheap assembly is moved into the chance constraint as a calibrated margin, so that a layout accepted on the cheap assembly is accepted on the complete one. On the test of Section 6 the goal cut the memory of the lenses and the sea-level rise (weights at most 2.1×10^{-5}, a five-hundredth of the limit) and kept the immobile zones, dispersion, buoyancy and the same-step coupling (weights 3.0×10^{-3} to 2.6×10^{-2}); the goal-graded assembly runs a 30-year forecast 2.5 times faster than the complete assembly, ranks the 25 layouts as it does (rank correlation 0.997) and, with its calibrated margin, chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.95 m²/d per metre of coast, whose risk judged on 25 draws of the complete assembly is 8% (2 of 25; 95% interval 1–26%), against a target of 10% and a guarantee of 20%, the target plus the calibration level.

2. The equations, in one notation

The domain Ω is the aquifer between its top and its base, $\mathbf{x} = (x, y, z)$ with z the elevation (m a.s.l.) and $\mathbf{e}_z$ the upward unit vector; time t is in days unless stated. The unknowns are listed in Table 2. Sea water is described by its fraction c, computed from chloride, the reaction invariant (Section 2.3), so that the density follows a conservative tracer.

Table 2. The unknowns of the assembled system.

Symbol	Unknown	Units	Equations
h_f	equivalent freshwater head	m	(1), (3)
h_k	head of the storage compartment k of the silt and clay lenses (Markovian lift of the memory)	m	(3)
$\mathbf{q}$	Darcy flux	m/d	(4)
c	sea-water fraction from chloride	–	(7)
c_k	sea-water fraction in the immobile zone k	–	(8)
$\mathbf{c}$	concentrations of Cl, Na, K, Ca, Mg, SO_4, HCO_3 in the mobile water	meq/L	(13)
$\mathbf{c}_k$	ion concentrations in the immobile zone k	meq/L	(14)
$\boldsymbol{\beta}$	equivalent fractions of Na, K, Ca, Mg on the exchanger	–	(15)
X	position of the saltwater toe	m	(22)
$\mathbf{u}$	controls: sites, recharge rates, pumping rates and screens of the wells	m³/d	(47)
$\boldsymbol{\theta}$	uncertain parameters (conductivity, inflow, dispersivity, memory, sea level, ...)	various	(50)

2.1 Flow, with the two added terms

The classical equation of variable-density flow balances storage, the divergence of the Darcy flux and the wells [13, 14]. The series added two terms to it [2–4]: a **memory** of the silt and clay lenses, through a kernel κ_h and its tail K_h, and a **learned closure** Ψ for dynamics that are missing from the model:

$$S_s\,\partial_t h_f + \nabla\cdot\mathbf{q} = \sum_w Q_w(t)\,\delta(\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_w) \;-\; \int_{t_0}^{t} K_h(t-s)\,\partial_s h_f(\mathbf{x},s)\,ds \;+\; \Psi(h_f,\mathbf{x};\boldsymbol{\gamma}) \tag{1}$$

where S_s is the specific storage (1/m), Q_w the rate of well w at $\mathbf{x}_w$ (positive for injection), K_h the memory tail and Ψ the closure with coefficients $\boldsymbol{\gamma}$. The first added term is storage that is released late, by lenses that drain slowly; the second is everything the model leaves out, learned from data.

The memory was written in the synthesis article as a convolution of the head with a kernel κ_h. The two forms are the same, by the moment split (Lemma 1 of [4]):

$$\int_0^\infty \kappa_h(r)\,h_f(t-r)\,dr = \bar\kappa\,h_f(t) - \int_0^\infty K_h(r)\,\partial_t h_f(t-r)\,dr, \qquad \bar\kappa = \int_0^\infty \kappa_h(r)\,dr, \qquad K_h(r) = \int_r^\infty \kappa_h(u)\,du \tag{2}$$

where $\bar\kappa$ is the total weight of the kernel, an instantaneous leakage that belongs to the base condition (32), and K_h is the tail, a storage memory that acts only on changes of the head and vanishes at steady state. Equation (1) keeps the tail; the steady state of the assembled system is therefore the classical one.

For lenses that drain at rates a_k the tail is a sum of exponentials, completely monotone, and the memory has an exact Markovian lift with one head h_k per compartment, which is what is assembled:

$$K_h(r) = \sum_{k=1}^{K} s_k a_k e^{-a_k r} \quad\Rightarrow\quad \int_{t_0}^{t} K_h(t-s)\,\partial_s h_f\,ds = \sum_{k=1}^{K} s_k a_k\,(h_f - h_k), \qquad \partial_t h_k = a_k\,(h_f - h_k) \tag{3}$$

where s_k (1/m) is the storage capacity of compartment k and a_k (1/d) its rate; the compartment heads start from their legacy $h_k(t_0)$, which absorbs the term $\sum_k s_k a_k e^{-a_k(t-t_0)}(h_f(t_0) - h_k(t_0))$ of the integration by parts. In the kernel form $\kappa_h(r) = \sum_k s_k a_k^2 e^{-a_k r}$ and $\bar\kappa = \sum_k s_k a_k$ (Section 3.2 of [9]).

$$\mathbf{q} = -\mathbf{K}\left(\nabla h_f + \frac{\rho - \rho_f}{\rho_f}\mathbf{e}_z\right), \qquad \mathbf{K} = \mathrm{diag}(K, K, K_z), \qquad h_f = \frac{p}{\rho_f g} + z \tag{4}$$

where $\mathbf{K}$ is the conductivity tensor for fresh water, p the pressure and g gravity. The buoyancy term makes salty water sink and drives the wedge.

$$\rho = \rho_f(1 + \delta\, c), \qquad \delta = \frac{\rho_s - \rho_f}{\rho_f}, \qquad c = \frac{\mathrm{Cl} - \mathrm{Cl}_f}{\mathrm{Cl}_s - \mathrm{Cl}_f} \tag{5}$$

where $\delta = 0.025$ is the density contrast and Cl_f, Cl_s the chloride of fresh water (12.92 mg/L, well 193) and of Adriatic sea water (21,781 mg/L) [6]. Viscosity is constant (Boussinesq).

$$\Psi(h_f, \mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\gamma}) = \sum_{j=1}^{J} \gamma_j\, \psi_j(h_f, \mathbf{x}), \qquad \mathcal{J}(\boldsymbol{\gamma}) = \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T \left\|\dot{\mathbf{y}} - \mathbf{f}_0(\mathbf{y}) - \mathbf{m}(\mathbf{y}; \boldsymbol{\gamma})\right\|^2 dt + \mathcal{R}(\boldsymbol{\gamma}) \tag{6}$$

where ψ_j are basis functions (zone indicators, h_f, $|\nabla h_f|$), $\mathbf{f}_0$ the known model, $\mathbf{m}$ its learned correction and $\mathcal{R}$ a regulariser [9]. The closure is zero in every computed model of the series, including the test of Section 6; Section 6.2 gives where along the aquifer it would matter for the placement goal.

2.2 The salt equations

The sea-water fraction is transported with the flux of (4), dispersed by the Bear–Scheidegger tensor and exchanged with immobile zones in the silt and clay [4, 15]. In non-conservative form, which keeps c unchanged where water is released from storage:

$$n\,\partial_t c + \nabla\cdot(\mathbf{q}c) - c\,\nabla\cdot\mathbf{q} - \nabla\cdot(n\mathbf{D}\nabla c) + \sum_{k=1}^{K} n\, b_k a_k\,(c - c_k) = \sum_w Q_w^+\,\delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_w)\,(c_{\mathrm{inj},w} - c) \tag{7}$$

where n is the porosity, b_k the capacity ratio and a_k the rate of immobile zone k, Q_w^+ the injection rate of recharge well w and $c_{\mathrm{inj},w}$ the sea fraction of the water it injects (zero for fresh water). Pumping wells remove water at the resident concentration and need no term.

$$\partial_t c_k = a_k\,(c - c_k), \qquad k = 1, \ldots, K \tag{8}$$

where c_k is the sea fraction in zone k; at Fushë-Kuqe zone 1 is the silt ($a_1 \approx 1$ yr^{-1}, $b_1 = 0.3$) and zone 2 the clay ($a_2 \approx 0.05$ yr^{-1}, $b_2 = 0.6$) [3].

$$n\mathbf{D} = (nD_m + \alpha_T|\mathbf{q}|)\mathbf{I} + (\alpha_L - \alpha_T)\frac{\mathbf{q}\mathbf{q}^\top}{|\mathbf{q}|} \tag{9}$$

where D_m is the molecular diffusion and α_L, α_T the longitudinal and transverse dispersivities [16].

Eliminating the zones turns them into a memory of the salt, with its own kernel and a term for the initial disequilibrium (Proposition 1 of [4]):

$$n\left[\partial_t c + \int_{t_0}^{t} \kappa_c(s)\,\partial_t c(t-s)\,ds\right] + \nabla\cdot(\mathbf{q}c) - c\nabla\cdot\mathbf{q} - \nabla\cdot(n\mathbf{D}\nabla c) = -n\sum_k b_k a_k e^{-a_k(t-t_0)}(c(t_0) - c_k(t_0)) \tag{10}$$

where $\kappa_c(s) = \sum_k b_k a_k e^{-a_k s}$; the source terms of (7) are omitted for brevity. The clay zone, with a time constant of twenty years, holds salt behind an advancing front and releases it behind a retreating one.

What a supply well delivers is the chloride averaged over its screen, which is the quantity the drinking-water standard is applied to [6, 17]:

$$\mathrm{Cl}_w(t) = \mathrm{Cl}_f + (\mathrm{Cl}_s - \mathrm{Cl}_f)\bar{c}_w(t), \qquad \bar{c}_w(t) = \frac{1}{L_w}\int_{z_w - L_w}^{z_w} c(x_w, z, t)\,dz \tag{11}$$

where x_w is the position of the well, z_w the top of its screen and L_w the screen length.

$$\{\mathrm{Cl}_w > 250\ \mathrm{mg/L}\} = \{\bar{c}_w > \varepsilon_{\lim}\}, \qquad \varepsilon_{\lim} = \frac{250 - \mathrm{Cl}_f}{\mathrm{Cl}_s - \mathrm{Cl}_f} = 0.01089 \tag{12}$$

where $\varepsilon_{\lim}$ is the sea fraction at which the screen reaches the chloride standard: about one per cent of sea water.

2.3 The long equation: seven ions, exchange and reactions

The equation that follows the flow in the synthesis article transports the seven major ions with an exchanger in local equilibrium, the immobile zones and the reactions, plus a learned closure confined to the span of the stoichiometric matrix [4]:

$$\partial_t(\mathbf{c} + E\,\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{c})) + \sum_{k=1}^{K} b_k a_k(\mathbf{c} - \mathbf{c}_k) + \nabla\cdot(\mathbf{v}\mathbf{c}) - \nabla\cdot(\mathbf{D}\nabla\mathbf{c}) = N(\mathbf{r}(\mathbf{c}) + \mathbf{\Phi}(\mathbf{c}, \mathbf{x}, t; \vartheta)) \tag{13}$$

where $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{q}/n$, E the exchange capacity (meq per litre of pore water, median 60), $\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{c})$ the equivalent fractions on the exchanger for the cations and zero for the anions, N the stoichiometric matrix (Na–Ca, Na–Mg and K–Ca exchange, sulfate reduction, calcite), $\mathbf{r}$ the known rates and $\mathbf{\Phi}$ the learned closure.

$$\partial_t \mathbf{c}_k = a_k(\mathbf{c} - \mathbf{c}_k) + \Gamma_k\,\mathbf{c}_k \tag{14}$$

where Γ_k holds the reactions inside zone k (sulfate reduction in the clay).

$$K_{\mathrm{Na}\text{–}I} = \frac{\beta_{\mathrm{Na}}\,a_I^{1/z_I}}{\beta_I^{1/z_I}\,a_{\mathrm{Na}}}, \quad I = \mathrm{K, Ca, Mg}, \qquad \beta_{\mathrm{Na}} + \beta_{\mathrm{K}} + \beta_{\mathrm{Ca}} + \beta_{\mathrm{Mg}} = 1, \qquad \beta_{\mathrm{Na}} = \frac{2}{b_\beta + \sqrt{b_\beta^2 + 4a_\beta}} \tag{15}$$

where a_I are activities, z_I charges, the Gaines–Thomas selectivities are 0.2, 0.4 and 0.5, and $a_\beta = \left(c_{\mathrm{Ca}}/K_{\mathrm{Ca}}^2 + c_{\mathrm{Mg}}/K_{\mathrm{Mg}}^2\right)/c_{\mathrm{Na}}^2$, $b_\beta = 1 + c_{\mathrm{K}}/(K_{\mathrm{K}}c_{\mathrm{Na}})$ give the closed form [6, 18, 19].

$$\Omega = \frac{a_{\mathrm{Ca}^{2+}}\,a_{\mathrm{CO}_3^{2-}}}{K_{sp}}, \qquad r_{\mathrm{cal}} = \kappa\,g(\Omega), \qquad g(\Omega) = \begin{cases} (1-\Omega)^{n_1}, & \Omega \geq \Omega_c \\ (1-\Omega_c)^{n_1}\left(\frac{1-\Omega}{1-\Omega_c}\right)^{n_2}, & \Omega < \Omega_c \end{cases} \tag{16}$$

where Ω is the calcite saturation ratio ($\log K_{sp} = -8.43$ at 15 °C) and g a rate law with a near- and a far-from-equilibrium branch [6, 20].

$$\frac{dc_{\mathrm{SO}_4,k}}{dt} = -k_{sr}\,c_{\mathrm{SO}_4,k}, \qquad \frac{dc_{\mathrm{HCO}_3,k}}{dt} = +2k_{sr}\,c_{\mathrm{SO}_4,k}, \qquad \log_{10}\gamma_i = -0.509\,z_i^2\left(\frac{\sqrt{I}}{1+\sqrt{I}} - 0.3\,I\right) \tag{17}$$

where k_{sr} is the rate of sulfate reduction in the clay (median 0.05 yr⁻¹), and γ_i the Davies activity coefficient with ionic strength I [21].

$$\mathbf{J}_i = \mathbf{v}c_i - (\mathbf{D} + D_i)\nabla c_i - z_i D_i c_i \nabla\psi, \qquad \nabla\psi = -\frac{\sum_j z_j D_j \nabla c_j}{\sum_j z_j^2 D_j c_j}, \qquad \sum_i z_i c_i = 0 \tag{18}$$

where the electro-diffusive flux with zero electric current [22]; at Fushë-Kuqe the Péclet number is about 2.3×10^5 and the leak of a reactive error into the chloride forecast is suppressed by about 4×10^{-6} (Theorem 2 of [23]).

$$\mathbf{u} = W^{\top}\mathbf{c}, \quad W^{\top}N = 0; \qquad f = \frac{\mathrm{Cl} - \mathrm{Cl}_f}{\mathrm{Cl}_s - \mathrm{Cl}_f}, \quad \Delta X = X_{\mathrm{obs}} - [X_f + f(X_s - X_f)] = (N\boldsymbol{\xi})_X \tag{19}$$

$$\mathrm{BEX} = \mathrm{Na} + \mathrm{K} + \mathrm{Mg} - 1.0716\,\mathrm{Cl} \tag{20}$$

where the reaction invariants obey (13) without reactions; for these ions and reactions they are chloride and the charge balance, so chloride, hence c and the density, are free of every reaction and of the closure $\mathbf{\Phi}$ (Proposition H1 of [6]). f, ΔX and BEX are the field indicators of mixing, reaction extents and base exchange [24].

$$\frac{dq_j}{dt} = \frac{1}{\tau_j}\left(\frac{Q_j f}{f + h_j} - q_j\right), \qquad \Phi_j = \frac{dq_j}{dt}\min\left(1, \frac{c_{\iota(j)}}{c_{\iota(j)}^{\mathrm{mix}}(f)}\right) \tag{21}$$

where the learned exchanger of TRACE-GO, one example of the closure $\mathbf{\Phi}$: the loading q_j of exchanger j relaxes toward a learned equilibrium with the sea fraction f [2, 4].

2.4 The toe and its mobility

The toe is where the wedge of sea water meets the base of the aquifer. In the assembled system it is not a separate unknown but a functional of the salt field, the landward end of the half-sea-water line on the base:

$$X(t) = \sup\left\{ x : \; c(x, z_b, t) \geq \frac{1}{2} \right\} \tag{22}$$

where z_b is the elevation of the base. Where the base is not flat, c is taken on the base surface.

Its mobility follows from the salt equation by the implicit-function theorem: on the line $c = 1/2$ the total change of c along the moving toe is zero, so

$$\frac{dX}{dt} = - \left. \frac{\partial_t c}{\partial_x c} \right|_{(X(t),\, z_b,\, t)} \tag{23}$$

where $\partial_t c$ is given by (7): the toe moves with the salt field, landward when the wedge gains salt at its tip and seaward when it loses it. This is exact and is what the assembled system computes.

Two reduced forms of the toe mobility are used for screening and for the boundary budget of review 45. The sharp-interface equilibrium of a confined aquifer with a seaward fresh flux q_s per metre of coast [16, 25], and a first-order relaxation toward it:

$$X_{\mathrm{eq}} = \frac{K\, \delta\, B^2}{2\, q_s}, \qquad q_s = q_{\mathrm{in}} + \sum_r q_r - \sum_w Q_w, \qquad \frac{dX}{dt} = \frac{X_{\mathrm{eq}}(\mathbf{u}(t)) - X}{\tau_X} \tag{24}$$

where B is the thickness, q_{in} the regional fresh inflow and q_r, Q_w the recharge and pumping landward of the toe; τ_X is the time the wedge takes to adjust, lengthened by the immobile zones by up to the factor $1 + \sum_k b_k$. BOUNDARY-GO used the linearised form $dX/dt = (-\gamma\, h(0.5\ \mathrm{km}) - X)/\tau_X$ with $\gamma = 1{,}000$ m per m of head and $\tau_X = 8$ yr [7]; Section 6.5 calibrates the relaxation law on the assembled system.

The toe is not what a supply well cares about. In the sharp-interface wedge the fresh water above the interface thickens landward as $B\sqrt{x/X}$, so a screen in the top L_w metres at x_w meets sea water only when

$$X \;\geq\; x_w \left(\frac{B}{L_w} \right)^2 \tag{25}$$

where which for the screens of Section 6 ($B = 60$ m, $L_w = 20$ m) asks the toe to lie nine times as far inland as the well. In the dispersive, pumped aquifer the mixing zone and the upconing below the well bring the standard much earlier; the toe is a late and indirect indicator of the event that matters, which is why the goal of Section 4 is the screen chloride (11) and not the toe.

2.5 Wells

$$\sum_w Q_w(t)\, \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_w) \;\rightarrow\; \sum_w Q_w(t)\, \frac{\ell_w(z)}{L_w}\, \delta(x - x_w)\delta(y - y_w) \tag{26}$$

where each well is a line source over its screen, distributed by the length $\ell_w(z)$ open in each layer (by transmissivity where layers differ); supply wells have $Q_w < 0$ over the top of the aquifer, recharge wells $Q_w = q_r > 0$ over the full thickness.

$$h_{\mathrm{well}} = h_{\mathrm{cell}} + \frac{Q_w}{2\pi T} \ln \frac{r_e}{r_w}, \qquad r_e \approx 0.2\, \Delta x; \qquad c = c_{\mathrm{inj}},\ \mathbf{c} = \mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{inj}} \text{ at recharge wells} \tag{27}$$

where the head inside the well from the cell head (Peaceman [26]), needed when a drawdown limit is written for the well; injected water carries the composition of the recharge source (well 193) [6].

$$\mathbf{u} = (\mathbf{z}^R, \mathbf{z}^S, \mathbf{q}, \mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{L}), \qquad \sum_{k \in \mathcal{C}_R} z_k^R\, q_k\, \rho_\varepsilon(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_k), \quad z_k^R \in \{0,1\} \;\rightarrow\; [0,1] \tag{28}$$

where $\mathbf{z}^R$, $\mathbf{z}^S$ are the site indicators of recharge and supply wells over the candidate sets $\mathcal{C}_R$, $\mathcal{C}_S$, $\mathbf{q}$ and $\mathbf{Q}$ the rates, $\mathbf{L}$ the screens, and ρ_ε a smoothed source used when the indicators are relaxed to intensities for gradient-based placement [12].

2.6 Boundary conditions

The boundary is split into the sea face, the top (recharge, rivers, drains), the land margins and the base, with the wells inside [6–8]:

$$h_f = \frac{\rho_s}{\rho_f}\eta(t) - \delta z \quad \text{on } \Gamma_{\text{sea}}, \qquad \eta(t) = \eta_0 + \dot{\eta}\, t + \sum_j A_j \cos(\omega_j t - \varphi_j) + \eta_{\text{surge}}(t) + \eta_{\text{ia}}(t) \tag{29}$$

where hydrostatic sea water in equivalent freshwater head; the sea level has a mean, a rise, tides, surges and interannual anomalies. In the areal models the sea is linked through a conductance (the Robin condition (32) of [6]).

$$c = 1,\ \mathbf{c} = \mathbf{c}_{\text{sea}} \ \text{ where } \mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} < 0, \qquad (n\mathbf{D}\nabla c)\cdot\mathbf{n} = 0 \ \text{ where } \mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} \geq 0 \qquad \text{on } \Gamma_{\text{sea}} \tag{30}$$

where the sea face switches with the direction of flow, for the salt and for every ion; $\mathbf{n}$ is the outward normal.

$$\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = -q_{\text{in}} \text{ or } 0, \quad c = 0,\ \mathbf{c} = \mathbf{c}_{193} \ \text{ on } \Gamma_{\text{in}}; \qquad nZ_r\frac{ds}{dt} = P - E(s) - L(s), \quad -\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = R = L(s) \ \text{ on } \Gamma_{\text{top}} \tag{31}$$

where the land margins receive the regional fresh inflow or are closed; recharge is the drainage of a root-zone water balance with soil memory (moisture s, root depth Z_r, rainfall P, evaporation E) [7].

$$q_r = C_r(h_r(t) - \max(h_f, z_b)), \qquad q_d = C_d(h_f - z_d)_+, \qquad -\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = \bar{\kappa}(h_f - h_{\text{base}}) + \int_{t_0}^{t} K_h(t-s)\,\partial_s h_f\, ds \ \text{ on } \Gamma_{\text{base}} \tag{32}$$

where rivers and drains as Robin conditions, and a leaky base whose leakage follows the moment split (2): the instantaneous part $\bar{\kappa}$ and the memory tail.

2.7 Initial conditions

$$h_f(\cdot, t_0) = h_0, \quad h_k(\cdot, t_0) = h_{k,0}, \quad c(\cdot, t_0) = c_0, \quad c_k(\cdot, t_0) = c_{k,0}, \quad \mathbf{c}(\cdot, t_0) = \mathbf{c}_0, \quad \boldsymbol{\beta}(\cdot, t_0) = \boldsymbol{\beta}_{\text{eq}}(\mathbf{c}_0) \tag{33}$$

where every state of the assembled system needs an initial value; the memory states $h_{k,0}$, $c_{k,0}$ are the legacy of the lenses and the immobile zones.

$$h_0 = \frac{\rho_s}{\rho_f}\eta(t_0) - \delta z \quad \text{on } \Gamma_{\text{sea}}, \qquad \sum_i z_i c_{0,i} = 0, \qquad \sum_I \beta_{0,I} = 1, \qquad \partial_t g(\cdot, t_0) = (f - \mathcal{A}u_0)(\cdot, t_0) \ \text{ on } \partial\Omega \tag{34}$$

where compatibility of the boundary and initial data of order 0 and 1, charge balance and the closure of the exchanger [8].

$$\mathbf{y}(t_0) = \Phi_{t_0 \leftarrow t_{\text{dev}}}(\mathbf{y}_{\text{ss}};\ \text{pumping record}) \qquad \text{or} \qquad p(\mathbf{y}(t_0) \mid \mathbf{d}_{0:T}) \propto p(\mathbf{y}(t_0)) \prod_k p(\mathbf{d}_k \mid \mathbf{y}(t_k)) \tag{35}$$

where the present state is either the pre-development equilibrium $\mathbf{y}_{\text{ss}}$ carried forward through the pumping record by the assembled system itself (Φ is its flow map; this note), or the analysis of the data $\mathbf{d}$ by a smoother [9]. In either case the memory states are not in equilibrium at t_0.

3. The assembly

3.1 The state and the discrete operators

After discretisation in space by finite volumes on N cells, every field becomes a vector of cell values and every memory a set of local states. The assembled state is

$$\mathbf{y} = (\mathbf{h},\ \mathbf{h}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{h}_K,\ \mathbf{c},\ \mathbf{c}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{c}_K,\ \mathbf{C},\ \mathbf{C}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{C}_K,\ \boldsymbol{\beta}), \qquad \dim \mathbf{y} = N(2 + 2K + 7(1+K) + 4) \tag{36}$$

where $\mathbf{h}$, $\mathbf{c}$ are the heads and sea fractions of the cells, $\mathbf{h}_k$, $\mathbf{c}_k$ the memory states, $\mathbf{C}$ the $N \times 7$ array of ion concentrations and $\boldsymbol{\beta}$ the $N \times 4$ exchanger fractions. With $K = 2$ there are 31 unknowns per cell; the Fushë-Kuqe grid of 5,589 active cells with 20 layers would carry about 3.5 million unknowns. The toe X is a functional of $\mathbf{c}$, not a state.

On every face f between the cells f^- and f^+ (in the direction of increasing x or z), with area A_f, distance d_f and conductance $T_f = K_f A_f / d_f$, the flux and the salt flux are

$$Q_f = -T_f(h_{f^+} - h_{f^-}) - [f \text{ vertical}]\, T_f\, d_f\, \delta\, \frac{c_{f^+} + c_{f^-}}{2}, \qquad F_f = Q_f\, c_{\uparrow f} - \frac{(n\mathbf{D})_f A_f}{d_f}(c_{f^+} - c_{f^-}) \tag{37}$$

where $c_{\uparrow f}$ is the upwind value (the sea value 1 on a sea face with inflow) and $(n\mathbf{D})_f = nD_m + \left(\alpha_L q_n^2 + \alpha_T q_t^2\right)/|\mathbf{q}|$ the normal dispersion, with q_n the normal flux of the face and q_t the mean of the four perpendicular fluxes of its two cells. In matrix form $\mathbf{Q} = G_h\mathbf{h} + G_c\mathbf{c} + \mathbf{g}_0(t)$, where $\mathbf{g}_0$ carries the sea level and the regional inflow; Div sums the outward fluxes of each cell, U selects the upwind cell and Grad takes differences across faces.

3.2 The assembled system

Written block by block, with $M_S = \mathrm{diag}(S_s V)$, $M_n = \mathrm{diag}(nV)$, S_k, B_k the diagonal capacities and $A_k = a_k I$ the rates of the memory states, V the cell volumes and $\mathbf{W}$, $\mathbf{W}^+$ the well sources (net and injection), the semi-discrete system is

$$M_S\,\dot{\mathbf{h}} = -\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{Q}(\mathbf{h},\mathbf{c},t) - \sum_k S_k A_k(\mathbf{h}-\mathbf{h}_k) + \mathbf{W}(\mathbf{u}) + V\Psi(\mathbf{h};\boldsymbol{\gamma}), \qquad \dot{\mathbf{h}}_k = A_k(\mathbf{h}-\mathbf{h}_k) \tag{38}$$

$$M_n\dot{\mathbf{c}} = -\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{Q},\mathbf{c}) + \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{c})\,\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{Q} - \sum_k M_n B_k A_k(\mathbf{c}-\mathbf{c}_k) - \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{W}^+)(\mathbf{c}-\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{inj}}) \tag{39}$$

where with $\dot{\mathbf{c}}_k = A_k(\mathbf{c}-\mathbf{c}_k)$ for the immobile zones.

$$M_n\frac{d}{dt}(\mathbf{C} + E\,\mathbf{S}(\boldsymbol{\beta})) = -\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{Q},\mathbf{C}) + \mathrm{diag}(\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{Q})\,\mathbf{C} - \sum_k M_n B_k A_k(\mathbf{C}-\mathbf{C}_k) + M_n N(\mathbf{r}+\boldsymbol{\Phi}) \tag{40}$$

where the third block is the long equation (13) with the same flux operator, $\mathbf{S}(\boldsymbol{\beta})$ places the exchanger fractions on the cations, and the algebraic constraint $\mathbf{0} = \mathbf{g}_{\mathrm{ex}}(\mathbf{C},\boldsymbol{\beta})$ is the Gaines–Thomas equilibrium (15) in every cell; the immobile ion states follow (14).

Collected, the assembly is a differential-algebraic system of index one (the exchanger fractions are fixed by the solution through the closed form of (15)):

$$\mathcal{M}\,\dot{\mathbf{y}} = \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{y};\boldsymbol{\theta},\mathbf{b}(t),\mathbf{u}(t)), \qquad \mathbf{0} = \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{y}), \qquad \mathbf{y}(t_0) = \mathbf{y}_0 \tag{41}$$

where $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ are the uncertain parameters, $\mathbf{b}(t)$ the boundary data of Section 2.6, $\mathbf{u}(t)$ the controls of Section 2.5 and $\mathbf{y}_0$ the present state (35).

3.3 Time stepping and the block Jacobian

Implicit Euler (or a Radau IIA method whose stage equations are generated from the same weak form [27]) turns (41) into one nonlinear system per step:

$$\mathbf{R}_n(\mathbf{y}_n,\mathbf{y}_{n-1},\mathbf{z}_{n-1};\mathbf{u}_n) = \mathcal{M}\,\frac{\mathbf{y}_n-\mathbf{y}_{n-1}}{\Delta t} - \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{y}_n) = \mathbf{0} \tag{42}$$

where $\mathbf{z}$ collects the local memory states, which are eliminated exactly in every cell:

$$\mathbf{h}_k^n = \alpha_k\mathbf{h}_k^{n-1} + (1-\alpha_k)\mathbf{h}^n, \quad \alpha_k = \frac{1}{1+a_k\Delta t} \quad\Rightarrow\quad S_kA_k\left(\mathbf{h}^n-\mathbf{h}_k^n\right) = S_kA_k\,\alpha_k\left(\mathbf{h}^n-\mathbf{h}_k^{n-1}\right) \tag{43}$$

where and likewise for $\mathbf{c}_k$: the memory becomes a diagonal storage term and a source from the previous step, so it adds nothing to the size of the system that is solved.

The Jacobian of (42) has the block structure that decides how the system can be solved:

$$J_n = \frac{\partial\mathbf{R}_n}{\partial\mathbf{y}_n} = \begin{pmatrix} J_{hh} & J_{hc} & 0 & 0 \\ J_{ch} & J_{cc} & 0 & 0 \\ J_{Ch} & J_{Cc} & J_{CC} & J_{C\beta} \\ 0 & 0 & J_{\beta C} & J_{\beta\beta} \end{pmatrix} \tag{44}$$

where with the flow–salt block

$$J_{hh} = \frac{M_S}{\Delta t} + \sum_k S_kA_k\alpha_k + \mathrm{Div}\,G_h, \quad J_{hc} = \mathrm{Div}\,G_c, \quad J_{ch} = \mathrm{Div}\,\mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{c}_\uparrow)G_h - \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{c})\,\mathrm{Div}\,G_h \tag{45}$$

$$J_{cc} = \frac{M_n}{\Delta t} + \sum_k M_nB_kA_k\alpha_k + \mathrm{Div}[\mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{Q})\,U + \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{c}_\uparrow)G_c - \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{d})\mathrm{Grad}]$$

$$-\mathrm{diag}(\mathrm{Div}\,\mathbf{Q}) - \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{c})\,\mathrm{Div}\,G_c + \mathrm{diag}(\mathbf{W}^+) \tag{46}$$

where $\mathbf{c}_\uparrow$ is $U\mathbf{c}$ plus the sea inflow values, $d_f = (n\mathbf{D})_f A_f / d_f$. The dispersion coefficients are taken from the fluxes of the previous step, so the step also depends on $\mathbf{y}_{n-1}$ through them; that dependence enters the adjoint of Section 4.4. The test assembles these blocks exactly; Newton then converges quadratically (largest residuals 7×10^{-1}, 2×10^{-2}, 2×10^{-3}, 6×10^{-6}, 2×10^{-11}, 1×10^{-13} in one half-year step), which is the check that the blocks are right.

Proposition A1 (the order of the blocks). In the assembled system (38)–(40) the only two-way coupling between blocks is between flow and salt: the flux depends on the salt through the density, and the salt on the flow through the flux. The ion block, the exchanger, the reactions, the closure $\mathbf{\Phi}$ and the toe are driven by $(\mathbf{h}, \mathbf{c})$ and feed nothing back, apart from electro-diffusion, which couples the ions back to chloride at a relative order of 4×10^{-6} at Fushë-Kuqe. The Jacobian (44) is therefore block lower-triangular below the 2×2 flow–salt block.

Proof. The density (5) depends on c, which is computed from chloride, and chloride is a reaction invariant (Proposition H1 of [6]), so neither the reactions nor $\mathbf{\Phi}$, which lies in the span of N, nor the exchanger enter the flow or the salt equations. The flux (4) depends on (h_f, c) only; the ion equations depend on $\mathbf{Q}$ and on the ions; the exchanger on the ions; the toe (22) on c. Hence $\partial\mathbf{R}_h/\partial(\mathbf{C}, \boldsymbol{\beta}) = 0$ and $\partial\mathbf{R}_c/\partial(\mathbf{C}, \boldsymbol{\beta}) = 0$. The electro-diffusive coupling (18) is the exception, bounded by Theorem 2 of [23]. □

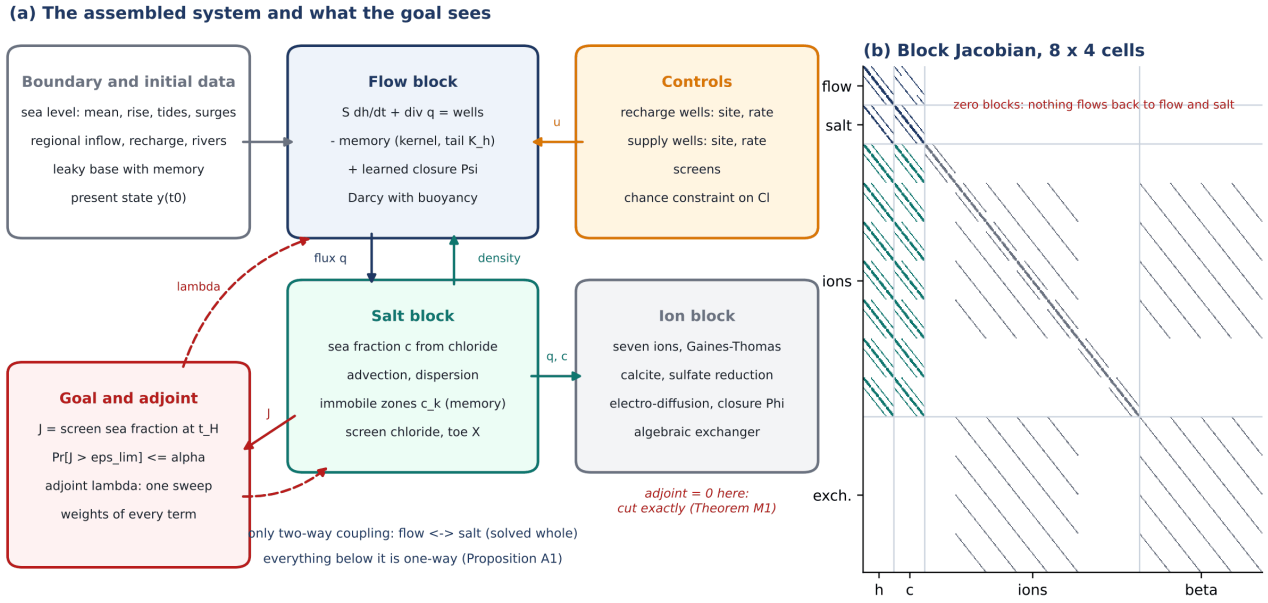


Figure 1. (a) The assembled system: boundary and initial data and the controls drive the flow block; flow and salt are coupled both ways (flux and density); the ion block is driven by them and feeds nothing back; the goal, the chloride at the supply screen, sends its adjoint back into the flow and salt blocks only. (b) The pattern of the assembled Jacobian (44) on a grid of 8 × 4 cells: flow–salt block (dark), ion and exchanger blocks (grey) below it, and the empty blocks above them that make the system block lower-triangular (Proposition A1). *Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.*

3.4 Two clocks, and why the flow–salt block is solved whole

Heads diffuse with $D_h = T/S \approx 2\times10^7$ m²/d and feel a pumping change kilometres away within a day; salt moves kilometres in decades. The ratio of the two clocks is about 10^{-5} [4], which suggests solving the flow and the salt one after the other, with the density lagged by a step. The test shows that this split, though consistent, is not harmless for the goal. Picard iteration between the two blocks did not converge at half-year steps (the change of the sea fraction between successive iterations grew from 6×10^{-2} after the first to 3×10^{-1} after thirty), while Newton on the whole block converged quadratically. The one-pass split approached the coupled value of the screen sea fraction only as the step was cut: it was 24%, 16%, 10%, 2% below the coupled value at steps of 1, 0.5, 0.25, 0.125 years, while the coupled value itself changed by at most 0.7% over the same steps. The flow–salt block is therefore solved whole, as in the monolithic solvers of [28, 29], and Section 5 lets the goal confirm that choice.

3.5 The reductions of the series as cuts of the assembly

Table 3. The models computed in the series are cuts of the assembled system. ASSEMBLY-GO chooses the cut by the goal instead of by habit.

Model of the series	Blocks kept	Blocks cut or frozen	Exact for
R1: areal steady flow with the Ghyben–Herzberg test [1]	flow (steady, depth-integrated)	salt, memory, ions; interface from the head	head-based questions at steady pumping
R2: Strack potential with a Gaussian mixing zone [5]	flow (steady), sharp interface + mixing width	salt transport, memory, ions	steady screen chloride, threshold form of P1–P2 [6]
R3: vertical variable-density section (this test, Section 6)	flow, salt, memory, immobile zones, ions	the third dimension	transients of a cross-section
R4: seven-ion flow line [2, 3]	salt, ions, exchange, memory	flow (prescribed velocity history)	chemistry along a flow path
Toe relaxation law (24) [7]	one ODE for X	everything else	the toe, slowly varying forcing

4. The final goal: placing recharge and pumping wells

4.1 Decisions, goal and constraint

The decision is where to put recharge wells and supply wells, how much to inject and pump and how to screen, within the constraints of the series (spacing, exclusion around supply wells, budget; (50) of [6]):

$$\mathbf{u} = (\mathbf{z}^R, \mathbf{z}^S, \mathbf{q}, \mathbf{Q}, \mathbf{L}) \in \mathcal{U}, \qquad \mathcal{U} = \left\{ |\mathbf{x}_k - \mathbf{x}_l| \geq d_{\min}\,,\ |\mathbf{x}_r - \mathbf{x}_w| \geq d_{\mathrm{ex}},\ \sum_j c_j z_j \leq \mathcal{B} \right\} \tag{47}$$

where $\mathbf{z}^R$, $\mathbf{z}^S$ are binary site indicators over the candidate sets, $\mathbf{q}$, $\mathbf{Q}$ the recharge and pumping rates and $\mathbf{L}$ the screens; c_j are costs and $\mathcal{B}$ the budget.

The goal of every supply well is the screen chloride (11) at the end of the planning horizon t_H; following WELL-GO [6], chloride is the standard that binds, and sodium is checked afterwards (Proposition P3 there):

$$J_w(\mathbf{u};\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \bar{c}_w(t_H;\mathbf{u},\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \mathbf{w}_w^{\top}\mathbf{c}(t_H), \qquad \text{event} \quad \max_w J_w > \varepsilon_{\lim} \tag{48}$$

where $\mathbf{w}_w$ averages the cell values over the screen of well w (interpolated linearly to x_w, so that every grid computes the same functional).

$$\max_{\mathbf{u}\in\mathcal{U}} \sum_w v(x_w) Q_w - \lambda_R \sum_r q_r \quad \text{s.t.} \quad \Pr_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}\left[\max_w J_w(\mathbf{u};\boldsymbol{\theta}) > \varepsilon_{\lim}\right] \leq \alpha, \quad \mathcal{M}\dot{\mathbf{y}} = \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{y};\boldsymbol{\theta},\mathbf{b},\mathbf{u}), \quad \boldsymbol{\theta} = \mathbf{g}(\mathbf{y}) \tag{49}$$

where $v(x_w)$ is the value of a cubic metre pumped at x_w, net of conveyance to the demand at the coast, and λ_R the price of recharged water. The problem is mixed-integer (the sites), chance-constrained (the posterior of $\boldsymbol{\theta}$) and constrained by the assembled system [30–32]. At scale it can be solved with learned constraints inside a mixed-integer program [33], learned neighbourhood search [34] or Bayesian optimisation over mixed spaces [35], with the sites fixed first and the rates as recourse [36]; with a few candidate sites, as in the test, it is enumerated.

$$\frac{1}{N_\theta}\sum_{i=1}^{N_\theta} \mathbf{1}\left\{\max_w J_w(\mathbf{u};\boldsymbol{\theta}_i) > \varepsilon_{\lim}\right\} \leq \alpha \tag{50}$$

where the sample-average form over N_θ posterior draws, which is what is solved.

Proposition G1 (the safe yield of a layout is a quantile). Fix the sites and the recharge of a layout ℓ and let $J(\ell, Q;\boldsymbol{\theta})$ be nondecreasing in the pumping Q for every $\boldsymbol{\theta}$. Define the critical rate $Q_c(\ell;\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \sup\{Q \geq 0 : J(\ell, Q;\boldsymbol{\theta}) \leq \varepsilon_{\lim}\}$. Then the largest Q that satisfies (50) is the order statistic

$$Q^\star(\ell) = Q_{c,(m)}(\ell), \qquad m = \lfloor \alpha N_\theta \rfloor + 1 \tag{51}$$

where the m-th smallest of the critical rates of the draws, and the placement problem becomes a choice among layouts of the value $v\,Q^\star(\ell) - \lambda_R q(\ell)$.

Proof. By monotonicity $J(\ell, Q; \boldsymbol{\theta}_i) > \varepsilon_{\lim}$ if and only if $Q > Q_c(\ell; \boldsymbol{\theta}_i)$, so the left side of (50) is the fraction of draws with $Q_c < Q$; it is at most α exactly for $Q \le Q_{c,(m)}$. □

Monotonicity holds in every run of the test (more pumping never freshened a screen within the horizon). It reduces the chance constraint to one root-finding per draw and layout, each a few forward runs of the assembled system.

Remark G2 (on the draws and beyond them). Constraint (50) holds on the draws used. For a new draw exchangeable with them, and without ties, the probability that its critical rate falls below Q_c,(m) is m/(N_θ + 1): 3/26 = 11.5% for N_θ = 25 and α = 10%, slightly above α. Taking m = ⌊α(N_θ + 1)⌋ instead keeps it at most α (2/26 = 7.7% here). A statement that holds with high probability, rather than on average over the draws, needs a binomial bound and more draws.

4.2 The adjoint of the assembled system

Gradients of the goal with respect to every rate and every candidate site, and the weights of Section 5, come from one backward sweep. With $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_n$ the adjoint of step n and $\boldsymbol{\mu}_n$ that of the memory states,

$$J_n^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_n = \delta_{n,N_t}\frac{\partial J}{\partial \mathbf{y}_{N_t}}^{\top} - \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{R}_{n+1}}{\partial \mathbf{y}_n}\right)^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{n+1} + B^{\top}\boldsymbol{\mu}_n, \qquad \boldsymbol{\mu}_{n-1} = \alpha\,\boldsymbol{\mu}_n - \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{R}_n}{\partial \mathbf{z}_{n-1}}\right)^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_n \tag{52}$$

where for $n = N_t, \dots, 1$ with $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{N_t+1} = 0$, $\boldsymbol{\mu}_{N_t} = 0$; B and α are the diagonal maps of (43); a last solve with the Jacobian of the pre-development equilibrium carries the adjoint into the initial state. $\partial \mathbf{R}_{n+1}/\partial \mathbf{y}_n$ contains the storage and the dependence of the dispersion coefficients on the previous fluxes.

$$\frac{dJ}{dp} = -\sum_n \boldsymbol{\lambda}_n^{\top}\frac{\partial \mathbf{R}_n}{\partial p}, \qquad \frac{dJ}{dQ_w} = -\sum_n \boldsymbol{\lambda}_{h,n}^{\top}\mathbf{e}_w, \qquad \frac{dJ}{dq_r(x)} = \sum_n (\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{h,n} - \operatorname{diag}(\mathbf{c}_n)\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{c,n})^{\top}\mathbf{e}_r(x) \tag{53}$$

where $\mathbf{e}_w$, $\mathbf{e}_r(x)$ distribute a unit pumping over the supply screen and a unit injection over the full thickness at the candidate x; one sweep gives the sensitivity of the goal to a recharge well at every column of the grid. In the test the adjoint gradients agree with central differences of the complete assembly to 8 significant digits for the pumping rate and for the recharge rate (supply well at 2.0 km, recharge well at 1.0 km, step 10^{-5}). At a layout where the net seaward flux past the supply well nearly vanishes they agree to 0.3%: there some face fluxes change direction under the perturbation, and the upwind goal is only piecewise differentiable.

5. ASSEMBLY-GO: an assembly set by the placement goal

The assembled system of Section 3 is large, and the placement problem of Section 4 asks for it thousands of times: one root-finding per layout and posterior draw, each a few forecasts. Review 60 proposed to let the goal decide the assembly [12]. Four results make this concrete. The first is exact, the second and third are first-order, and the fourth moves what is left into the constraint.

Theorem M1 (exact cuts). Let the goal J depend only on the flow and salt states $(\mathbf{h}, \mathbf{c})$, as the screen chloride (48) does, and let the assembled Jacobians be block lower-triangular below the flow–salt block (Proposition A1). Then at every step the adjoint vanishes on every downstream block, $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{C,n} = \mathbf{0}$ and $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_{\beta,n} = \mathbf{0}$. Consequently (i) J and its gradient with respect to every control are the same whether or not the ions, the exchanger, the reactions and the closure $\boldsymbol{\Phi}$ are assembled; (ii) the weight (54) of every parameter inside those blocks (selectivities, exchange capacity, reaction rates, closure coefficients) is zero; (iii) with electro-diffusion, (i) and (ii) hold up to the relative order of the leak bound, 4×10^{-6} at Fushë-Kuqe [23].

Proof. In the adjoint recursion (52) the right-hand side has no downstream component at $n = N_t$, because J does not depend on $(\mathbf{C}, \boldsymbol{\beta})$. The transposed Jacobian $J_n^{\top}$ is block upper-triangular, so its downstream rows read $J_{CC}^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_C + J_{\beta C}^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_\beta = \mathbf{r}_C$ and $J_{C\beta}^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_C + J_{\beta\beta}^{\top}\boldsymbol{\lambda}_\beta = \mathbf{r}_\beta$, with an invertible diagonal block (the ion transport operator and the exchange equilibrium of index one). With $\mathbf{r}_C = \mathbf{r}_\beta = \mathbf{0}$ the only solution is zero. The cross-step Jacobian $\partial \mathbf{R}_{n+1}/\partial \mathbf{y}_n$ has the same triangular structure, so the downstream right-hand side stays zero at every earlier step, by induction backwards. Statement (i) follows because the flow–salt rows of the forward system do not contain the downstream unknowns. Statement (ii) follows because a parameter p of a downstream block has $\partial \mathbf{R}_n/\partial p$ supported on downstream rows only, so $\boldsymbol{\lambda}_n^{\top}\partial \mathbf{R}_n/\partial p = 0$. Statement (iii) follows from the perturbation bound of [23]. □

The theorem is the reason the series could put a learned chemistry closure into the model without touching the chloride forecast (the "cut" of [4, 23]), here turned into a rule of assembly: for a chloride goal the ion block is computed once, after the decision, to check sodium and hardness for the chosen layout (Proposition P3 of [6]).

Proposition M2 (the goal weight of a term). Give every term T of the assembly a scale s_T, with $s_T = 1$ for the term as assembled and $s_T = 0$ for the term removed; for the coupling, let s_T interpolate between the same-step density and the density of the previous step. The weight of T for the goal, and the first-order change of the goal when T is removed, are

$$w_T = \left.\frac{dJ}{ds_T}\right|_{s_T=1} = -\sum_n \boldsymbol{\lambda}_n^{\top} \frac{\partial \mathbf{R}_n}{\partial s_T}, \qquad J|_{s_T=0} - J|_{s_T=1} = -w_T + O\left(\|\Delta \mathbf{y}\|^2\right) \tag{54}$$

where with one forward and one adjoint run of the complete assembly for all terms at once. The rule of assembly is

$$\text{cut } T \Leftrightarrow \max_{\text{reference cases}} |w_T| < \tau\, \varepsilon_{\text{lim}} \tag{55}$$

where with τ a small fraction (here 2%, i.e. $|w_T| < 2.2 \times 10^{-4}$, about 5 mg/L of chloride at the screen). The weight is the derivative with respect to the scale of the term, not the residual difference at a fixed state: removing the sea-level rise at a fixed state shifts the heads of the sea face by tens of centimetres and reverses inflow and outflow there, while the actual change of the goal is nil because the whole head field rises with the sea.

Proof. J is a function of s_T through the solution of $\mathbf{R}_n(\mathbf{y}; s_T) = \mathbf{0}$; differentiating the constraints and using (52) gives $dJ/ds_T = -\sum_n \boldsymbol{\lambda}_n^{\top} \partial \mathbf{R}_n / \partial s_T$ [37, 38]. Taylor's theorem in s_T gives the remainder. □

Proposition M3 (a mesh graded by the goal). Let $\mathbf{y}_H$ be the solution of the assembly on a coarse mesh and $I\mathbf{y}_H$ its interpolation to the complete mesh h. The dual-weighted residual estimates the error of the goal and gives a cell-wise indicator [39]:

$$J_h(I\mathbf{y}_H) - J_h(\mathbf{y}_h) \approx \sum_n \boldsymbol{\lambda}_n^{\top} \mathbf{R}_n(I\mathbf{y}_H), \qquad \eta_j = \sum_n \sum_{i \in \text{column } j} \left|\lambda_{n,i}\, R_{n,i}(I\mathbf{y}_H)\right| \tag{56}$$

where the column indicator η_j is summed over the reference cases. The goal-graded mesh equidistributes $(\eta_j/\Delta x_j)^{1/3}$ over the same number of columns as the uniform coarse mesh, with a cap on the widest column.

The estimate itself is only first order and, for a goal that sits in the tail of a sharp front, it was not reliable in the test (Section 6.3); learned conservative fluxes are one way to keep such fronts sharp on coarse cells [40]. ASSEMBLY-GO therefore uses the indicator only to rank where the mesh matters, and does not rely on the estimate; the remaining error is calibrated by Proposition M4.

Proposition M4 (the error of the cheap assembly moves into the constraint). Let A be the cheap assembly and F the complete one. Draw C calibration cases $(\ell_i, \boldsymbol{\theta}_i)$ like the decision cases, compute $r_i = Q_c^A(\ell_i; \boldsymbol{\theta}_i) - Q_c^F(\ell_i; \boldsymbol{\theta}_i)$, and let m_β be the $\lceil (1-\beta)(C+1) \rceil$-th smallest r_i. Solve the placement on A with the critical rates lowered by m_β:

$$Q_{A,\beta}^{\star}(\ell) = \left[Q_{c,(m)}^{A}(\ell) - m_\beta\right]_+, \qquad \Pr\left[J_F\left(\ell, Q_{A,\beta}^{\star}(\ell); \boldsymbol{\theta}\right) > \varepsilon_{\text{lim}}\right] \le \alpha + \beta \tag{57}$$

where for a new draw $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ exchangeable with the calibration cases, up to the sampling error of the draws.

Proof. If the case is exchangeable with the calibration cases, $\Pr[r > m_\beta] \le \beta$ by the rank argument of split conformal prediction [41, 42]. On $\{r \le m_\beta\}$ we have $Q_c^F \ge Q_c^A - m_\beta$, so exceeding the standard on F at $Q_{A,\beta}^{\star}$ implies $Q_c^A - m_\beta < Q_{A,\beta}^{\star}$, i.e. $Q_c^A < Q_{c,(m)}^A$, which has probability at most α (Proposition G1). A union bound gives $\alpha + \beta$. □

The procedure. (1) Choose a few reference cases: layouts at their critical rates on the complete assembly. (2) For each, one forward and one adjoint run of the complete assembly give the weights of all terms, the gradients with respect to every rate and every recharge site, and the mesh indicator. (3) Cut the downstream blocks (Theorem M1) and the terms below the tolerance; keep the rest; grade the mesh. (4) Run C calibration cases on both assemblies and compute the margin. (5) Solve the placement on the cheap assembly with the margin. (6) Run the complete assembly, ions included, once for the chosen layout: chloride against the margin, sodium and hardness against Proposition P3 of [6]. The cheap assembly can be replaced or completed by a neural-operator surrogate trained on runs of the assembly [43, 44], or differentiated end to end for gradient-based placement [45]; the margin of

Proposition M4 applies to either, and the decision should then be operated and revalidated as in field practice for injection wells [46].

6. The test

6.1 The aquifer, the history and the decision

The test assembles the system on a vertical section of a confined coastal aquifer, the reduction R3 of Table 3. It is 4 km long and 60 m thick, its top is 10 m below sea level, and it has silt and clay lenses with hydraulic memory, immobile zones, and the ion block with exchange. The parameters are those of Fushë-Kuqe where the series has them (Table 4). The present state is made as at the field site, where the coastal screens salinised under pumping [47]: from the pre-development equilibrium, 50 years of pumping 4 m²/d per metre of coast from a well field 1.5 km from the coast. At the end of the history its screen delivers 364 mg/L of chloride in the median aquifer and the toe has moved from 349 m to 1070 m. The decision is where to put the new supply well (2.0, 2.5, 3.0 or 3.5 km from the coast), where to put one recharge well injecting 1 m²/d of fresh water (none, 0.5, 1.0, 1.5 km, the old well field, 2.0, 2.5 or 3.0 km), and how much to pump, so that the probability that the supply screen exceeds 250 mg/L at the end of a 30-year horizon is at most 10%: 25 layouts.

Table 4. The test bed. ξ denotes independent standard normal variables.

Quantity	Value or prior	Source
Grid of the complete assembly	120 × 20 cells (33 m × 3 m); half-year steps	this note
Conductivity K, anisotropy, porosity	$100\,e^{0.25\xi}$ m/d (T ≈ 4,700–7,700 m²/d), $K_z/K = 0.1$, $n = 0.25$	complete-system note, Table 2
Specific storage; lens capacities and rates	5×10^{-6} 1/m; $s_k = 2 \times 10^{-5}$, 5×10^{-5} 1/m; $a_k = 1$, 0.05 yr⁻¹	reviews 43–45 (rates); this note
Immobile zones	$b_1 = 0.3$, $b_2 \sim \mathcal{U}(0.3,0.9)$; $a_1 = 1$, $a_2 = 0.05$ yr⁻¹	RHYTHM-GO
Dispersivities	$\alpha_L = 20\,e^{0.4\xi}$ m, $\alpha_T = \alpha_L/10$	chloride study (10 m, 1 m) widened
Regional fresh inflow	$4\,e^{0.2\xi}$ m²/d per metre of coast	recharge 0.5 mm/d over about 8 km
Sea-level rise	$\mathcal{N}(4,2^2)$ mm/yr	BOUNDARY-GO
Density contrast; end-members; standards	0.025; well 193 and Adriatic water; Cl 250, Na 200 mg/L	complete-system note
Exchange	E = 60 meq/L; selectivities 0.2, 0.4, 0.5	TRACE-GO
Draws	25 design draws (the cheap assemblies choose; 10 for the two counter-examples), 25 evaluation draws (the complete assembly judges) and 40 calibration cases for the margin (16 for the counter-examples)	this note

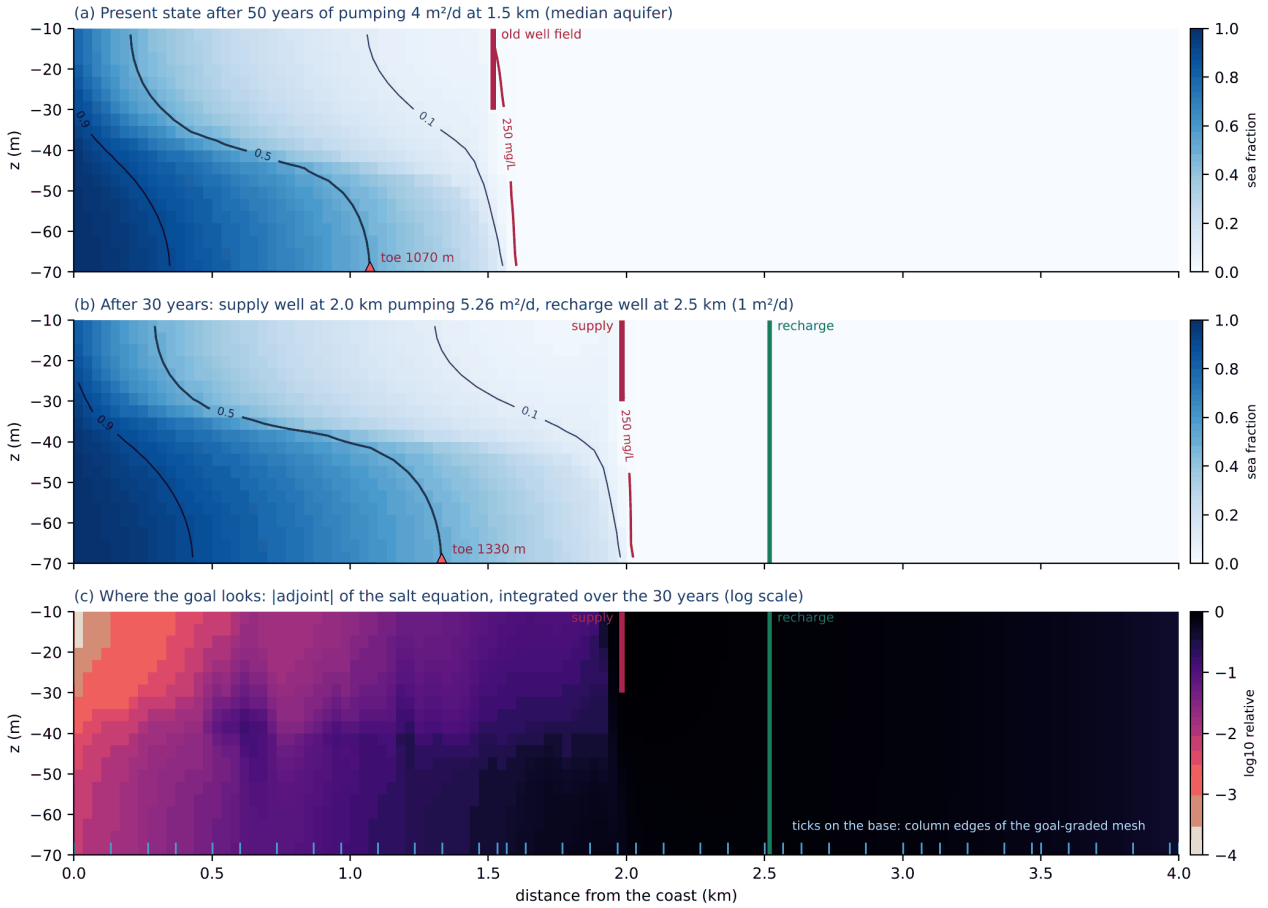


Figure 2. The test bed with the median parameters. (a) The present state after the 50-year history: the old screen at 1.5 km delivers 364 mg/L of chloride; the toe (triangle) is at 1070 m, against 349 m before development. (b) Thirty years later with a supply well at 2.0 km pumping 5.26 m²/d per metre of coast, its critical rate, and a recharge well at 2.5 km; the red line is the 250 mg/L contour, which touches the bottom of the screen; the toe has moved to 1330 m. (c) Where the goal looks: the adjoint of the salt equation for the screen chloride, integrated over the 30 years. The ticks on the base are the column edges of the goal-graded mesh.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

6.2 What the goal kept and what it cut

Table 5 and Figure 3 give the weights of the eight terms at four reference cases, each a layout at its critical rate on the complete assembly, so that the screen sits exactly at 250 mg/L: S2.0-R2.5, S2.5, S3.0-R1.5, S3.5-R1.0 (S: supply well, R: recharge well, km from the coast). One forward and one adjoint run of the complete assembly took 11 s and about 4 s per case. The hydraulic memory of the lenses and the sea-level rise weigh at most 2.1×10^{-5}, a five-hundredth of the limit. The lenses release stored water slowly, but at these capacities they change the head at the screen by millimetres. The rise lifts the whole head field with the sea and moves almost no water. The rule cut all three; removing them changed the goal by at most 2.1×10^{-5}, as predicted to within 25%, and to within 1% in three of the four cases. The immobile zones, transverse dispersion and buoyancy weigh 6.3×10^{-3} to 2.6×10^{-2}, between half and twice the limit itself: they set the width and the speed of the mixing zone that reaches the screen. A 10% reduction of the immobile capacities or of the transverse dispersivity was predicted to within 8%. The same-step coupling weighs 3.0×10^{-3} to 6.6×10^{-3} and was kept. For this term the first-order number only says that it matters: the goal is not monotone in the lag (it rose by 5.5×10^{-5} for 1% of lag and by 7.5×10^{-4} for 20% in a separate check), and the full one-pass split moved it by -4.3×10^{-3} to -1.9×10^{-3}, in the opposite direction to the first-order value.

Table 5. Goal weights w_T of (54) over the four reference cases (sea fraction at the screen per unit scale of the term; the limit is $\varepsilon_{\lim} = 0.0109$ and the tolerance $\tau\varepsilon_{\lim} = 2.2 \times 10^{-4}$). Check: the change of the goal predicted from the weight against the change computed by running the complete assembly without the term (cut terms), with the term reduced by 10% (kept terms), or with the one-pass split.

Term	Weight w_T (range over 4 cases)	Check: predicted / actual change	Decision
Hydraulic memory, silt lenses	6.6×10⁻⁷ – 9.6×10⁻⁶	removed: 9.6×10⁻⁶ / 9.6×10⁻⁶ (largest)	cut
Hydraulic memory, clay lenses	7.8×10⁻⁶ – 2.1×10⁻⁵	removed: 2.1×10⁻⁵ / 2.1×10⁻⁵ (largest)	cut
Immobile zone, silt	6.3×10⁻³ – 1.4×10⁻²	−10%: 6.3×10⁻⁴ / 6.2×10⁻⁴ (first case)	kept
Immobile zone, clay	1.0×10⁻² – 1.2×10⁻²	−10%: 1.1×10⁻³ / 1.1×10⁻³ (first case)	kept
Transverse dispersion	7.5×10⁻³ – 1.3×10⁻²	−10%: 1.3×10⁻³ / 1.4×10⁻³ (first case)	kept
Sea-level rise	3.6×10⁻⁶ – 6.8×10⁻⁶	removed: 6.8×10⁻⁶ / 7.7×10⁻⁶ (largest)	cut
Buoyancy (density coupling)	9.8×10⁻³ – 2.6×10⁻²	δ −10%: -2.6×10⁻³ / -3.8×10⁻³ (first case; δ also enters the sea face)	kept
Same-step flow–salt coupling	3.0×10⁻³ – 6.6×10⁻³	one-pass split: -3.0×10⁻³… / -4.3×10⁻³ to -1.9×10⁻³	kept

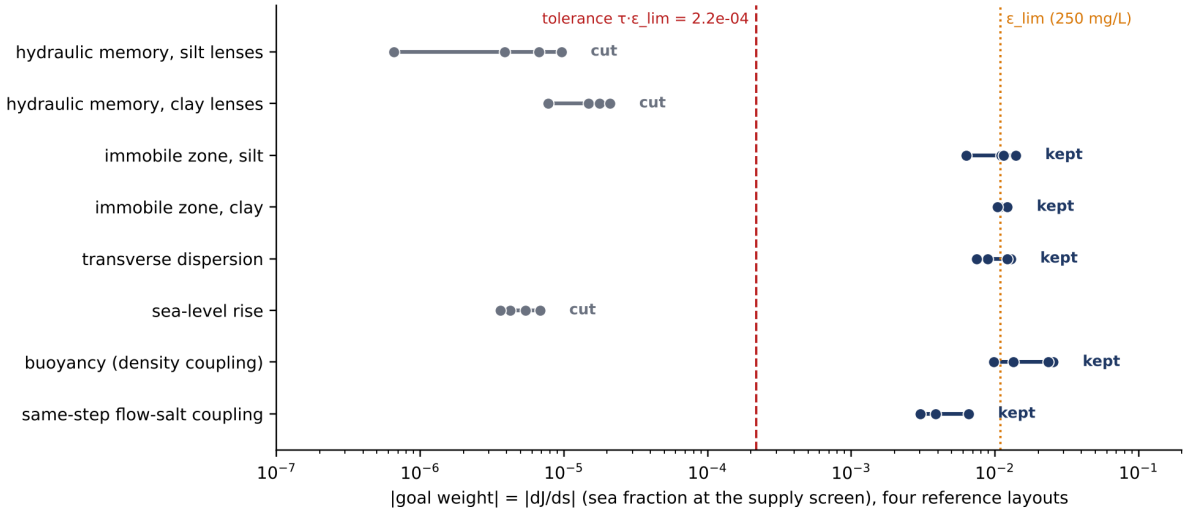


Figure 3. The goal weights of every term of the assembly, four reference layouts (dots). Grey terms lie three orders of magnitude below the tolerance (dashed) and are cut; dark terms lie near the limit itself (dotted) and are kept. The ion block is not shown: its weight is zero by Theorem M1.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

The learned closure Ψ is zero in the test, but its weight shows where dynamics missing from the model would matter for the decision. A missing source equal to 10 mm/yr of recharge spread over a 500-m band changes the screen sea fraction by at most 2.8×10⁻⁵ in the band at the coast and by up to 7.6×10⁻⁴ (7% of the limit) in the bands landward of the supply well, where every litre of fresh water passes the well. The closure, and the data that identify it, are therefore worth most for the inland water balance, not at the coast.

6.3 The mesh

The indicator (56), summed over the four reference cases, is largest where the supply screens draw water through the mixing zone (Figure 2c). The goal-graded mesh puts columns of 33–67 m at the candidate supply sites and at the old well field and columns of 100–133 m elsewhere (39 columns; the uniform coarse mesh has 40 columns of 100 m). Table 6 compares, on the four reference cases and eight further cases with random layouts and draws, the error of each coarse assembly in the goal with its dual-weighted estimate. Both coarse meshes overestimate the screen sea fraction, because a coarse cell smears the mixing zone upward. The goal-graded mesh does so on every case by 6.0×10⁻³ to 1.3×10⁻², and its estimate has the right sign and order on every case (ratio of estimate to error 0.40–0.87). The uniform mesh errs by anywhere between 2.4×10⁻³ and 1.8×10⁻², depending on where the

supply well falls relative to its columns, and its estimate has the wrong sign in 6 of 12 cases. The goal-graded mesh is therefore not always the more accurate, but its error is the more **predictable**, which is what Proposition M4 needs.

Table 6. Error of the coarse assemblies in the goal (screen sea fraction, limit 0.0109) at the critical rate of the complete assembly, against the dual-weighted-residual estimate (56). Uniform: 40 columns of 100 m; goal-graded: 39 columns of 33–133 m. Same physics as the complete assembly.

Case	True error, uniform	Estimate, uniform	True error, goal-graded	Estimate, goal-graded
reference: S2.0-R2.5, Q = 5.26	2.36×10^{-3}	-2.02×10^{-2}	1.28×10^{-2}	5.32×10^{-3}
reference: S2.5, Q = 5.12	1.53×10^{-2}	8.45×10^{-3}	1.05×10^{-2}	6.08×10^{-3}
reference: S3.0-R1.5, Q = 6.20	1.21×10^{-2}	1.06×10^{-2}	9.04×10^{-3}	7.84×10^{-3}
reference: S3.5-R1.0, Q = 6.74	2.69×10^{-3}	-4.65×10^{-3}	5.98×10^{-3}	4.63×10^{-3}
random: S3.5-R2.0, Q = 10.28	3.99×10^{-3}	-2.42×10^{-3}	8.43×10^{-3}	6.22×10^{-3}
random: S3.5-R1.0, Q = 9.02	2.77×10^{-3}	-3.93×10^{-3}	7.39×10^{-3}	5.76×10^{-3}
random: S2.0-R3.0, Q = 3.84	3.47×10^{-3}	-1.67×10^{-2}	1.11×10^{-2}	4.48×10^{-3}
random: S3.5, Q = 6.62	3.49×10^{-3}	-4.51×10^{-3}	7.48×10^{-3}	5.85×10^{-3}
random: S3.0, Q = 4.46	1.20×10^{-2}	1.11×10^{-2}	8.11×10^{-3}	6.95×10^{-3}
random: S2.5-R3.0, Q = 7.21	1.81×10^{-2}	8.09×10^{-3}	1.28×10^{-2}	7.18×10^{-3}
random: S3.0-R0.5, Q = 3.95	1.13×10^{-2}	9.92×10^{-3}	7.03×10^{-3}	5.23×10^{-3}
random: S3.0-R2.5, Q = 6.94	1.04×10^{-2}	9.88×10^{-3}	8.16×10^{-3}	6.23×10^{-3}

6.4 Placing the wells

Every assembly solves the placement problem (49) the same way. For each of the 25 layouts and each draw it finds the critical rate by a bracketed secant on the logarithm of the goal (Proposition G1; 5.5 forecasts per root on average). It takes the safe yield as the order statistic (51) at $\alpha = 10\%$, and chooses the layout of largest value $v(x_s)Q^\star - \lambda_R q_r$. The value counts water at the supply well less 0.2 per km of conveyance beyond 2 km, and recharged water at 0.5 of its value. The complete assembly does this on 25 evaluation draws and acts as the referee. The cheap assemblies do it on separate design draws (25 for the goal-guided and uniform assemblies, 10 for the two counter-examples), with and without the calibrated margin of Proposition M4 estimated from 40 calibration cases (16 for the two counter-examples). The full assembly needed 15 minutes per draw for all layouts.

Table 7. The placement on each assembly. Layout chosen by the value $v(x_s)Q^\star - \lambda_R q_r$ with $v = 1 - 0.2\,(x_s - 2\ \mathrm{km})/\mathrm{km}$ and $\lambda_R = 0.5$; safe rate in m² per day per metre of coast; risk: fraction of the 25 evaluation draws of the complete assembly on which the screen exceeds 250 mg/L at that layout and rate (target 10%; 1 of 25 draws is 4%, 95% interval 0.1–20%, and 2 of 25 is 8%, 1–26%; guarantee 10% + β with β = 10%). Cost: median wall time of one 30-year forecast.

Assembly	Layout chosen	Safe rate (m²/d)	Risk on the complete assembly	Cost of one forecast
Complete assembly (referee, 25 evaluation draws)	S3.5-R3.0	6.36	≤ 10% on its own 25 draws; 11.5% expected on a new draw (Remark G2)	3.9 s
goal-guided (ASSEMBLY-GO), 25 design draws, no margin	S3.5-R3.0	5.80	4%	1.6 s (2.5× faster)
… with calibrated margin m = −0.15 m²/d	S3.5-R3.0	5.95	8%	
uniform coarse mesh, same terms, 25 design draws, no margin	S3.5-R3.0	5.90	4%	1.7 s (2.3× faster)
… with calibrated margin m = −0.08 m²/d	S3.5-R3.0	5.98	8%	
goal mesh, density lagged one step, 10 design draws, no margin	S2.5-R3.0	5.16	20%	0.2 s (17.8× faster)
… with calibrated margin m = −0.001 m²/d	S2.5-R3.0	5.16	20%	

Assembly	Layout chosen	Safe rate (m²/d)	Risk on the complete assembly	Cost of one forecast
goal mesh, immobile zones removed, 10 design draws, no margin	S2.5-R3.0	4.39	4%	1.8 s (2.3× faster)
… with calibrated margin m = −0.38 m²/d	S2.5-R3.0	4.77	8%	

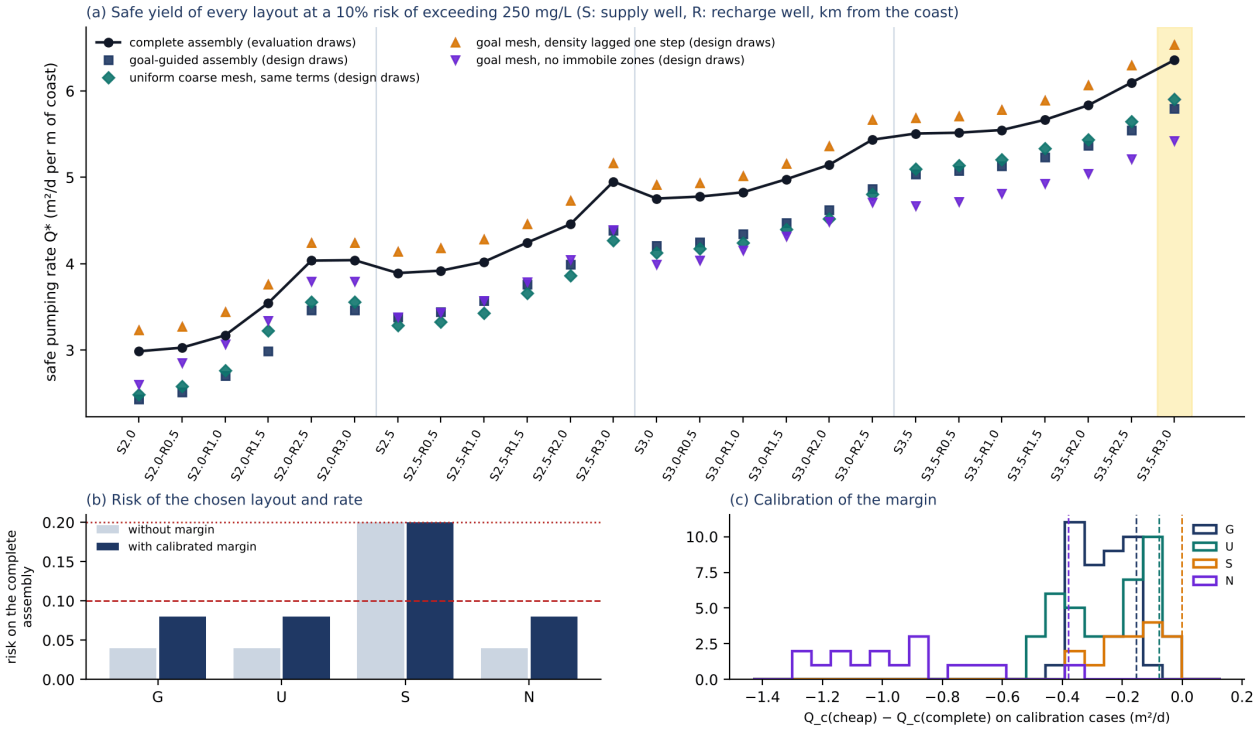


Figure 4. (a) Safe pumping rate $Q^\star$ of every layout on the complete assembly (black, evaluation draws) and on the cheap assemblies (design draws, no margin); the layout chosen by the complete assembly is shaded. (b) Risk of the layout and rate each cheap assembly chooses, judged on the complete assembly, without and with the calibrated margin; dashed: $\alpha = 10\%$, dotted: $\alpha + \beta$. (c) Calibration residuals $Q_c^{\text{cheap}} - Q_c^{\text{complete}}$ and the margins (dashed). *Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.*

Both coarse assemblies are conservative: they overestimate the screen sea fraction (Table 6), so their safe rates lie below those of the complete assembly at 25 and 25 of the 25 layouts, by 0.51 m²/d on average for the goal-guided assembly and 0.51 m²/d for the uniform one. Yet they rank the 25 layouts almost exactly as the complete assembly does (rank correlation 0.997 and 0.999). Without a margin the goal-guided assembly chooses safely but gives water away. It chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.80 m²/d, with a risk of 4% on the complete assembly; the complete assembly would allow 6.36 m²/d at that layout. The calibrated margins are negative: −0.15 m²/d for the goal-guided and −0.08 m²/d for the uniform assembly. A negative margin returns the water that the conservative bias withholds, and the guarantee of Proposition M4 still holds. With its margin the goal-guided assembly chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.95 m²/d, with a risk of 8% on the complete assembly. The uniform assembly chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.98 m²/d, with a risk of 8%. These risks rest on 25 evaluation draws: 1 of 25 (4%) has a 95% interval of 0.1–20% and 2 of 25 (8%) of 1–26%. They show that no assembly fails badly, not that the 10% target is met; the guarantee of Proposition M4 is 10% + β = 20%, and a few hundred evaluation draws of the chosen layouts would be needed to show the target itself. The complete assembly itself chooses the supply well at 3.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 6.36 m²/d. The goal-guided assembly chooses the complete assembly's own best layout. Over conveyance prices from 0 to 0.4 per km, the goal-guided assembly with its margin chooses the complete assembly's layout for 4 of 5 prices and loses at most 0.1% of the value elsewhere. The two counter-examples remove a term the goal kept, on the same 10 design draws, so they can be compared with each other. Lagging the density one step (S) removes the conservative bias of the goal mesh: the 90% calibration residual is

−0.001 m²/d against −0.15 for the goal-guided assembly, so the lag raises the critical rates by about 0.15 m²/d, in the direction of the one-pass split error of Section 3.4. With nothing left to cover the sampling error of 10 draws, its choice, the supply well at 2.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km at 5.16 m²/d, exceeds the standard in 20% of the evaluation draws of the complete assembly, 2.0 times the risk allowed, with or without its margin. Without the immobile zones (N) the assembly is conservative by at least 0.38 m²/d in nine calibration cases of ten; that covers the same sampling error (risk 4% without the margin, 8% with it), but it chooses the supply well at 2.5 km and recharge well at 3.0 km and gives up 0.7% of the value. Part of both risks comes from having only 10 design draws; the difference between the two, on the same draws, is the effect of the term removed. One 30-year forecast took 3.9 s on the complete assembly and 1.6 s on the goal-guided one, 2.5 times less; the whole placement (all layouts, all draws) took 6.1 CPU-hours on the complete assembly and 1.9 on the goal-guided one.

6.5 The toe

The toe moves as (23) says, and the relaxation law (24) describes it. Fitted to each of the 75 forecasts of the complete assembly (three layouts at their safe rates, 25 evaluation draws), with the head at mid-depth 0.5 km from the coast as the driver, it reproduces the toe over 30 years with a median largest error of 1.2 and 0.8 m for 2 of the 3 layouts, and of 20 m for the layout where the toe hardly moves (median displacement 4 m), so that there is little to fit. The median relaxation time is 7–12 years and the median γ is 556–1191 m per m of head (BOUNDARY-GO assumed 8 years and 1,000 m). As a proxy for the goal the toe does better here than the sharp-interface picture suggests: a threshold on the toe position, tuned to flag as many aquifers as actually exceed 250 mg/L at the screen, catches 6 of the 7 exceedances of the three layouts. With 7 events this is thin evidence, and the toe explains only part of the variation of the screen sea fraction (correlation 0.51–0.67). The inequality (25) says why the toe cannot replace the screen: the screen meets sea water through the mixing zone and the upconing below the well, long before a sharp-interface toe would reach nine times the distance of the well, so a toe criterion must be calibrated against the screen, layout by layout.

6.6 The ions, computed once

For the first reference layout at its critical rate, the complete assembly was run again with the seven-ion block and Gaines–Thomas exchange (E = 60 meq/L) through the whole history and forecast. The goal was identical to the last digit, as Theorem M1 says. The chloride computed by the ion block agrees with the chloride of the salt block within 3.0×10^{-3} mg/L. The ion block cost 1 s of the 13 s of that run (11%). The check it is kept for is sodium. At the screen it is 125 mg/L at the end of the horizon, when chloride is 250 mg/L: below 200 mg/L, as Proposition P3 of [6] predicts for intrusion with sodium taken up by the exchanger. Hardness at the screen is 6.30 meq/L against 3.65 for the recharge water. Behind the recharge well, 100 m landward at mid-depth, the water carries 18 mg/L of sodium and 13 mg/L of chloride.

6.7 One adjoint ranks the recharge sites

The adjoint sweep of each reference case also gives the sensitivity of the screen chloride to a small recharge well at every column (53). Ranking the candidate recharge sites by this marginal value, from one forward and one adjoint run, and comparing with the ranking by the safe yield of the complete assembly with a 1 m²/d recharge well at each site (25 draws and some 685 forecasts per supply site), the rank correlation is 0.90, 1.00, 1.00, 1.00 for the supply wells at 2.0, 2.5, 3.0, 3.5 km, and the best site is the same in 3 of 4 cases. The adjoint puts the largest marginal value of recharge landward of the supply well in 2 of 4 cases.

7. For Fushë-Kuqe: the recipe

- **Assemble flow and salt as one block**, solved by Newton with the exact Jacobian; at Fushë-Kuqe the density coupling and the immobile zones of the silt and clay are not optional for a chloride goal (weights near the limit itself), while the hydraulic memory of the lenses can wait until a goal on heads or on the clay piezometers needs it.
- **State the goal before the model**: the chloride in the screens of the supply wells of the Gorre–Fushë-Kuqe field at the planning horizon, with the risk α the utility accepts. One forward and one

adjoint run of the complete three-dimensional system at a few reference layouts then give the weights of every term and the sensitivity to recharge at every candidate site.

- **Cut the chemistry for the decision, not for the check**: the seven ions, the exchanger and the learned chemistry closure do not change the chloride goal (Theorem M1) and are run once for the chosen layout, to check sodium (Proposition P3 of the complete-system note) and the softened water behind recharge wells.
- **Calibrate the cheap model against the complete one** with a few dozen paired runs and put the margin into the chance constraint; a coarse model that is consistently conservative gets its water back, one whose error changes sign does not.
- **Rank the candidate recharge sites by one adjoint run** before running any placement; on the test it agreed with the complete placement in 3 of 4 cases.
- **Watch the placed wells with an alarm built for the new pumping**: a head-based chloride alarm learned before the decision is valid after it only if the decision is corrected through the recorded pumping and an unrecorded change of climate is certified [48].
- **Measure what the weights point to**: the inland water balance, which carries the largest weight of a missing source, and chloride profiles through the transition zone near the supply screens, which set the mixing width that decides the standard.

8. The system at a glance

Table 8. The assembled system at a glance, and what the placement goal needs of each block.

Block	Equations	Assembled in the test	For the chloride goal
Flow with storage and wells	(1), (4), (26)	yes (monolithic with salt)	kept
Memory of the lenses (kernel, tail, lift)	(2), (3)	yes	cut (weight below 2×10^{-5})
Learned closure Ψ	(6)	zero	sensitivity mapped (Section 6.2)
Density and buoyancy	(5)	yes	kept
Salt with immobile zones and dispersion	(7)–(10)	yes	kept
Screen chloride and the standard	(11), (12)	yes (the goal)	goal
Seven ions, exchange, reactions, Φ	(13)–(21)	yes, once (Section 6.6)	cut exactly (Theorem M1); checked after
Electro-diffusion	(18)	no	cut (leak bound 4×10^{-6})
Toe and its mobility	(22)–(25)	diagnostic	not a goal (Section 6.5)
Sea boundary, sea-level rise, tides	(29), (30)	hydrostatic sea, rise	rise cut for this horizon (weight below 10^{-5})
Land, recharge, rivers, base	(31), (32)	regional inflow; closed top and base	kept (inflow); others not in the test
Initial state	(33)–(35)	pre-development + 50-year history	kept
Placement problem and adjoint	(47)–(53)	yes	the final goal

Prepared on 27 October 2026 from the code and results of the ASSEMBLY-GO experiment in the author's repository (stages 0–5 and the analysis); every number about the test is read from the results of the ASSEMBLY-GO experiment and checked when the document is built. The references of other authors were checked against Crossref, the Official Journal or library catalogues (the eleven formerly marked "not verified" on 8 November 2026); the notes of the author's series ([2]–[12], [22], [23], [48], [51]) are unpublished and available from the author.

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PART 5

Theory note: BEYOND-GO, the boundary where the model is cut

The boundary condition the flow equation is missing: a learnable boundary where the model is cut, four propositions with proofs and six numerical checks. Preparatory work of the NPD's team, November 2026.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part
The learned boundary closes the environment of the agent of Part 7 at the inland cut, so the agent is trained on the aquifer beyond the model as well; its positive memory keeps every training episode physical.

BEYOND-GO: the boundary condition the flow equation is missing

A transparent, learnable boundary for the coastal-aquifer flow equation: which term to add where the model is cut, why it must be passive, how few compartments it needs and when two piezometers can learn it. Four propositions with proofs and six numerical checks

Dulian Zeqiraj · November 2026 · theory note with numerical checks · follows the assembly note (ASSEMBLY-GO) and its flow equation with two added terms

1. Outcome

• **The question.** The flow equation of the series carries two added terms: the memory of the silt and clay lenses and a learned closure Ψ [D1, eq. (1)]. Where the model is cut inland, its boundary is a prescribed inflow or a closed margin [D1, eq. (31)]. MODFLOW offers a fixed head, a prescribed flux or a general-head boundary (GHB) [17]. None of them responds to pumping or to the sea the way the aquifer beyond the cut does. Which term should be added so that the boundary is the true one, and can a neural network learn it?

• **The term (Proposition 1).** For every linear, confined exterior (heterogeneous, leaky or closed, of any shape), the exact boundary is a conductance plus a completely monotone memory: $\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = Cu + \sum_m w_m(u - y_m)$ with $\partial_t y_m = \mu_m(u - y_m)$ and $C, w_m, \mu_m \geq 0$. It is the lens memory of [D1] moved onto the boundary. Conversely, every such network is the exact boundary of some physical exterior. With the 80 compartments of the test exterior the cut model reproduces the full aquifer to 1.3×10^{-13} m.

• **Stable by construction (Proposition 2).** With $C, w_m \geq 0$ the model loses energy whatever the rest of it is. A negative conductance $C = -0.02c$ that passes a 2 km test makes a 6 km model grow without bound.

• **Few compartments (Proposition 3).** Compartments much slower or faster than the band of interest collapse into a conductance and a boundary storage. Six compartments give 7.8 mm root-mean-square error at the boundary cell over 20 years, against 147.9 mm for the best calibrated GHB (19 times less); twelve give 0.44 mm.

• **What two piezometers can learn (Proposition 4).** Two piezometers between the closure and the cut learn the boundary apart from everything else in the model, but only on the band of periods that the pumping excites. Varied pumping with 2 mm noise gives a 1.3% error in the band and predicts a drought with doubled pumping, never seen in the data, to 6.1 mm (calibrated GHB: 372 mm). A closure inside the band corrupts the boundary (47.4% error).

• **Where the neural network goes.** The network belongs in the forcing (the inflow from rain), in a monotone conductance and in a learned prior on the boundary (the "neural regularizer"), not inside the operator. Trained on 400 simulated exteriors, the prior cuts the error where the data are silent by 3.9–4.4 times. It improves every prediction, even when built on a wrong geology.

• **Sea-level rise (N6).** Over 20 years of a 0.5 m rise, the fresh water that does not reach the sea depends on the inland boundary by a factor of 9.4. The prescribed inflow of [D1] gives 49 m³ per metre of coast, the truth 154 and BEYOND-GO with six compartments 160. The cut of sea-level rise in [D1] was therefore a property of its boundary, as [D1] suspected, not of the aquifer.

Innovation: BEYOND-GO. A boundary condition that learns what lies beyond the model. Its hypothesis class is exactly the class of linear passive exteriors: a conductance plus positive first-order compartments, on a fixed logarithmic grid of time scales. Every member of the class is a physical exterior, and every linear exterior is a member. The learned boundary therefore cannot be unphysical, cannot destabilise the model and loses nothing in generality.

Three further steps are new for coastal aquifers. (i) A rule for where a neural network may enter (the forcing and monotone conductances) and where it may not (the storages). (ii) An identifiability result that separates the boundary from the closure Ψ with two piezometers and makes the pumping schedule the experiment that reveals the boundary. (iii) A prior learned from simulated geology that fills the periods the data cannot reach.

Transparent boundaries built from sums of exponentials are classical for waves [1–5]. Passive rational equivalents of an external network are standard in power systems [8, 9]. Positive multi-exponential memories are standard for mass transfer [14] and for head time series [15, 16]. The step taken here is to use the structure theorem as the hypothesis class of a learned boundary inside the flow equation, with its passivity, identifiability and design consequences.

2. The flow equation, the cut and the missing term

2.1 The equation with its two added terms

The assembly note writes the flow of the coastal aquifer as [D1, eq. (1)]

$$S_s\,\partial_t h_f + \nabla\cdot\mathbf{q} = \sum_w Q_w(t)\,\delta(\mathbf{x}-\mathbf{x}_w) - \int_{t_0}^{t} K_h(t-s)\,\partial_s h_f(\mathbf{x},s)\,ds + \Psi(h_f,\mathbf{x};\gamma) \quad \text{in } \Omega \tag{1}$$

where S_s is the specific storage, h_f the freshwater head, $\mathbf{q}$ the Darcy flux and Q_w the well rates. The first added term is the memory of the lenses. Its tail $K_h(r)=\sum_k s_k a_k e^{-a_k r}$ is completely monotone and has an exact Markovian lift: one head h_k per compartment, with $\partial_t h_k = a_k(h_f - h_k)$ [D1, eq. (3)]. The second added term is the learned closure Ψ. Both act inside the domain Ω. This note is about the edge of Ω.

2.2 The boundary at the cut

A model of a coastal aquifer ends somewhere inland, at a cut Γ that geology does not mark. The assembly note treats the land margins as receiving a prescribed regional inflow or as closed, $\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = -q_{in}$ or 0 [D1, eq. (31)]. In its test, sea-level rise was cut because the inland boundary of the section fixes the fresh inflow, so the whole head field rises with the sea and almost no water moves [D1]. The other classical choices are a fixed head and a general-head boundary $\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = C\big(h_f - \overline{h}\big)$ [17].

The aquifer beyond the cut (the exterior) acts on Ω only through the flux across Γ. If the exterior is linear, that flux is its own forcing plus a linear, causal response to the history of the head on Γ:

$$\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n} = -q_{in}(t) + \mathcal{Z}\big[h_f - \overline{h}\big](t) \quad \text{on } \Gamma \tag{2}$$

where $q_{in}(t)$ is the inflow that would enter if the head on Γ stayed at a reference $\overline{h}$, and $\mathcal{Z}$ is the response of the exterior: a Dirichlet-to-Neumann map with memory. The three classical boundaries are special cases: $\mathcal{Z}=0$ is the prescribed inflow, $\mathcal{Z}[u]=Cu$ is the GHB and $C\to\infty$ is the fixed

head. None of them has memory, and the exterior always has it, because its storage fills and drains over its own time scales. The test exterior of Section 9 has time scales up to 7.2 years.

2.3 The term to add: BEYOND-GO

The response is written as a conductance plus a positive memory of the changes of the head:

$$\mathcal{Z}_\theta[u](t) = C\,u(t) + \int_{t_0}^{t} K_\Gamma(t-s)\,\partial_s u(s)\,ds, \qquad K_\Gamma(r) = \sum_{m=1}^{M} w_m\, e^{-\mu_m r}, \qquad u = h_f - \bar{h} \tag{3}$$

with $C \geq 0$, $w_m \geq 0$ and $\mu_m > 0$. Exactly as for the lenses, the memory has a Markovian lift, one state per compartment:

$$\mathcal{Z}_\theta[u] = C\,u + \sum_{m=1}^{M} w_m (u - y_m), \qquad \partial_t y_m = \mu_m (u - y_m), \qquad y_m(t_0) = y_{m,0} \tag{4}$$

Here y_m is the head of compartment m, w_m its conductance, $\sigma_m = w_m/\mu_m$ its storage and $1/\mu_m$ its time scale. C is the steady conductance from the cut to the fixed heads of the exterior (rivers, lakes, a leaky base). The initial values $y_{m,0}$ are the legacy of the exterior, like $h_k(t_0)$ for the lenses. An exterior at rest at t_0 has $y_{m,0} = u(t_0)$, and then (4) equals the convolution form (3). In the assembled semi-discrete system [D1, eq. (38)] the boundary adds one term to the head equation and M states per boundary cell, of the same kind as the lens states:

$$M_S\,\dot{\mathbf{h}} = \ldots - P_\Gamma^{\top} A_\Gamma \Big[C\,\mathbf{u} + \sum_m w_m (\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{y}_m) - \mathbf{q}_{in} \Big], \qquad \dot{\mathbf{y}}_m = \mu_m (\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{y}_m), \qquad \mathbf{u} = P_\Gamma \mathbf{h} - \bar{h} \tag{5}$$

where the dots stand for the right side of (38) of [D1], P_Γ picks the cells on Γ and A_Γ holds their face areas. Figure 1 shows the construction. The rest of the note shows that the form (3)–(4) is exact (Section 3), stable (Section 4), cheap (Section 5) and learnable (Section 6), and where a neural network fits into it (Section 7).

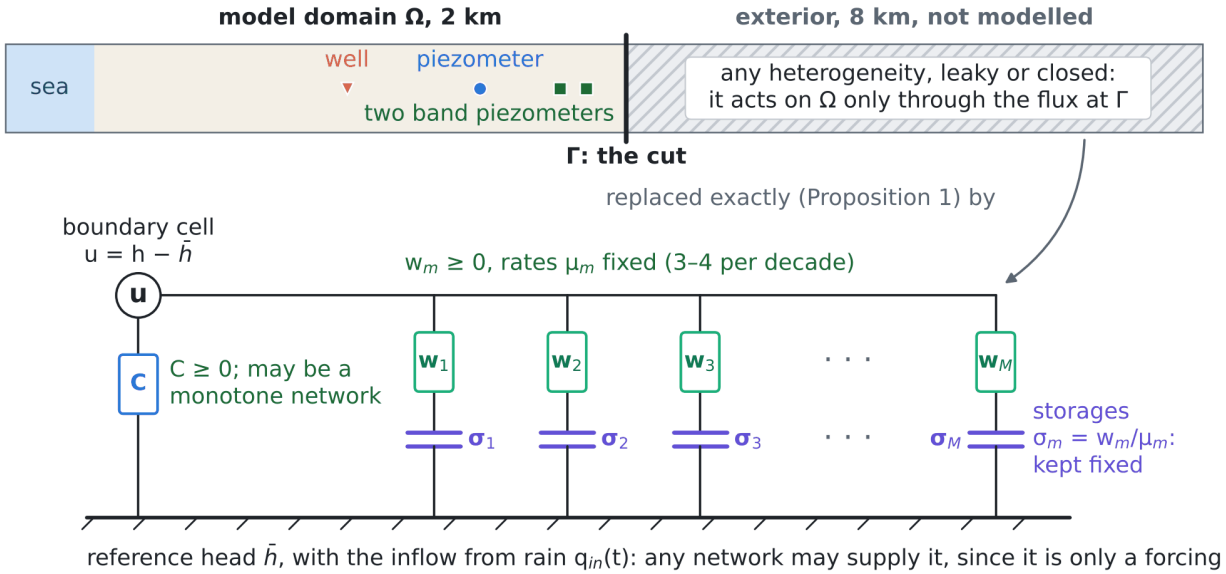


Figure 1. BEYOND-GO. The aquifer beyond the cut is replaced by a conductance C to the far field and M compartments, each a conductance w_m in series with a storage σ_m. Green marks where a neural network may enter, violet what must stay fixed. The positions are those of the test bed of Section 9; the exterior is not drawn to scale.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

3. Proposition 1: the exact boundary of any linear exterior

Let the exterior be discretised by any conservative scheme with positive storages and nonnegative conductances: the cell-centred finite volumes of MODFLOW, or lumped finite elements. Any heterogeneity, shape and number of layers is allowed. The exterior is linear (confined, or linearised about a reference state). Apart from fixed heads it has no sources, since its own forcing is moved into q_{in} by linearity. M_e is the diagonal matrix of storages. A_e is the conductance matrix: the connections inside the exterior, the conductances to its fixed heads, and the conductance $c>0$ that links its first cell to the boundary cell of Ω. Write the boundary relation as $\hat{q}(s)=Z(s)\,\hat{u}(s)$ in the Laplace variable s.

Proposition 1 (structure and realisability). For zero initial deviation, the flux leaving Ω through the cut is $\hat{q}=Z(s)\,\hat{u}$ with

$$Z(s)=C+\sum_{n=1}^{N_e} w_n\,\frac{s}{s+\mu_n},\qquad C\ge 0,\quad w_n\ge 0,\quad \mu_n>0,\quad C+\sum_n w_n=c \tag{6}$$

$$C=c-c^2\,e_1^{\top}A_e^{-1}e_1,\quad w_n=\frac{c^2\beta_n^2}{\mu_n},\quad \beta_n=v_n^{\top}M_e^{-1/2}e_1,\quad M_e^{-1/2}A_eM_e^{-1/2}\,v_n=\mu_n v_n \tag{7}$$

where e_1 marks the first exterior cell and v_n are orthonormal eigenvectors. In time this is (3)–(4) with N_e compartments. $C=0$ if and only if the exterior has no fixed head (it is closed). Conversely, any $C\ge 0$, $w_n\ge 0$, $\mu_n>0$ is the exact boundary of a physical exterior: a fixed head behind the conductance C and N isolated storage cells, cell n holding storage $\sigma_n=w_n/\mu_n$ behind conductance w_n.

Proof. The exterior heads, measured from the reference, obey $M_e\dot{v}=-A_ev+c\,e_1u$. The flux leaving Ω is $q=c\,(u-e_1^{\top}v)$. With zero initial deviation, the Laplace transform gives $(sM_e+A_e)\hat{v}=c\,e_1\hat{u}$, so $Z(s)=c-c^2e_1^{\top}(sM_e+A_e)^{-1}e_1$. A_e is symmetric and, because $c>0$ and the exterior is connected, positive definite. Hence $M_e^{-1/2}A_eM_e^{-1/2}=\sum_n\mu_n v_nv_n^{\top}$ with $\mu_n>0$, and $e_1^{\top}(sM_e+A_e)^{-1}e_1=\sum_n\beta_n^2/(s+\mu_n)$. Writing $1/(s+\mu)=1/\mu-s/(\mu(s+\mu))$ gives (6), with $C=c-c^2\sum_n\beta_n^2/\mu_n=c-c^2e_1^{\top}A_e^{-1}e_1$; letting $s\to\infty$ gives $C+\sum_n w_n=c$. To show $C\ge 0$, write $A_e=c\,e_1e_1^{\top}+A'$ with A' positive semidefinite (the exterior without the link). Then $e_1^{\top}A_e^{-1}e_1=\max_v\left(2v_1-cv_1^2-v^{\top}A'v\right)\le\max_{v_1}\left(2v_1-cv_1^2\right)=1/c$. Equality needs a v with $v_1=1/c$ and $A'v=0$. For a connected exterior the kernel of A' is spanned by the constant vector if the exterior is closed and is zero otherwise, so $C=0$ exactly for a closed exterior. In time, $\hat{y}_n=\mu_n/(s+\mu_n)\,\hat{u}$ is $\dot{y}_n=\mu_n(u-y_n)$, and $s/(s+\mu_n)\,\hat{u}=\hat{u}-\hat{y}_n$, which is (4). For the converse, cell n of the network obeys $\sigma_n\dot{y}_n=w_n(u-y_n)$ and takes the flux $w_n(u-y_n)$, and the fixed head takes Cu; the sum is (4). □

The continuous exterior. For a semi-infinite strip with transmissivity T and storage coefficient S, the exterior head is $\hat{u}\,e^{-\kappa x}$ with $\kappa=\sqrt{sS/T}$. The boundary is then of half order, a continuum of compartments:

$$Z(s)=\sqrt{ST}\,\sqrt{s}=\frac{\sqrt{ST}}{\pi}\int_0^{\infty}\frac{s}{s+\mu}\,\mu^{-1/2}\,d\mu,\qquad \text{that is}\quad \mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n}=\sqrt{ST}\;\partial_t^{1/2}u \tag{8}$$

with weight density $\left(\sqrt{ST}/\pi\right)\mu^{-1/2}$. Since Proposition 1 holds on every mesh, the structure survives refinement. The limits have the form

$$Z(s)=C+\int_{(0,\infty)}\frac{s}{s+\mu}\,\nu(d\mu),\qquad K_\Gamma(r)=\int_{(0,\infty)}e^{-\mu r}\,\nu(d\mu),\qquad \nu\ge 0 \tag{9}$$

Z is a complete Bernstein function and the memory kernel K_Γ is completely monotone. By Bernstein's theorem, every completely monotone kernel is such a positive mixture of exponentials, and the class is closed under pointwise limits [6]. This is the precise sense in which "a

conductance plus a completely monotone memory" is the true boundary condition of a linear exterior, and nothing else is.

Three remarks. (i) *The third term is the first one moved to the boundary.* K_Γ and the lens tail K_h of [D1] are the same object: completely monotone memories with exact Markovian lifts. The lens memory is storage hidden inside Ω, and the boundary memory is storage hidden beyond Γ. The same structure describes multirate mass transfer into immobile zones [14]. (ii) *Both can be run in an unmodified finite-volume code as extra cells.* A storage cell behind a conductance is an ordinary cell. In principle MODFLOW 6 can hold them as hidden cells of an unstructured grid [17]; this was not tested here. (iii) *Many boundary cells.* In two or three dimensions the cut has many cells. Then C and w_n become positive semidefinite matrices (w_n of rank one), and the exact operator is nonlocal along the cut. A local (diagonal) approximation keeps the positivity but loses the coupling along Γ.

4. Proposition 2: passivity, and what it allows a neural network to do

Take the inland, fresh part of the aquifer (constant density), with the lens memory of [D1] and the boundary (4) on Γ. Remove all forcing ($Q_w = 0$, $\Psi = 0$, $q_{in} = 0$, sea at the reference head), or, equivalently, consider the difference of two solutions with the same forcing, in which every forcing cancels. $\mathbf{K}$ is the conductivity tensor.

Proposition 2 (passivity). (a) The energy (10) is dissipated at the rate (11). (b) Hence the model is stable for every $\mathbf{K}$, S_s, geometry and mesh, and any two runs with the same forcing converge. (c) The forcing $q_{in}(t)$ may be any function. The conductances C and w_m may depend on time and on the head, provided that they stay nonnegative and are nondecreasing in the head difference they act on. The storages σ_m must stay fixed or decrease in time. (d) A negative conductance $C = -\alpha c$, $\alpha > 0$, is not passive, and whether it is stable depends on the rest of the model. For a strip of length L with the sea at $x = 0$, it has growing modes if and only if $\alpha c L > T$, at the rate given by (12).

$$E = \frac{1}{2}\int_\Omega S_s h^2\, dV + \frac{1}{2}\sum_k \int_\Omega s_k h_k^2\, dV + \frac{1}{2}\sum_m \sigma_m \int_\Gamma y_m^2\, dA \tag{10}$$

$$\frac{dE}{dt} = -\int_\Omega \nabla h^{\top}\mathbf{K}\,\nabla h\, dV - \sum_k \int_\Omega s_k a_k (h - h_k)^2 dV - \int_\Gamma \Big[Ch^2 + \sum_m w_m (h - y_m)^2\Big] dA \le 0 \tag{11}$$

$$\frac{\tanh z}{z} = \frac{T}{\alpha c L}, \quad \lambda = \frac{T z^2}{S L^2}, \quad \text{on the mesh: growth if and only if } \alpha c > \frac{T}{L - \Delta x/2} \tag{12}$$

Proof. (a) Multiply (1), without forcing, by h and integrate. The divergence term gives $-\int \nabla h^{\top}\mathbf{K}\nabla h$ minus the boundary flux $\int_\Gamma h\,\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{n}$; the sea face (at the reference head) contributes nothing. Multiply $\partial_t h_k = a_k(h - h_k)$ by $s_k h_k$; the sum with the lens term of (1) is $-\int s_k a_k (h - h_k)^2$. Multiply $\partial_t y_m = \mu_m (h - y_m)$ by $\sigma_m y_m$, which gives $w_m y_m (h - y_m)$. Then $-h[Ch + \sum_m w_m (h - y_m)] + \sum_m w_m y_m (h - y_m) = -Ch^2 - \sum_m w_m (h - y_m)^2$. (b) E is a norm of the state and does not increase. (c) The forcing cancels in the difference of two solutions. With a state-dependent conductance f, the dissipation becomes $(h_1 - h_2)(f(h_1) - f(h_2)) \ge 0$ when f is nondecreasing. A time-varying storage adds $\frac{1}{2}\dot\sigma_m y_m^2$ to (11), which is not positive only if $\dot\sigma_m \le 0$. (d) A growing mode $h = \sinh(kx)\, e^{\lambda t}$ with $\lambda = Tk^2/S$ satisfies $Tk\cosh(kL) = \alpha c \sinh(kL)$. With $z = kL$ this is (12), which has a root $z > 0$ if and only if $T/(\alpha c L) < 1$, because $\tanh z/z$ falls from 1 to 0. On the mesh the conductance matrix A is positive definite, and adding $-\alpha c\, e e^{\top}$ creates one negative eigenvalue if and only if $\alpha c\, e^{\top} A^{-1} e > 1$. Here $e^{\top} A^{-1} e$ is the resistance from the last cell to the sea, $(L - \Delta x/2)/T$. □

Passivity is a property of the boundary alone, as in the theory of dissipative systems [7]; stability with a non-passive term is a property of the whole model. Calibration changes the whole model: it moves T, and a model may later be extended to a larger L. Condition (12) shows that a term that was stable in validation can become unstable after either change. Check N3 shows this happening.

5. Proposition 3: how few compartments are needed

The exact network has one compartment per exterior cell (80 in the test). A model needs the boundary only on the band of periods its forcing and its questions contain: here from five days to forty years, $[\omega_{min}, \omega_{max}]$ with $\omega = 2\pi/\text{period}$.

Proposition 3 (approximation). (a) For $|s| = \omega$ in the band and $0 < \varepsilon < 1$, a compartment much slower than the band acts as a conductance, and one much faster acts as a boundary storage (13). On the band, $Z(s)$ is therefore $C' + \sigma' s$ plus the compartments inside the band, with $C' = C + \sum_{slow} w_m$ and $\sigma' = \sum_{fast} \sigma_m$. (b) The half-order boundary (8) is approximated to a relative error of order ε by the trapezoidal rule in $x = \ln \mu$ with the nodes, weights and window (14). The count is (15): it grows with the logarithm of the band and the square of $\ln(1/\varepsilon)$. (c) All weights are positive, so the approximation is passive (Proposition 2).

$$\frac{s}{s+\mu} = 1 + O(\varepsilon) \quad \text{if } \mu \le \varepsilon\, \omega_{min}, \qquad w\,\frac{s}{s+\mu} = \sigma s\,(1 + O(\varepsilon)) \quad \text{if } \mu \ge \omega_{max}/\varepsilon \tag{13}$$

$$\mu_j = e^{x_j}, \quad w_j = \frac{\sqrt{ST}\,\eta}{\pi}\, e^{x_j/2}, \quad x_j = X_- + (j-1)\eta, \quad \eta = \frac{\pi^2}{\ln(1/\varepsilon)}, \qquad X_- = \ln \omega_{min} - 2\ln\frac{2}{\pi\varepsilon}, \quad X_+ = \ln \omega_{max} + 2\ln\frac{2}{\pi\varepsilon} \tag{14}$$

$$M = 1 + \frac{X_+ - X_-}{\eta} = 1 + \frac{\ln(1/\varepsilon)}{\pi^2}\left[\ln\frac{\omega_{max}}{\omega_{min}} + 4\ln\frac{2}{\pi\varepsilon}\right] \tag{15}$$

Proof. (a) $s/(s+\mu) - 1 = -\mu/(s+\mu)$, whose modulus is at most $\mu/\omega \le \varepsilon$. And $s/(s+\mu) - s/\mu = -s^2/(\mu(s+\mu))$, whose modulus relative to ω/μ is at most $\omega/\mu \le \varepsilon$. (b) The integrand of (8) in $x = \ln\mu$ is $f(x) = s\,e^{x/2}/(\pi(s+e^x))$. For $s = i\omega$ its poles nearest to the real axis lie at $\operatorname{Im} x = -\pi/2$, so it is analytic in the strip $|\operatorname{Im} x| < \pi/2$. The trapezoidal rule then converges like $\exp(-2\pi d/\eta)$ with $d \to \pi/2$ [10], that is like $\exp\left(-\pi^2/\eta\right) = \varepsilon$. The tails decay as $e^{x/2}/\pi$ to the left and $\omega e^{-x/2}/\pi$ to the right. Their integrals beyond X_- and X_+, divided by $\left|\sqrt{s}\right| = \sqrt{\omega}$, equal ε at the two band ends for the window (14). (c) is immediate. □

Proposition 3(b) is an estimate, not a bound. The three errors add, and the trapezoidal constant is not one. Check N2 found the error at the predicted count to be 1.8–2.4 times ε, and the count that actually reaches ε to be 19–21% larger. For a general exterior, check N1 fitted the weights by nonnegative least squares on a fixed logarithmic grid. Over 3.5 decades, 3, 6 and 12 compartments gave median impedance errors of 26.0%, 1.9% and 0.10%: about three to four compartments per decade are enough. The same positive rational fitting, with passivity enforced, is how external electrical networks are reduced [8, 9].

6. Proposition 4: what two piezometers can learn

Let heads be observed with noise at $x_1 < x_2 < L$ inside Ω, near the cut at $x = L$. Assume the band (x_1, L) contains no unknown source (known recharge is allowed) and the vertically integrated equation $S\,\partial_t h = T\,\partial_{xx} h + r$ holds in it. In this section Z relates the deviations of flux and head at $x = L$.

Proposition 4 (identifiability and design). (a) *Separation.* For every $\omega \neq 0$ at which the heads carry signal, the heads at x_1 and x_2 determine $Z(i\omega)$, whatever the rest of the model (the wells, the sea, the closure Ψ outside the band). The reconstruction (16) amplifies noise by about (17). (b) *Band.* At frequencies where the forcing has no power, the data carry no information on Z. Outside the excited band, Z is set by the structure and the prior, not by the data. (c) *Confounding.* If an unknown source acts inside the band (a closure Ψ, or an unknown inflow q_{in} at the cut), it cannot be separated from Z unless it is restricted. (d) *Design.* Place two piezometers between the closure region and the cut, with no unknown source between them and the cut. Space them about one diffusion length $\sqrt{T/(S\omega_{max})}$ apart, and vary the pumping across the band and independently of the rain.

$$\hat{h}(x,s) = A(s)\,e^{\kappa x} + B(s)\,e^{-\kappa x} + \hat{h}_p(x,s), \quad \kappa = \sqrt{sS/T}, \quad Z(s) = \frac{-T\,\partial_x \hat{h}(L,s)}{\hat{h}(L,s)} \tag{16}$$

$$\exp\left((L - x_2)\sqrt{\frac{\omega S}{2T}}\right) \tag{17}$$

Proof. (a) In the band, the transformed equation $sS\hat{h} = T\hat{h}_{xx} + \hat{r}$ has the general solution (16), where $\hat{h}_p$ is fixed by the known recharge. The two observations give a linear system for A and B with determinant $-2\sinh(\kappa(x_2 - x_1))$. For $s = i\omega$, $\omega \neq 0$, $\kappa(x_2 - x_1)$ has a nonzero real part, so this determinant is never zero. Then $\hat{h}(L)$ and $\partial_x \hat{h}(L)$, and hence $Z(i\omega)$, follow; nothing outside the band enters. Continuing a solution of the heat equation sideways in this way is unique but ill-posed [11]. The growing exponential has modulus (17). (b) A frequency absent from the forcing is absent from the heads. In principle Z is analytic, so its values on an interval fix it everywhere, but that continuation is unstable; with noise only Proposition 3(a) and the prior remain. (c) If the truth is (Z, Ψ) with Ψ acting at the boundary cell, the pair $(Z', \Psi + (Z' - Z)[u])$ produces the same heads for every Z'. The same holds for q_{in}, unless it is known or independent of the excitation. Pumping varied independently of the rain then acts as an instrument [12]. (d) follows from (a)–(c) and from the amplification (17). □

Proposition 4 makes the boundary a target of the experimental design of the series. The pumping schedule is the experiment. Its regime changes, months to years apart, are what make the boundary identifiable, as persistent excitation does in system identification [12]. The two piezometers are the sensors that this experiment needs.

7. Learning BEYOND-GO: where the neural network goes

The question that led to this note was whether a neural regulariser could learn the true boundary condition. Propositions 1–4 give the answer. A network should not replace the operator $\mathcal{Z}$. Nothing linear lies outside the class (3)–(4), a free network can leave the passive class (Proposition 2), and outside the excited band it would extrapolate without control (Proposition 4). The network has three good places:

$$C = \mathrm{softplus}(a_0), \quad w_m = \mathrm{softplus}(a_m), \quad \mu_m = \mu_1 \rho^{m-1}, \quad q_{in}(t) = g_\phi(P(t-r),\ 0 \le r \le r_{max}) \tag{18}$$

- **The forcing.** $q_{in}(t)$ is the inflow from rain P and may be any network g_ϕ. It cancels in Proposition 2, so it cannot destabilise anything. GUARANTEE-GO and RECONSTRUCTION-GO already reconstruct this lateral inflow from rain [D2, D3]. BEYOND-GO adds the response that a prescribed inflow lacks.
- **A monotone conductance.** $C_\theta(t,u) \geq 0$, nondecreasing in u, may be a network, for example for a river that dries out or a seasonal clogging (Proposition 2(c)). The storages σ_m stay fixed, and the rates μ_m sit on a fixed geometric grid with three to four per decade (Proposition 3).
- **The learned regulariser.** The network belongs in the objective, as a prior learned from geology:

$$J(\theta) = \frac{1}{2}\sum_k \left\| \frac{\mathbf{d}_k - \mathbf{h}_k(\theta)}{\sigma} \right\|^2 - \log p_\phi(\mathbf{f}(Z_\theta)), \qquad \mathbf{f}(Z) = (\ln \operatorname{Re} Z(i\omega_j),\ \ln \operatorname{Im} Z(i\omega_j))_{j=1}^{24} \tag{19}$$

where $\mathbf{d}_k$ are the observed heads and σ their noise. The density p_ϕ is trained on an ensemble of simulated exteriors. Each geological scenario (lengths, heterogeneous T, S, closed or leaky ends) gives its exact Z by Proposition 1, its 48 features and so a sample. In check N5 p_ϕ is a Gaussian with 1% shrinkage of its covariance, the linear case of a learned regulariser [13]; a neural density (for example a normalising flow) replaces it when the ensemble is richer. Its weight is not tuned: the noise level and the ensemble fix it. The gradient of J comes from the adjoint of the time stepping, which carries M scalar adjoint states per boundary cell, as for the lens compartments of [D1]. The checks below used finite differences over 13 parameters.

8. Other terms the flow equation may need

The same test (is the term passive, or at least does it keep the maximum principle?) sorts the other candidates. Table 1 lists them.

Table 1. Terms that can be added to the flow equation (1), the condition under which each keeps the model stable, and where each stands.

Term	What is added	Stable if	Status
Lens memory	$-\sum_k s_k a_k (h_f - h_k)$, with $\partial_t h_k = a_k(h_f - h_k)$	always ($s_k, a_k \geq 0$)	[D1], eqs. (1)–(3)
Learned closure	$\Psi(h_f, \mathbf{x}; \gamma)$	dissipative: Ψ nonincreasing in h_f	[D1], eq. (6); zero in its tests
Boundary memory (BEYOND-GO)	$Cu + \sum_m w_m(u - y_m)$ on Γ	$C, w_m \geq 0$; storages fixed	this note
Inelastic storage	$S_s = S_{ske}$ above the preconsolidation head h_{pc}, S_{skv} below it	always ($S_s > 0$: maximum principle)	MODFLOW 6 CSUB [18]; subsidence of the Durrës plain [D1]
Tidal and barometric loading	$+\gamma S_s \partial_t \eta_\sigma$ (η_σ: vertical load in head units, γ: loading efficiency)	a known forcing: stability unchanged	[21]

9. Numerical checks

Test bed. A one-dimensional coastal aquifer, 10 km long, with T = 500 m²/d and S = 0.05 (diffusivity 10^4 m²/d). It uses cell-centred finite volumes of 100 m, implicit Euler with daily steps and 20 years of simulation. The sea is a fixed head at $x = 0$; the far end is closed. The model sees only the first 2 km, and its cut at 2 km must stand in for the 8 km beyond. Recharge of 0.5 mm/d, with a seasonal swing of ±80%, falls on the model domain. The well is at 0.95 km. Its pumping is either steady (0.6 m²/d per metre of coast) or varied (regimes of 6 months to 3 years at 0.3–1.0 m²/d, with ±15% monthly changes). The piezometer is at 1.45 km, the band piezometers at 1.75 and 1.85 km, and the boundary cell at 1.95 km. The parameters are illustrative and not calibrated for Fushë-Kuqe. All checks run in 111 s (the BEYOND-GO code).

N1. The exact boundary and its reductions (Proposition 1)

The exact network of the 8 km closed exterior has 80 compartments, C = 1.8×10⁻¹⁵ (zero up to rounding, as Proposition 1 says for a closed exterior) and $\sum w_n = c$. With it, the cut model reproduces the full aquifer to 1.3×10⁻¹³ m at the boundary cell and 9.4×10⁻¹⁴ m at the piezometer, over 20 years in which the head at the boundary cell ranges over 1.25 m. Positive reductions with 3, 6 and 12 compartments were compared with a fixed head, a no-flow boundary and the best GHB (conductance scanned over 70 values, best C = 0.203 m/d = 0.041c). Table 2 and Figure 2 show the result.

Table 2. N1: errors of the cut model against the full aquifer over 20 years with varied pumping (root mean square and maximum at the boundary cell, root mean square at the piezometer), and the error of the impedance over 3.5 decades (median and maximum).

Boundary at the cut	Boundary cell, rms	Boundary cell, max	Piezometer, rms	Impedance, median / max
Fixed head	305.8 mm	645.5 mm	218.3 mm	–
No flow (prescribed inflow)	242.0 mm	545.1 mm	166.3 mm	–
Calibrated GHB	147.9 mm	325.1 mm	101.3 mm	–
BEYOND-GO, 3 compartments	37.8 mm	89.4 mm	27.0 mm	26.0% / 55.5%
BEYOND-GO, 6 compartments	7.8 mm	15.4 mm	5.8 mm	1.9% / 12.0%
BEYOND-GO, 12 (11 nonzero)	0.44 mm	1.04 mm	0.32 mm	0.10% / 0.75%
Exact network, 80 compartments	1.3×10⁻¹³ m	–	9.4×10⁻¹⁴ m	0

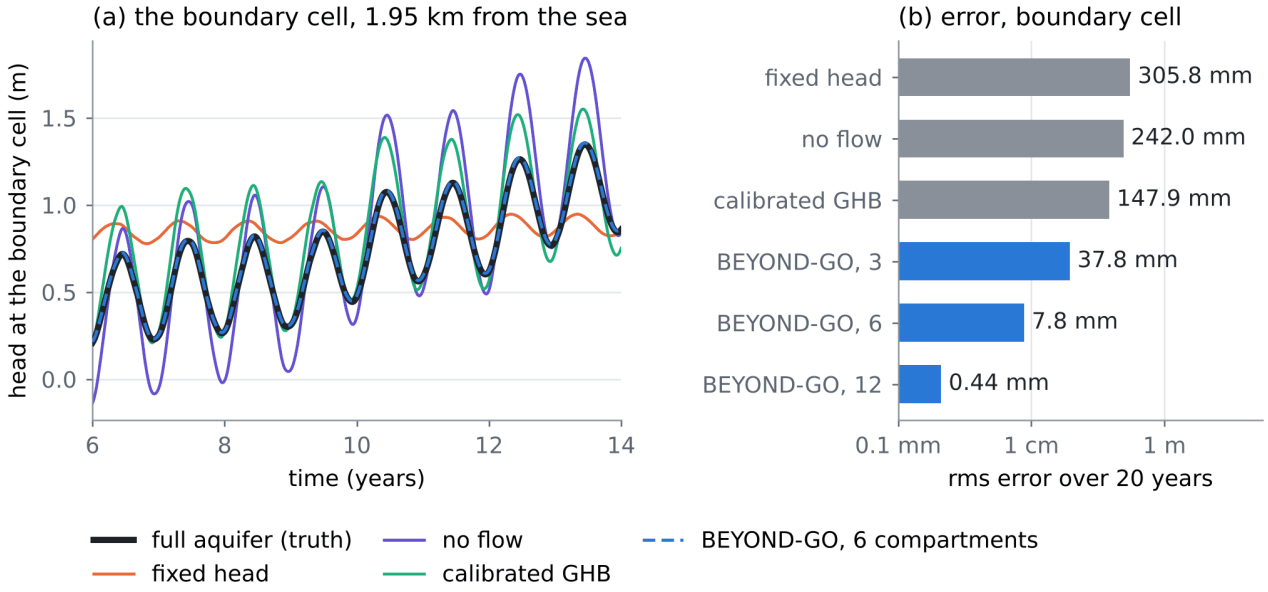


Figure 2. N1. (a) Head at the boundary cell in years 6–14: the full aquifer and five boundaries at the cut. The six-compartment BEYOND-GO lies on the truth. (b) Root-mean-square error over 20 years (logarithmic axis).
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

Even the best GHB, calibrated on these very data, misses by 147.9 mm, because a conductance cannot store water. Six positive compartments cut the error 19 times, and twelve cut it 335 times.

N2. How many compartments the half-order boundary needs (Proposition 3)

Table 3. N2: the count (15) against the count actually needed, for the half-order boundary (8) over 4 and 6 decades of period starting at 30 years.

Decades	Target ε	M by the count formula	Error at that M	M needed for ε
4	1%	14	1.77%	17
4	0.1%	26	0.23%	31
6	1%	16	1.87%	19
6	0.1%	29	0.24%	35

Two more decades add only 2–4 compartments, and ten times more accuracy roughly doubles the count, as (15) predicts (Figure 3a).

N3. Passivity (Proposition 2)

Start the model without forcing from a 1 m mound around the well. With the passive exact boundary the energy decreases at every step, from 12.5 to 0.0138 in five years. With $C = -0.2c$, above the threshold, the energy grows by a factor 3.4×10^{52} in five years. Its measured growth rate, 0.0338 per day, matches the rate of the semi-discrete model under implicit Euler (0.0338) to a relative 8×10^{-16}. The continuous strip (12) gives 0.0399; the difference comes from the boundary term acting on the cell-centre head, half a cell inside the face. The thresholds are α = 0.050 for the continuum and 0.0513 on the mesh. With $C = -0.02c$, below them, the 2 km model decays. The same boundary in longer models (Table 4, Figure 3c) shows the danger of Proposition 2(d).

Table 4. N3: the non-passive boundary $C = -0.02c$, stable in the 2 km test, in longer models.

Model length	Threshold α on the mesh	Growth rate (1/d)	Head amplitude
2 km	0.0513	-4.02×10^{-3}	halves in 172 days
4 km	0.0253	-3.74×10^{-4}	halves in 5.1 years
6 km	0.0168	1.63×10^{-4}	doubles in 11.7 years
8 km	0.0126	3.08×10^{-4}	doubles in 6.2 years

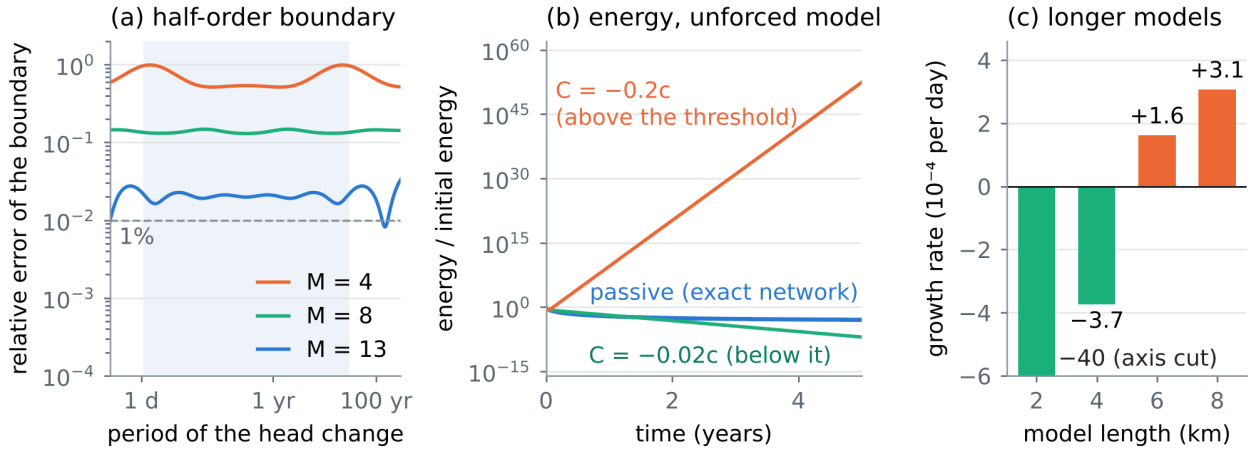


Figure 3. (a) N2: relative error of the half-order boundary with M = 4, 8 and 13 compartments on the quadrature (14); shaded, the four decades of the design. (b) N3: energy of the unforced model with the passive boundary and with two negative conductances. (c) N3: growth rate of the $C = -0.02c$ boundary as the model is lengthened.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

N4. Learning the boundary from two piezometers (Proposition 4)

The boundary was learned from the two band piezometers by output error. The band cells (1.85 and 1.95 km) were simulated with the observed head at 1.75 km and the known recharge as

inputs, and the 13 nonnegative parameters (C and 12 compartments, 3.4 per decade) were chosen to reproduce the head at 1.85 km. Nothing else of the model was used, and no noisy data were differentiated. The learned boundary was then put into the cut model to predict a regime never seen in the data. Over 10 years, the pumping doubles from year 2 and a drought cuts recharge to 30% in years 3–8; the head at the boundary cell falls by 2.39 m. Table 5 and Figure 4 show the results.

Table 5. N4: median relative error of the learned impedance in three bands of period, and root-mean-square error of the prediction at the boundary cell. "Steady" and "varied" refer to the pumping during the 20 years of data.

Data	Noise	40–200 years	30 days–10 years	2.5–10 days	Prediction
Steady pumping	2 mm	25.6%	5.1%	365%	35.3 mm
Steady pumping	10 mm	201%	16.1%	549%	227.4 mm
Varied pumping	2 mm	4.5%	1.3%	233%	6.1 mm
Varied pumping	10 mm	29.6%	5.2%	387%	34.9 mm
Varied, closure in the band (1.95 km)	2 mm	75.6%	47.4%	86.5%	–
Varied, closure outside it (1.25 km)	2 mm	6.3%	3.3%	258%	–
Exact boundary	–	–	–	–	2.0×10^{-11} mm
Calibrated GHB · no flow · fixed head	–	–	–	–	372 mm · 605 mm · 1234 mm

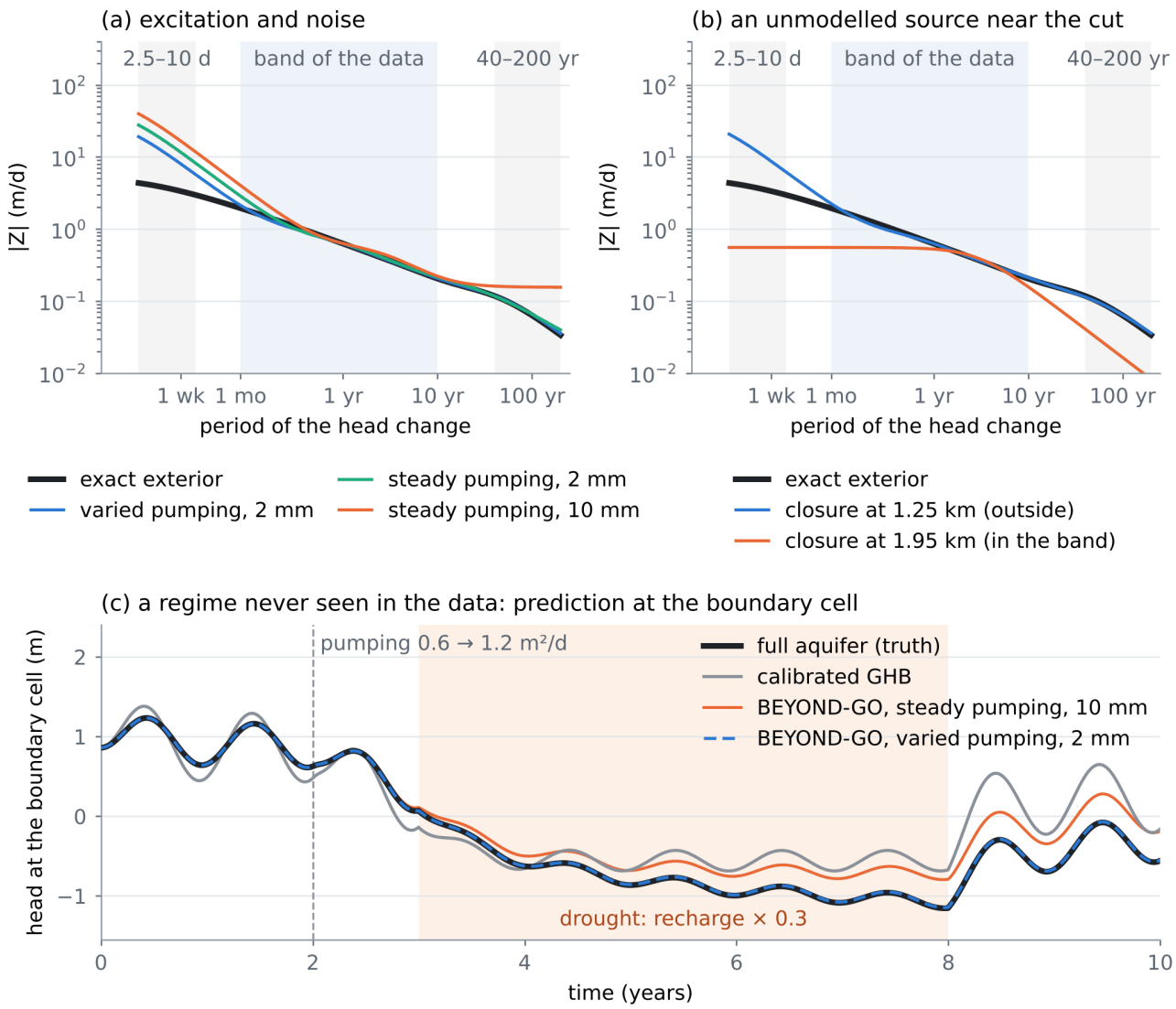


Figure 4. N4. (a) Modulus of the learned impedance against the exact one. Shaded: the band of the data (30 days–10 years) and, in grey, periods of 2.5–10 days and 40–200 years. (b) A closure source of 0.15 m²/d (seasonal) plus a 0.1 m²/d step in year 6, placed inside or outside the band. (c) Prediction of a regime never seen in the data.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

The results follow Proposition 4 point by point. Inside the band, varied pumping learns the boundary four times better than steady pumping at the same noise (1.3% against 5.1%). At periods of 2.5–10 days, which no forcing excites, every estimate is wrong by more than 200%. That does not matter for the prediction, which has no power there either. Varied pumping also reaches the 40–200 year band, beyond the 20-year record, to 4.5%, because the positive structure links it to the band. A closure source between the piezometers and the cut corrupts the boundary (47.4%), while the same source outside the band leaves it intact (3.3%). The learned boundary predicts the new regime to 6.1 mm, 61 times better than the GHB calibrated on the full record.

N5. The learned regulariser (Section 7)

Two priors were trained, each on 400 simulated exteriors of 3–15 km, half closed and half leaky, with heterogeneous, correlated T. The **right** prior draws the median T from 150–1500 m²/d and S from 0.01–0.2. The truth lies at the 13th percentile of its Mahalanobis distances, within the prior but not at its centre. The **wrong** prior draws T from 40–160 m²/d and S from 0.004–0.02, a geology about six times less conductive. Under it the truth lies at the 98th percentile. The identifications of N4 were repeated with each prior (Table 6, Figure 5).

Table 6. N5: the identifications of N4 without a prior, with the right prior and with the wrong one (median relative error of the impedance; root-mean-square error of the prediction of N4).

Data	Prior	40–200 years	30 days–10 years	2.5–10 days	Prediction
Steady, 2 mm	none	25.6%	5.1%	365%	35.3 mm
	right	1.9%	3.8%	93.5%	12.2 mm
	wrong	14.3%	3.2%	90.4%	13.6 mm
Steady, 10 mm	none	201%	16.1%	549%	227.4 mm
	right	176%	9.9%	126%	191.6 mm
	wrong	110%	7.9%	115%	76.2 mm
Varied, 2 mm	none	4.5%	1.3%	233%	6.1 mm
	right	3.8%	1.1%	53.1%	5.2 mm
	wrong	4.4%	1.1%	59.5%	5.5 mm
Varied, 10 mm	none	29.6%	5.2%	387%	34.9 mm
	right	12.8%	4.8%	88.8%	20.2 mm
	wrong	20.7%	5.0%	90.2%	26.2 mm

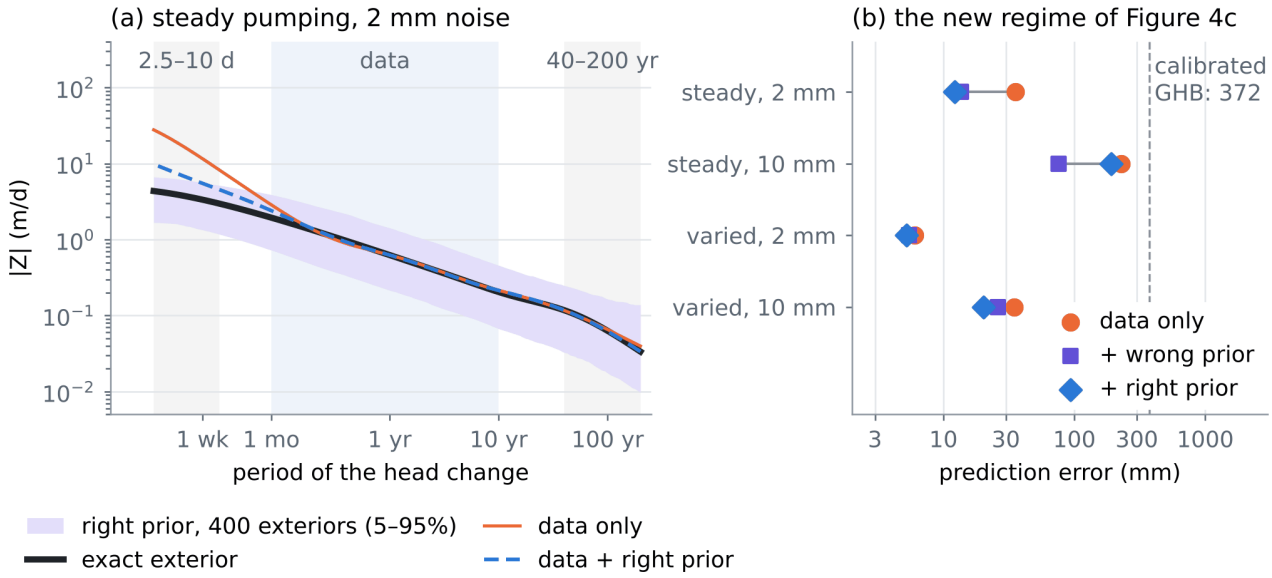


Figure 5. N5. (a) Steady pumping with 2 mm noise. The right prior (its 5–95% envelope in violet) brings the boundary much closer to the truth at the shortest periods, where the data are silent. (b) Error of the prediction of Figure 4c without a prior, with the wrong prior and with the right one.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

The prior helps in every case and most where the data are silent. The error at periods of 2.5–10 days falls 3.9–4.4 times. The 40–200 year error for steady pumping with 2 mm noise falls from 25.6% to 1.9%, and every prediction improves. Two findings qualify this. First, the wrong prior still improved every case over no prior, and it was only slightly worse than the right one (better in one case). The prior acts mainly through the *shape* of the impedance, which all diffusive exteriors share, while the data fix its level inside the band. This is no licence to use a wrong prior: the Mahalanobis distance of the estimate flags it, though weakly. Under the wrong prior the estimates sit at percentiles 98.5–99.2 of its ensemble, and under the right one at 93.0–98.5. The data-only estimates sit far outside both (distances 247–659, against a 99th percentile of 56.6). Second, a prior does not replace the experiment. With steady pumping and 10 mm noise, the best prior still predicts to only 76.2 mm, while varied pumping with 2 mm noise and no prior predicts to 6.1 mm.

N6. Sea-level rise: the cut that the boundary decided

The sea was raised by 0.5 m over 20 years on top of the forcing of N1, and each cut model was compared with the full aquifer. The aquifer must store water as its heads rise with the sea, and that water comes from the fresh discharge to the sea (mean 0.291 m²/d per metre of coast). Less fresh discharge moves the toe inland. In the sharp-interface equilibrium of [D1, eq. (24)] the toe distance is inversely proportional to the fresh discharge. Table 7 shows the result.

Table 7. N6: fresh water that does not reach the sea during 20 years of a 0.5 m rise, the fall of the fresh discharge at year 20, and the landward shift of the equilibrium toe that this fall would cause [D1, eq. (24)].

Inland boundary	Fresh water lost (m³ per m of coast)	Discharge at year 20	Equilibrium toe
Full aquifer (truth)	154	−10.2%	+11.3%
BEYOND-GO, 6 compartments	160	−11.1%	+12.5%
BEYOND-GO, 12 compartments	155	−10.2%	+11.4%
Prescribed inflow [D1, eq. (31)]	49	−2.4%	+2.4%
Calibrated GHB	237	−20.9%	+26.4%
Fixed head	462	−42.7%	+74.5%

The answer to the sea-level question changes by a factor of 9.4 with the inland boundary. The prescribed inflow, which led [D1] to cut sea-level rise, underestimates the lost fresh water 3.1 times. It sees the storage of the 2 km model but not that of the 8 km beyond it. The fixed head overestimates it three times, and even the GHB calibrated in N1 errs by 54%. BEYOND-GO with six compartments errs by 4%, and with twelve by 0.2%. The boundary learned from piezometers in a pumping experiment (N4) therefore decides a question that the assembly had to leave open, in line with the role of the inland boundary in the sea-level response of coastal aquifers [19, 20].

10. What BEYOND-GO adds

- **A term for the flow equation with an exact pedigree.** (3)–(4) is the boundary of every linear exterior and only of physical exteriors (Proposition 1). It sits next to the two terms the series already added and has the same mathematical form as the lens memory.
- **Stability as a property of the learned boundary alone** (Proposition 2), with a rule for neural networks: free in the forcing, monotone in the conductances, never in the storages. A non-passive term that passed validation failed when the model was lengthened (N3).
- **Logarithmic cost** (Proposition 3): 6–12 states per boundary cell, three to four per decade of period (N1, N2).
- **Identifiability and design** (Proposition 4): two piezometers separate the boundary from the closure Ψ and from everything inside the model, and the pumping schedule is the experiment that reveals the boundary (N4).
- **A learned prior from simulated geology** that repairs the periods the data cannot reach, does not replace the experiment, and in this test was robust to a wrong geology (N5).
- **An answer to a question the assembly left open**: whether sea-level rise matters inland depends on the boundary, and BEYOND-GO reproduces the true response within 4% (N6).

Verification note. The external references [1–21] were checked in Crossref (DOI, authors, title, venue), November 2026. The note was drafted with the help of an AI assistant. Every number is computed by the BEYOND-GO code (results in its res folder) and inserted by the build script.

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Notes of this series (preparatory work of the NPD's team)

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PART 6

Implementation report: SHOCK-GO, the earthquake in the aquifer

The earthquake, the aquifer and liquefaction: the pore-pressure step of each layer, the earthquake as a free pumping test, the design of the 2019 hindcast and the joint safe window, with numerical checks. Preparatory work of the NPD's team, November 2026.

Deep reinforcement learning in this part

The pore-pressure step of each earthquake is a jump of the environment of the agent of Part 7, and the liquefaction factor of safety is one of its constraints; the relaxation after the earthquake, a free pumping test, sharpens the model the agent learns on.

SHOCK-GO: the earthquake, the aquifer and liquefaction, implemented

The first three steps of the earthquake note [D1] as tested code: the liquefaction module with the pore pressure of the day, the coseismic step from four published models of the 26 November 2019 Durrës earthquake, and the design of the 2019 hindcast; with a joint safe window for liquefaction and seawater intrusion and a daily bulletin

Dulian Zeqiraj · November 2026 · implementation report with numerical checks · follows the working note of 31 October 2026 on the earthquake, the aquifer, human action and floods [D1]

1. Outcome

• **What was built.** Three modules in the SHOCK-GO experiment: the liquefaction triggering of Boulanger and Idriss [9, 10] with the liquefaction potential index (LPI) [11], driven by the pore pressure at the moment of the earthquake; Okada's solution for a rectangular fault [1], written here and checked against five independent tests; and the three experiments E1–E3 of the plan, with the innovation E4. Everything runs in about 9 s. Figure 1 shows the chain.

• **Liquefaction module (E1).** All structural checks pass (MSF = 1.000 at M 7.5, K_σ = 1.000 at $\sigma'_v = P_a$). Equation (4.9) of [D1] holds to 3.3×10^{-10}. A new closed form for the full sensitivity, $\partial \ln FS/\partial z_w = (\gamma_w/\sigma'_v)(1 - C_\sigma/K_\sigma)$, holds to 3.4×10^{-10}. In the example profile the LPI falls from 20.2 to 9.3 when the water table drops from 0.8 to 2.6 m, about 6.0 per metre. Re-normalising the CPT resistance with the stress of the day, a tempting shortcut, understates that slope by 33%.

• **The coseismic step (E2): a correction of magnitude.** The four published source models [4–7] agree on the sign of the step over 86% of the area where the strain matters. Its size, however, depends on the layer. A layer under the free surface takes the horizontal strain of the crust and adjusts vertically, so its pore pressure follows its own shear modulus: $\Delta p_0 = -\kappa\,\Delta\varepsilon_a$, $\kappa = 2/3GB(1+\nu_u)/(1-\nu_u)$. In a confined aquifer (G = 0.5 GPa) the head falls by 0.6–1.0 m over the hanging wall and rises by 0.2–0.3 m in front of it. In the soft surface sand (G = 50 MPa) it falls by 7–12 cm and rises by 3–4 cm. Equation (2.2) of [D1], applied to the volumetric strain of the half-space, gives 35 times the soft-sand value.

• **Consequence.** For liquefaction of the surface sands the static step is negligible next to the seasonal swing of the water table (about 1 m). It matters for the confined aquifer and its wells. Rises of metres in liquefied areas, such as those of Chi-Chi cited in [D1], cannot come from the static strain of a soft layer. They point to the volumetric change caused by the shaking itself (Wang and Chia [14] use laboratory data on saturated sediments under cyclic loading), which the CSR–CRR comparison already represents.

• **The earthquake as a free pumping test (E2).** A 2.94–3.07-day 95% interval for the leakage time

of the confined aquifer follows from 20 days of logger data after a 0.3 m step. A whole year of seasonal heads gives 2.67–3.37 days, an interval 5.8 times wider.

• **The 2019 hindcast (E3).** On a synthetic coastal plain, even with the largest step (the upper bound of (2.2) as written), 480 sites with CPT give a power of 49% to detect the step and 26% to detect the water table of the day. The 2019 liquefaction map [8] cannot test the chain; the well records of November 2019 can.

Innovation: SHOCK-GO. Three results are new. (i) **Which aquifer feels the earthquake.** The static step of a layer under the free surface follows its own shear modulus, $\kappa = 2/3GB(1+\nu_u)/(1-\nu_u)$: centimetres in soft surface sand, up to a metre in a confined aquifer, and 35 times less in the soft sand than (2.2) as written. The step therefore leaves the liquefaction of the surface sands and stays in the confined aquifer and its wells. (ii) **The earthquake as a free pumping test.** The relaxation of that step identifies the leakage time 5.8 times more sharply than a year of seasonal heads. (iii) **A design result.** The 2019 liquefaction map cannot test the step, and tests the water table of the day only with several hundred CPTs.

The certified safe window and the liquefaction state "if the design earthquake struck now" are concepts of the CERTAIN-COAST proposal [D2]: its multi-hazard window and its indicator I_2. SHOCK-GO computes them with the liquefaction module. For one managed head the window between liquefaction and intrusion closes at $\eta_{close}(a) = z_s - z^\star(a) - m_{int} - A$: at the synthetic port of E4, at 0.29 m of relative sea-level rise for 0.20 g (about 2059 at an illustrative 9 mm/yr), and it is already closed at 0.22 g. The probability that the LPI exceeds 5 if the earthquake struck that day moves between 0.16 (late July) and 0.26 (early February), a factor of 1.6 that a static hazard map hides.

The building blocks are published [1, 9–11, 13, 16]; sea-level rise and liquefaction have been studied together [17, 18]. In the sources read for this note we did not find the step coefficient of a layer under the free surface used to decide which aquifer feels an earthquake, nor the coseismic step used as a pumping test of the leakage time.

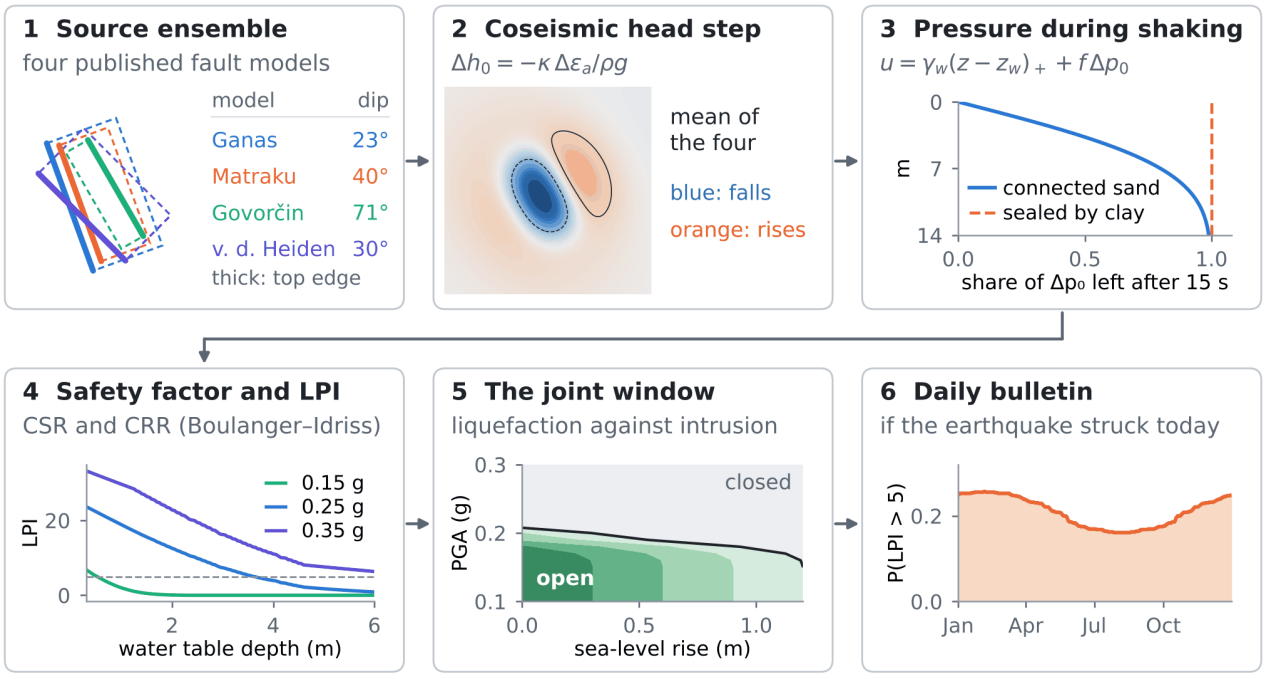


Figure 1. SHOCK-GO in six steps, each with its computed field: (1) the four source models (thick line: top edge of the fault); (2) the mean head step in the confined aquifer; (3) the share of the step left after 15 s of shaking; (4) LPI against the depth of the water table; (5) the joint safe window against sea-level rise and design acceleration; (6) the daily bulletin.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

2. What was implemented

The note [D1] proposed three first steps: the liquefaction module, the coseismic step from the published source models, and a hindcast of the 2019 liquefaction. Table 1 lists what each step became. The parameters of the coastal plain, the soils and the ground motion are illustrative and the coordinates are local (km from the fault centroid); this is a test of the method, not a map of Durrës.

Table 1. The modules, what they compute and how they were checked.

Step of [D1]	Module	What it computes	Checked by
1. Liquefaction	liq.py	σ_v, u, σ'_v, CSR, CRR, FS, LPI, $\partial \ln FS/\partial z_w$	structural values; finite differences of (4.9) and of the closed form
2. Coseismic step	okada85.py, liq.py	surface displacement and strain [1]; $\Delta p_0 = -\kappa\,\Delta\varepsilon_a$; drainage share f	okada_checks.py (five tests); Biot's law (1.1)
3. Hindcast design	the main script, E3	AUC of four predictors; power against the number of sites	DeLong covariance [15]; 400 resamples per size
Innovation	the main script, E4	joint window, closing sea level, daily bulletin	quantiles over 60 profiles and 12 accelerations

3. E1: the liquefaction module

3.1 The pore pressure of the day

The module follows (4.2)–(4.8) of [D1] (Boulanger and Idriss [9], eqs. 2.2, 2.7, 2.14, 2.16, 2.19, 2.20 and 2.24). One change is needed. In (4.1) the coseismic step was added to the water table. A step of pore pressure in a sand below a clay is not a movement of the water table: the water table is where $u = 0$, and it does not move in the seconds of shaking. The step enters the pore pressure:

$$u(z) = \gamma_w (z - z_w)_+ + f(z)\,\Delta p_0(z), \qquad \sigma'_v(z) = \sigma_v(z) - u(z), \qquad \sigma_v(z) = \int_0^z \gamma_t\, dz' \tag{1}$$

where z_w is the depth of the water table on the day, Δp_0 the undrained step (Section 4) and f the share of it left at the end of the shaking (Section 4.5). Then, with $q = q_{c1Ncs}$,

$$\mathrm{FS} = \frac{\mathrm{CRR}_{7.5,1}(q)\;\mathrm{MSF}(q,M)\;K_\sigma(q,\sigma'_v)}{0.65\,(\sigma_v/\sigma'_v)\,(a_{\max}/g)\,r_d(z,M)}, \qquad \mathrm{LPI} = \int_0^{20\,\mathrm{m}} \max(0, 1 - \mathrm{FS})\,(10 - 0.5z)\,dz \tag{2}$$

with the functions of (4.3)–(4.7) of [D1]. FS is set to infinity above the water table and in soils that cannot liquefy (clays and silts with I_c above 2.6).

3.2 What the CPT resistance is, and the shortcut to avoid

q_{c1Ncs} is a density index: the tip resistance normalised with the effective stress at the time of the CPT. It describes the sand and does not change when the water table moves later. The water table of the day enters only through CSR and K_σ. Re-normalising q_{c1Ncs} with the stress of the day (through $C_N = (P_a/\sigma'_v)^m \le 1.7$) mixes the state of the sand with the state of the water. For the example profile, with the CPT made at a water table of 2.0 m, the shortcut gives an LPI slope of 4.1 per metre instead of 6.0: it understates the effect of the water table by 33% (Figure 2e, dashed).

3.3 The sensitivity to the water table in closed form

Proposition 1 (sensitivity of the factor of safety). Below the water table, with the same unit weight above and below it, q_{c1Ncs} fixed and $\Delta p_0 = 0$,

$$\frac{\partial \ln \mathrm{FS}}{\partial z_w} = \frac{\gamma_w}{\sigma'_v}\left(1 - \frac{C_\sigma}{K_\sigma}\right) \quad \text{if } K_\sigma < 1.1; \qquad \frac{\partial \ln \mathrm{FS}}{\partial z_w} = \frac{\gamma_w}{\sigma'_v} \quad \text{if } K_\sigma = 1.1 \tag{3}$$

The first factor is (4.9) of [D1] with the opposite sign; the second is the share that K_σ takes back. Because $C_\sigma \le 0.3$ and K_σ is near 1, a deeper water table always raises FS.

Proof. $CRR_{7.5,1}$ and MSF depend on q and M only, and r_d on z and M. Below the water table $\partial \sigma'_v / \partial z_w = \gamma_w$ and σ_v does not change. Hence $\partial \ln CSR / \partial z_w = -\gamma_w / \sigma'_v$, which is (4.9). From (4.7), $\partial K_\sigma / \partial z_w = -C_\sigma \gamma_w / \sigma'_v$ below the cap and zero on it. Subtracting the logarithmic derivative of CSR from that of K_σ gives (3). □

Table 2 lists the structural checks. Both derivatives agree with central finite differences to about 10^{-10}, the rounding level of the differences.

Table 2. Checks of the liquefaction module.

Check	Expected	Computed
MSF at M = 7.5	1 (definition)	1.000
K_σ at $\sigma'_v = P_a$	1 (definition)	1.000
r_d at the surface, M = 6.4	close to 1	1.008
$CRR_{7.5,1}$ at q_{c1Ncs} = 100	from (4.5)	0.137
(4.9) against finite differences	relative error ≈ 0	3.3×10^{-10}
(3) against finite differences	relative error ≈ 0	3.4×10^{-10}

3.4 An example profile

A coastal profile of a 1.2 m crust over three sands (median q_{c1Ncs} of 82, 104 and 132, with CPT-like scatter) separated by silty clays was shaken by M 6.4 at 0.25 g with the water table at 0.8, 1.6 and 2.6 m. The LPI is 20.2, 14.9 and 9.3 (Figure 2). The upper sand carries most of the LPI, because there the stress is low and the weight $10 - 0.5z$ is high; this is why the LPI is so sensitive to the water table when the liquefiable layers are shallow, as Maurer et al. [11] observed.

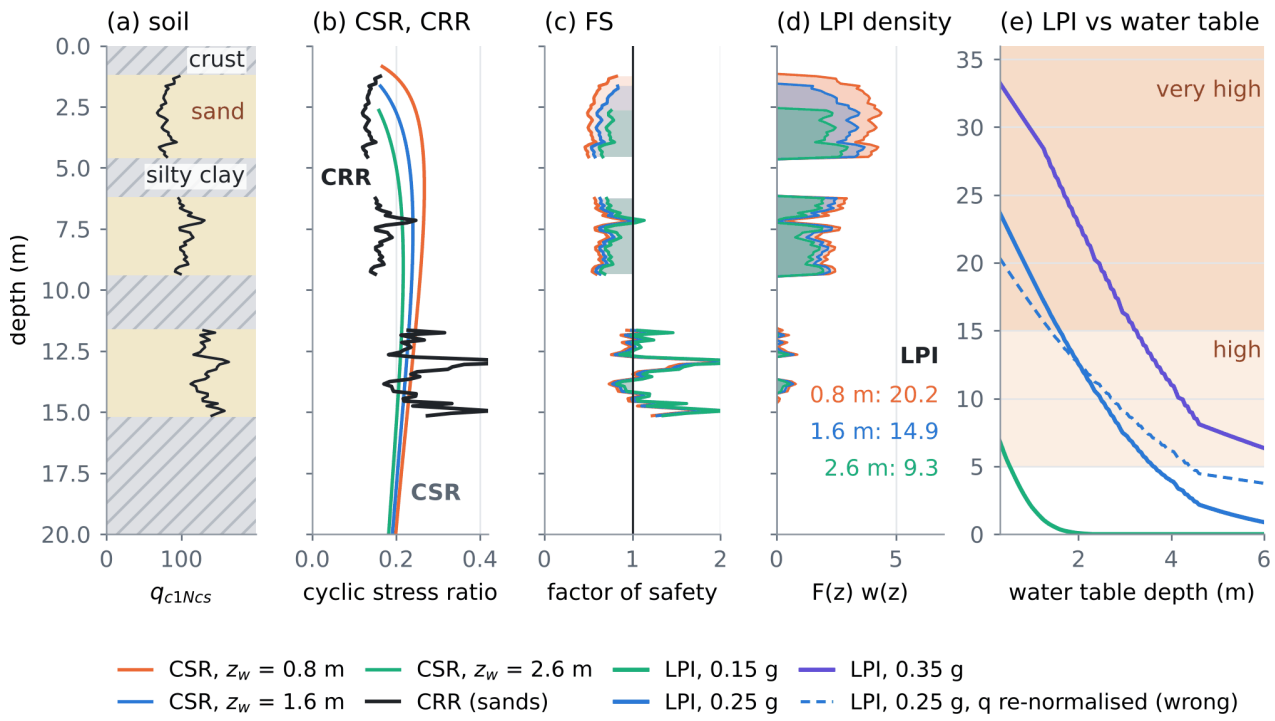


Figure 2. E1. (a) The profile: crust and silty clays hatched, sands shaded, q_{c1Ncs} as a line. (b) CSR for three water tables and CRR of the sands. (c) Factor of safety; shaded where FS < 1. (d) The LPI integrand and the LPI for each water table. (e) LPI against the depth of the water table for three accelerations; dashed: the shortcut of Section 3.2. Shading: high (5–15) and very high (over 15) LPI.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

4. E2: the coseismic step

4.1 Okada's solution, written and checked

The surface displacement of a rectangular dislocation in an elastic half-space [1] was written in numpy (okada85.py), and the horizontal strains were taken by fourth-order central differences. The note cites Okada [2], the internal-deformation form; the surface form [1] is the one needed for a shallow layer (Section 4.3). Five tests that do not use the code itself (okada_checks.py) all pass (Table 3).

Table 3. Independent checks of okada85.py.

Test	What must hold	Result
C1. Fault reaching the surface	jump of displacement across the trace = slip vector (strike-slip, and reverse at 45°)	error ≤ 6.1×10^{-5} m per m of slip
C2. Point-source limit	a 200 m fault far away = the point-source formulas of [1] × area	relative error ≤ 6.1×10^{-4}
C3. Plane strain	a 2000 km fault: surface displacement independent of ν	0.2% change for ν 0.25 → 0.40 (20 km fault: 5.2%)
C4. Sense of motion	reverse lifts the hanging wall, normal lowers it; left-lateral moves the far side left	u_z = +0.227 and -0.227 m; u_n = +0.051 (east), -0.051 (west) m
C5. Strain step	strain independent of the difference step (1, 2, 4 m)	relative change ≤ 1.8×10^{-11}

4.2 Four published source models

The geometry of each model was taken from its abstract; what an abstract did not give was derived from the moment magnitude with uniform slip, $M_0 = \mu LWs$, $M_w = (\log_{10} M_0 - 9.1)/1.5$ [3], μ = 30 GPa (Table 4). The strike follows the NW–SE trend of the structure, set by the dip direction. All four are reverse faults (rake 90°).

Table 4. The source ensemble. Bold: from the abstract of the paper; the rest derived here.

Model	Dip	Centroid depth	L × W (km)	Slip (m)	Mw here
Ganas et al. 2020 [4]	**23° E**	**16.5 km**	**22 × 13**	**0.55**	6.38
Matraku et al. 2023 [6]	**40° E**	**15 km**	20 × 11	0.71 (uniform)	**6.38**
Govorčin et al. 2020 [5]	**71° SW**	17 km (**slip at 11–23 km**)	18 × 12.7	0.52 (uniform)	**6.30**
van der Heiden et al. 2026 [7]	**about 30° NE**	15 km (**12–18 km**)	20 × 12	0.70 (uniform)	**6.40**

4.3 The undrained step in a layer under the free surface

Equation (2.2) of [D1] gives the step as $\Delta p_0 = -BK_u\Delta\varepsilon_v$, with $\Delta\varepsilon_v$ the volumetric strain of the half-space (2.1). That is right for an aquifer as stiff as the half-space. The sediments of a coastal plain are much softer and lie in a layer tens to hundreds of metres thick, against a deformation field that varies over kilometres. Such a layer takes the horizontal strain of the crust beneath it, while its top is free: $\sigma_{zz} = 0$.

Proposition 2 (the step under a free surface). For an undrained ($\zeta = 0$) poroelastic layer obeying (1.1)–(1.2) of [D1], with imposed horizontal strains and $\sigma_{zz} = 0$,

$$\Delta p_0 = -\kappa\,\Delta\varepsilon_a, \qquad \Delta\varepsilon_a = \Delta\varepsilon_{xx} + \Delta\varepsilon_{yy}, \qquad \kappa = \frac{2GB}{3}\,\frac{1+\nu_u}{1-\nu_u} \tag{4}$$

with G, B and ν_u of the layer. Equivalently $\Delta p_0 = -BK_u\Delta\varepsilon_v$ with the volumetric strain of the layer, $\Delta\varepsilon_v = \Delta\varepsilon_a(1-2\nu_u)/(1-\nu_u)$, not that of the half-space. A soft saturated layer ($\nu_u \to 1/2$) deforms at almost constant volume, and $\kappa \to 2GB$: the step scales with the shear modulus of the layer, not with the stiffness of its water.

Proof. With $\zeta = 0$, (1.2) gives $p = -\alpha M\varepsilon_v$, and (1.1) becomes undrained elasticity with $\lambda_u = 2G\nu_u/(1-2\nu_u)$. Then $\sigma_{zz} = 0$ gives $\varepsilon_{zz} = -\nu_u\varepsilon_a/(1-\nu_u)$, so $\varepsilon_v = \varepsilon_a(1-2\nu_u)/(1-\nu_u)$. With $\alpha M = BK_u$ and $K_u = 2G(1+\nu_u)/[3(1-2\nu_u)]$, $p = -BK_u\varepsilon_v$ is (4). The identity was checked against (1.1)–(1.2) solved directly for five random materials, to 2×10^{-16}. □

At the surface of the half-space $\Delta\varepsilon_v = \Delta\varepsilon_a(1-2\nu)/(1-\nu)$, so (2.2) as written corresponds to $\kappa_{(2.2)} = BK_u(1-2\nu)/(1-\nu)$ = 3.33 GPa for BK_u = 5 GPa and ν = 0.25. Table 5 compares the three coefficients. The confined aquifer and the soft sand are placeholders until G is measured (seismic CPT or surface waves) and B is taken from the tidal response of the wells, as Section 8 of [D1] proposes.

Table 5. The step coefficient and the step over the four source models. Head per microstrain of areal strain; ranges are the extremes of the four maps.

Layer	G, B, νu	κ	Head per microstrain	Fall (hanging wall)	Rise (in front)
Soft surface sand	50 MPa, 0.98, 0.49	95 MPa	10 mm	7–12 cm	3–4 cm
Confined aquifer	0.5 GPa, 0.90, 0.45	0.79 GPa	81 mm	0.6–1.0 m	0.2–0.3 m
(2.2) as written	BK_u = 5 GPa, ν = 0.25	3.33 GPa	340 mm	35 × soft sand	4.2 × confined

4.4 The pattern and the agreement of the models

All four models put a fall of the head over the hanging wall, where the uplifted crust is stretched, and a rise in front of the buried top edge and behind the fault, where it is squeezed (Figure 3a–d). Where the areal strain of any model exceeds 0.75 microstrain, the four agree on the sign over 86% of the area. They disagree in a ring around the fall (Figure 3e, dotted), whose position is set by the dip: the 71° model of Govorčin et al. narrows the fall and moves the rise towards the trace. The

ensemble therefore carries a real epistemic spread, as [D1] anticipated, but not in the sign over the hanging wall.

4.5 Drainage during the shaking

A sand connected to the water table through sand drains during the shaking. For one-dimensional diffusion from the water table, the share of the step left after a shaking of duration t_s at depth L below the water table is

$$f(L) = \operatorname{erf}\left(\frac{L}{2\sqrt{D\,t_s}} \right) \quad \text{for sand connected through sand;} \qquad f = 1 \quad \text{for sand sealed by clay} \tag{5}$$

With a diffusivity of 1 m²/s and 15 s of shaking, 7% of the step is left at 0.5 m, 28% at 2 m, 64% at 5 m and 97% at 12 m (Figure 3g). The shallow sands that dominate the LPI lose most of a step in seconds; a sand sealed by clay keeps it.

4.6 The earthquake as a free pumping test

After the step, a confined sand below a leaky clay relaxes as $\Delta h(t) = \Delta h_0 e^{-t/\tau}$, which is (2.3) of [D1] reduced to one compartment. The leakage time τ is the quantity that a pumping test measures. A 0.3 m step with τ = 3 days was recorded every 15 minutes with 2 cm noise for 20 days. The fit gives $\hat{\tau}$ = 3.00 days and a 95% bootstrap interval of 2.94–3.07 days. The same τ from the phase lag of a whole year of daily heads (amplitude 0.5 m, same noise) has an interval of 2.67–3.37 days, 5.8 times wider (Figure 3h). Every well in the confined aquifer that logged the night of 26 November 2019 holds such a test.

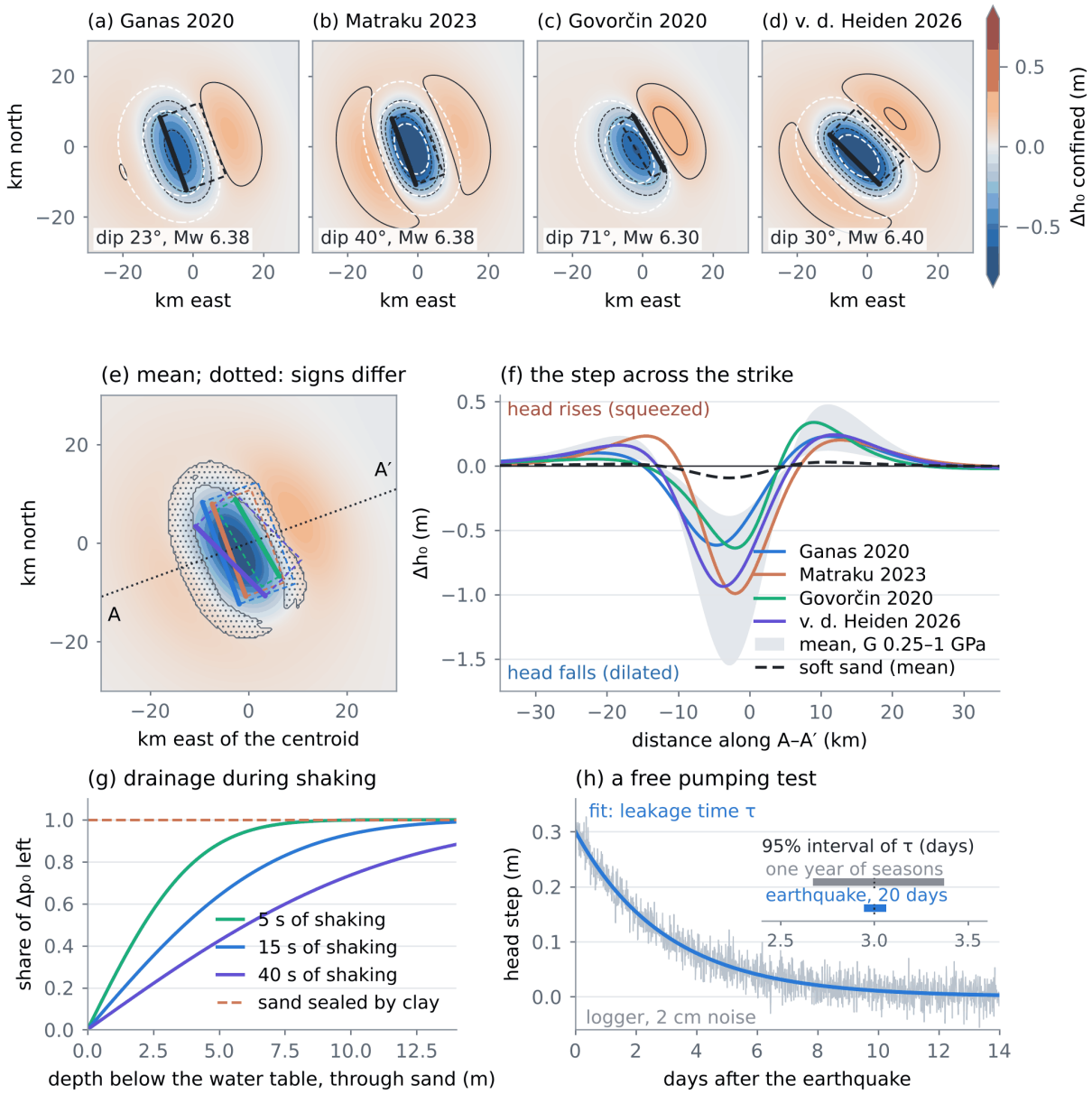


Figure 3. E2. (a–d) Head step in the confined aquifer for the four source models; contours at −0.5, −0.25, −0.1, 0.1 and 0.25 m; white dashed: uplift of 2, 5 and 10 cm; thick line: top edge of the fault. (e) Mean of the four; dotted where they disagree on the sign; A–A′: the transect. (f) The step along A–A′: the four models in the confined aquifer, the band of the mean for G from 0.25 to 1 GPa, and the mean in the soft surface sand. (g) Share of the step left after the shaking, (5). (h) The relaxation after a 0.3 m step and the 95% intervals of τ from the earthquake and from a year of seasons.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

5. E3: designing the 2019 hindcast

The third step of [D1] is to ask whether the water table of the day and the step improve the prediction of where liquefaction occurred in 2019 [8]. Before collecting data, the test was designed on a synthetic coastal plain: 900 sites within 8 km of a coast that strikes N160°, over the fault of Ganas et al., each with a layered profile whose share of sand follows a smooth susceptibility field, a seasonal water table, and a peak acceleration that decays with distance with lognormal scatter. The truth uses the water table of 26 November and the largest step, (2.2) as written; 38% of the sites liquefy. Four predictors were compared by the area under the ROC curve (AUC), with the DeLong covariance for paired AUCs [15] and a one-sided test at 5%:

- M0: mean water table; M1: water table of the day; M2: M1 plus the step of the four-model mean; M3: M1 plus the step of the true source.

On all 900 sites the AUCs are 0.736, 0.738, 0.753 and 0.754 (Figure 4b). The gains are small because most of the information sits in the soil and the shaking. Table 6 gives the power: the chance that a hindcast with N mapped sites detects the gain.

Table 6. Power of the paired-AUC test (400 resamples per size, one-sided, 5%).

Test	N = 30	60	120	240	480
Water table of the day (M1 vs M0)	1%	5%	7%	13%	26%
Step, four-model mean (M2 vs M1)	7%	12%	14%	24%	40%
Step, true source (M3 vs M1)	6%	14%	17%	30%	49%

With the coefficient of soft sand (Section 4.3) the step changes the LPI of a site by a median of 0.02 and at most 0.77, against a median of 0.69 for the upper bound (Figure 4d). No number of sites would detect it. **Design conclusion:** the liquefaction map of 2019 cannot test the coseismic step, and it tests the water table of the day only with several hundred CPTs at mapped sites. The step should be tested where it is large, in the confined aquifer, on the well records of November 2019 (Section 4.6). A liquefaction hindcast remains useful to calibrate the triggering at the site, but with its low power stated in advance.

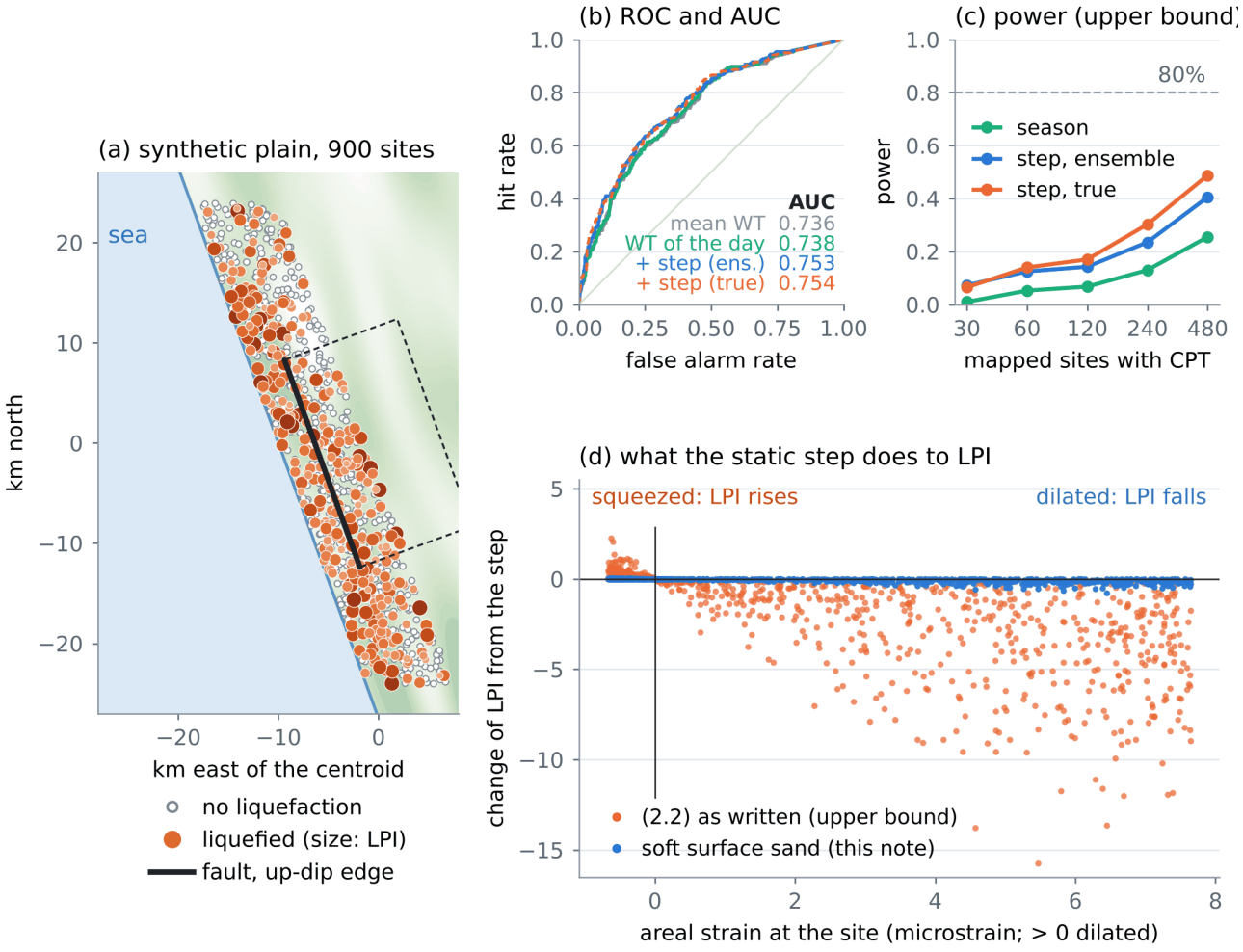


Figure 4. E3. (a) The synthetic plain: sites without and with liquefaction (size: LPI), the coast and the fault. (b) ROC curves and AUCs of the four predictors. (c) Power against the number of mapped sites (upper-bound step). (d) Change of LPI caused by the step, against the areal strain at the site: (2.2) as written (orange) and soft surface sand (blue).

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

6. E4: the joint safe window and the daily bulletin, computed

6.1 Two limits on one head

Let h be the managed head at a low coastal site above mean sea level, z_s the ground elevation and $z^\star(a)$ the depth that the water table must keep for the LPI to stay below 5 under the design acceleration a, certified as the 90% quantile over the profiles of the site. Liquefaction asks for $h \le z_s - z^\star(a)$. The Ghyben–Herzberg relation (3.7) of [D1] keeps the interface at least 20 m deep if $h \ge \eta + m_{int}$ with m_{int} = 20/40 = 0.5 m, η being the relative sea-level rise [16]. This is the certified multi-hazard window of the proposal [D2], written for one managed head. The window and its width are

$$\eta + m_{int} \;\le\; h \;\le\; z_s - z^\star(a), \qquad W(\eta, a) = z_s - z^\star(a) - \eta - m_{int} \tag{6}$$

A head that swings by A over the year stays inside all year only if $W \ge A$. The window closes for good at

$$\eta_{close}(a) = z_s - z^\star(a) - m_{int} - A \tag{7}$$

Both limits move the wrong way with time: sea-level rise and subsidence (3.3)–(3.5) of [D1] raise η; a larger design acceleration deepens $z^\star$. Pumping to fight liquefaction lowers h towards intrusion; recharge to fight intrusion raises it towards liquefaction.

6.2 The port of E4

A synthetic low port: ground at z_s = 2.0 m, 60 CPT-like profiles with sands from 1–2 m depth, A = 0.3 m. Table 7 and Figure 5 give the result. The median profile needs no lowering up to 0.22 g; the window is set by the weakest tenth of the port.

Table 7. The water table that keeps 90% of the port below LPI 5, and the sea level at which the all-year window closes. Years at an illustrative 9 mm/yr of relative sea-level rise (4 mm/yr of sea and 5 mm/yr of subsidence, not measured values).

Design acceleration	z* certified (90%)	z* median	η at closing	Year
0.15 g	0.00 m	0.00 m	1.20 m	about 2159
0.18 g	0.27 m	0.00 m	0.93 m	about 2129
0.20 g	0.91 m	0.00 m	0.29 m	about 2059
0.22 g	1.76 m	0.00 m	-0.56 m	closed already
0.25 g	2.89 m	0.25 m	-1.69 m	closed already

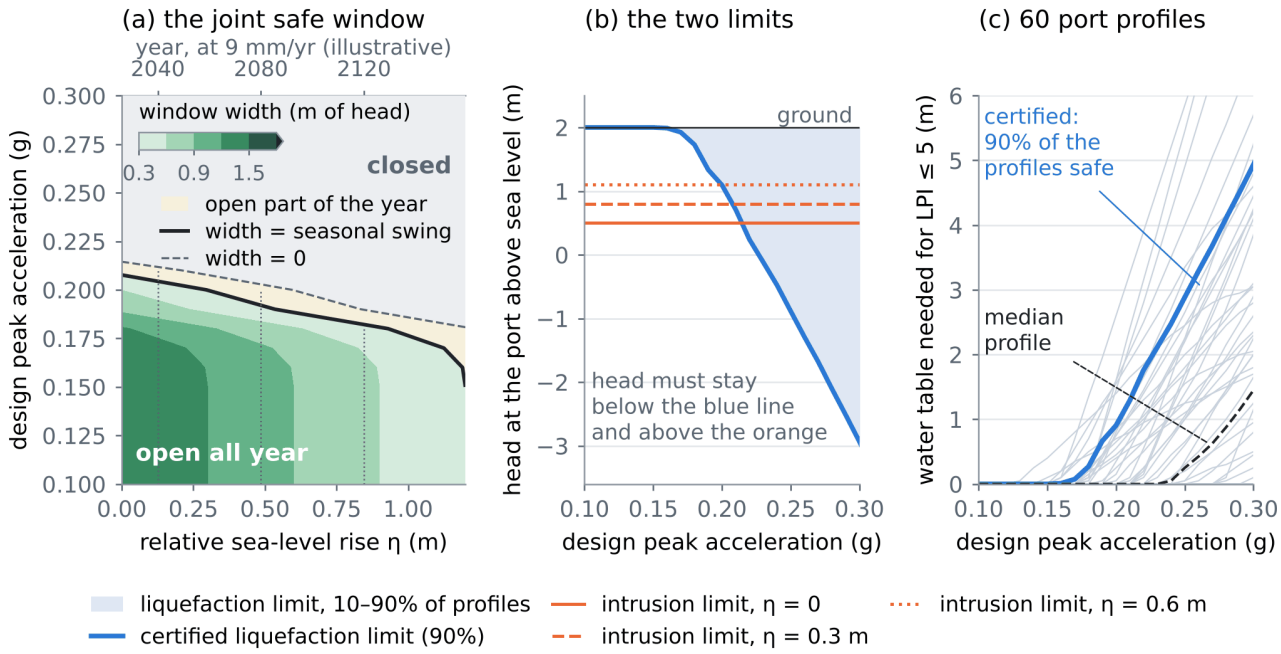


Figure 5. E4. (a) Width of the joint window against relative sea-level rise and design acceleration; the solid line is where it equals the seasonal swing, the dashed line where it vanishes; top axis: years at an illustrative 9 mm/yr. (b) The two limits on the head: liquefaction (blue, certified) and intrusion (orange) for three sea levels. (c) The water table needed for LPI ≤ 5 in each of the 60 profiles, their median and the certified 90% line.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

6.3 The daily bulletin

The same profiles give, for each day d, the probability that the LPI exceeds 5 if the design earthquake (M 6.4, median 0.22 g, lognormal scatter 0.35) struck that day:

$$P_d = \Pr\left[\text{LPI} > 5 \mid \text{earthquake on day } d\right] = \frac{1}{N_p N_a} \sum_{i=1}^{N_p} \sum_{j=1}^{N_a} \mathbf{1}\left[\text{LPI}_i(z_w(d), a_j) > 5\right] \tag{8}$$

with N_p = 60 profiles and N_a = 12 accelerations. With the natural water table moving between 0.9 and 2.0 m, P_d moves between 0.16 in late July and 0.26 in early February (Figure 6). With the logger network of the project, $z_w(d)$ is measured, and the bulletin can be issued daily, with the conformal or certified bounds of the CERTAIN-COAST cycle in place of the plain quantiles used here.

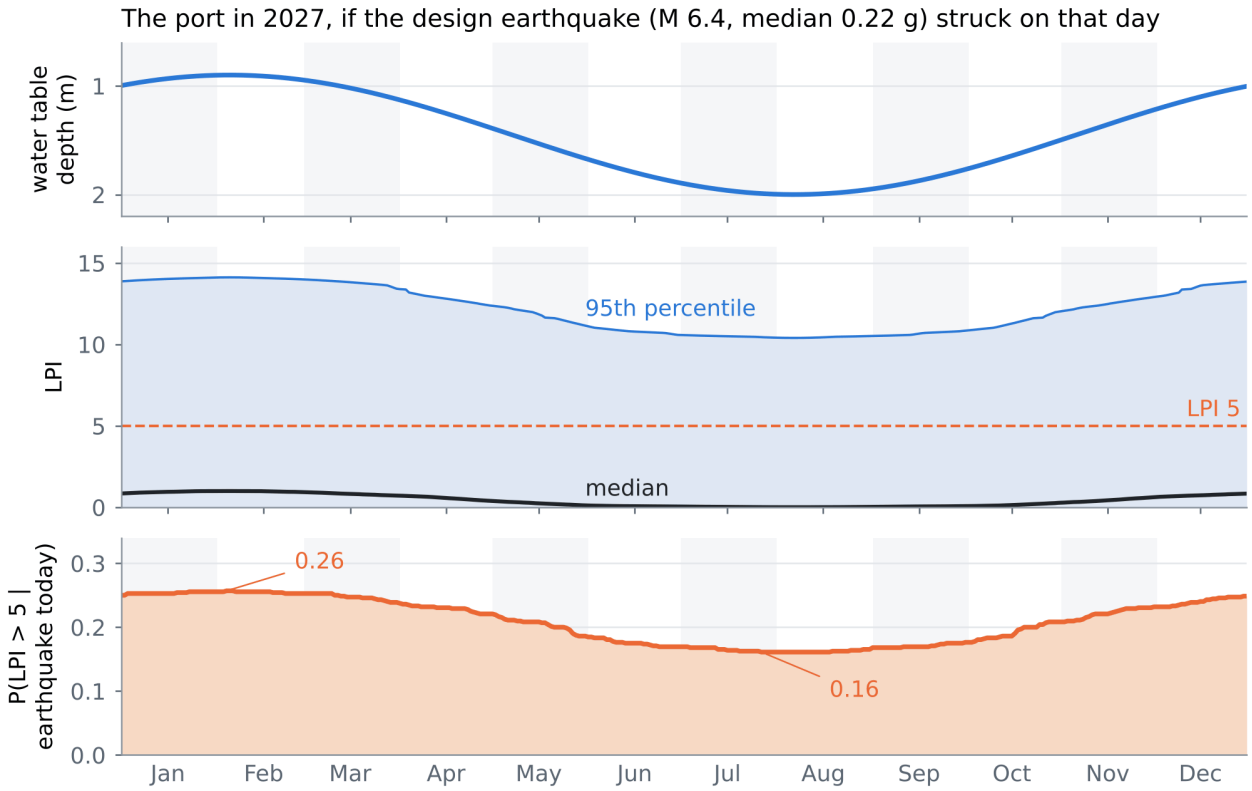


Figure 6. The daily bulletin for the port in 2027. Top: the water table. Middle: the median and the 5–95% band of the LPI over profiles and accelerations. Bottom: the probability that the LPI exceeds 5 if the earthquake struck that day.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

7. What changes in the note

The revised Albanian note [D1] carries these changes. Its first page lists them, and each new paragraph opens with a short bold title:

- **(4.1)–(4.2).** The step enters the pore pressure, $u = \gamma_w (z - z_w)_+ + f \Delta p_0$ (1), with the drainage share (5); the water table does not jump.
- **(2.2).** For a layer under the free surface, $\Delta p_0 = -\kappa \, \Delta \varepsilon_a$ (4); in soft sand the step is centimetres. The mechanism paragraph now separates the static step from the volumetric change caused by the shaking (Wang and Chia [14]), which CSR–CRR already contains, so that it is not counted twice.
- **(2.4).** The constant: from $e = 3E/(4\pi r^3)$ and $\log_{10} E = 5.24 + 1.44M$ it is −4.38, not −4.62; for M 6.4 the radius of e = 0.1 J/m³ becomes 88 km instead of 73 km. Both are larger than the distance from the 2019 source to the Durrës–Fushë Kuqe coast (a few tens of kilometres), so no decision there depends on it. Wang and Chia [14] present the relation as new; its printed constant must be read there before use.
- **4.5.** q_{c1Ncs} is fixed by the CPT; the full sensitivity is (3); the shortcut of Section 3.2 biases the slope by 33%.
- **3.3.** The compaction equations are those of the CSUB package of MODFLOW 6 [20], which replaces SUB-WT.
- **5.6.** Settlement from liquefaction is the integral of the post-shaking volumetric strain over depth, with the strain from FS and q_{c1Ncs} as in Zhang et al. [19]; the coefficients are taken from that paper, not repeated here.

Verification note. The external references [1–20] were checked in Crossref (DOI, authors, title, venue), November 2026, except the report [9], which has no DOI. The geometry of the source models comes from their abstracts. The note was drafted with the help of an AI assistant. Every number is computed by the SHOCK-GO experiment (the main script, okada_checks.py; results in res/) and inserted by the build script.

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Notes of this series (preparatory work of the NPD's team)

[D1] Zeqiraj, D. (2026). The earthquake, the aquifer, human action and flooding: the coupled system of equations for the Durrës–Fushë-Kuqe coast (in Albanian). Working note, 31 October 2026; revised version available on request.

[D2] CERTAIN-COAST (2026). Certified early warning to protect water, port and energy infrastructure on a sinking Adriatic coast. Technical annex of the NATO SPS application, Part 3 of these files.

PART 7

Decisions in extreme events: final assembled system and deep reinforcement learning

The decisions the operators and the end-user must take when an extreme event comes, the equations of the project as one final assembled system with the decisions in it, and deep reinforcement learning that recommends only decisions inside the certified safe window. Supplement to WP2, WP3 and WP5.

CERTAIN-COAST — Decisions in extreme events

The decisions the operators must take, the final assembled system of equations, and deep reinforcement learning kept inside the certified limits

NATO SPS Multi-Year Project, call 2027-1. Supplement to WP2, WP3 and WP5. Equations are native Word math; references were checked in Crossref.

When an extreme event comes, a drought with a storm surge, an earthquake or a sea level higher than any on record, the operators of the wellfields, the port and the energy landfall, and the Institute of Geosciences (IGJEO) that issues the bulletins, must decide quickly, with incomplete data, and with decisions that pull the hazards in opposite directions. This part states those decisions, writes the equations of the project as one final assembled system in which the decisions are part of the state equations, and shows how deep reinforcement learning turns that system into recommended decisions that never leave the certified limits.

Innovation

The decision is part of the assembled system: one set of equations carries the hazards, the certified warnings and the decisions of every operator, and a deep reinforcement learning agent searches the decisions only inside the set that the certified margins keep safe, so its recommendations carry the same stated miss rate as the warnings.

1. The decisions in an extreme event

Who decides	Decision	Extreme events	Why it is hard
Water utility, wellfields of Durrës–Fushë-Kuqe	Cut or shift pumping between wells and fields; switch part of the supply to other sources; order a chloride sampling campaign	Drought with a storm surge; an earthquake that moves the heads	Less pumping protects the aquifer but leaves people short of water; chloride is seen weeks late, between two samples
Port of Durrës	Restrict berths and heavy loads; inspect the quay walls; dewater behind them	Earthquake; extreme sea level	The liquefaction risk depends on the water table of that day; every hour of a closed berth costs
Energy landfall near Fier (Trans Adriatic Pipeline)	Inspect and protect the landfall; adapt the operation	Storm surge; earthquake; subsidence	The event may be rarer than the record; a failure has international consequences
Institute of Geosciences (IGJEO), end-user	Issue, escalate or lift a warning bulletin for each asset	All three hazards at once	A false alarm erodes trust and a missed alarm costs most; the three hazards share one water table

Five features make these decisions hard. **Compound events:** the drivers act at once, a surge on a drought, an earthquake on a high water table [15]. **One lever, opposite effects:** pumping lowers liquefaction susceptibility but draws the saline wedge inland and compacts the clays (Part 1). **Beyond the record:** the event that matters may never have been observed, so it is represented by storylines [10] and by the extreme-value margins of the alarms (Part 3). **Time and irreversibility:** a salinised well or an inelastic compaction step does not come back. **Many decision-makers on**

one aquifer: each operator acts on its own objective, while the warnings and the water table are shared; adaptive pathways, forecast-based action and drought resilience analysis address parts of this [5, 3, 7], but none takes the decision from one physical model with a stated miss rate.

2. The final assembled system

The equations of Parts 2 to 6 are assembled into one system with one state. The state collects the heads h, the salt concentration c, the land motion u_z from the compaction of the clays, the pore pressure p of the layers under the free surface, and the memory states of the learned boundary. Flow and salt transport with variable density:

$$S_s \frac{\partial h}{\partial t} - \nabla \cdot \left[K \left(\nabla h + \frac{\rho - \rho_0}{\rho_0} \mathbf{e}_z \right) \right] = \sum_w Q_w(t)\, \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_w) + r(\mathbf{x}, t) \tag{1}$$

$$\phi \frac{\partial c}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\mathbf{q}\, c - \phi\, \mathbf{D}\, \nabla c) = 0, \qquad \mathbf{q} = -K \left(\nabla h + \frac{\rho - \rho_0}{\rho_0} \mathbf{e}_z \right) \tag{2}$$

The compaction of each clay layer ℓ of thickness b_ℓ lowers the land, with the elastic skeletal storage $S_{ke,\ell}$ above the preconsolidation head and the much larger inelastic one $S_{kv,\ell}$ below it; the land motion sets the relative sea level, and the relative sea level sets the seaward boundary as an equivalent fresh head:

$$\frac{\partial u_z}{\partial t} = - \sum_\ell b_\ell\, S_{k,\ell}(h_\ell) \frac{\partial h_\ell}{\partial t}, \qquad R(t) = \eta(t) - u_z(t), \qquad h \mid_{\text{sea}} = \frac{\rho_s}{\rho_0}(R(t) - z) + z \tag{3}$$

At the inland cut the model ends, and the aquifer beyond it is represented by the learned boundary of Part 5 (Proposition 1 there): in the Laplace variable s, the flux through the cut is

$$\hat{q}(s) = Z(s)\, \hat{u}(s), \qquad Z(s) = C + \sum_{n=1}^{N} w_n \frac{s}{s + \mu_n}, \qquad C \geq 0,\ w_n \geq 0,\ \mu_n > 0 \tag{4}$$

An earthquake at time τ_j is a jump of the state: the pore pressure of each layer under the free surface steps by Proposition 2 of Part 6, with the shear modulus G, the Skempton coefficient B and the undrained Poisson ratio ν_u of the layer and the horizontal strain $\Delta\varepsilon_a$ of the crust beneath it. The liquefaction factor of safety then follows the water table of that day:

$$p\left(\tau_j^+\right) = p\left(\tau_j^-\right) - \kappa\, \Delta\varepsilon_a(\tau_j), \qquad \kappa = \frac{2GB}{3} \frac{1 + \nu_u}{1 - \nu_u} \tag{5}$$

$$\mathrm{FS}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \frac{\mathrm{CRR}(\mathbf{x})}{\mathrm{CSR}(z_w(\mathbf{x}, t))}, \qquad \mathrm{CSR} = 0.65 \frac{a_{\max}}{g} \frac{\sigma_v}{\sigma'_v} r_d \tag{6}$$

The certified alarm k (intrusion, liquefaction, extreme water level) fires when the forecast of its indicator at lead time L_k comes within the margin m_k of its threshold τ_k; the margin adds the certified error Δ_k of the fast copy to the forecast error γ_k calibrated online (Eqs. (6)–(7) of Part 3):

$$A_k(t) = \mathbf{1}\left\{ \hat{I}_k(t + L_k) \geq \tau_k - m_k(t) \right\}, \qquad m_k(t) = \Delta_k(t) + \gamma_k(t) \tag{7}$$

Written together, Eqs. (1)–(7) are one controlled stochastic system. The rain, the sea and the pumping demand drive it continuously ($\mathbf{W}_t$), earthquakes and storm surges act as jumps (N_j), the decisions $\mathbf{u}_t$ of the operators enter as sources and boundary values, and the monitoring network designed for the warnings (WP4, Part 3) observes it:

$$d\mathbf{x}_t = F(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{u}_t, \theta)dt + G(\mathbf{x}_t)d\mathbf{W}_t + \sum_j J_j(\mathbf{x}_{t^-})dN_j(t), \qquad \mathbf{y}_t = H(\mathbf{x}_t) + \boldsymbol{\varepsilon}_t \tag{8}$$

The decision problem of the operators is a constrained Markov decision process [1]: keep the cost of the decisions (unmet water demand, closed berths, protective works, damage) as low as

possible while the probability that any hazard crosses its threshold within the horizon stays within the tolerance α_k agreed with the end-user:

$$\min_{\pi} \ \mathbb{E}_{\pi}\left[\sum_{t=0}^{T}\gamma^{t}\, c(\mathbf{x}_t,\mathbf{u}_t)\right] \quad \text{subject to} \quad \mathbb{P}_{\pi}(\exists\, t\le T:\ I_k(\mathbf{x}_t)>\tau_k)\le\alpha_k, \quad k=1,2,3 \tag{9}$$

Its feasible decisions at each bulletin form the certified safe operating window of Part 3 (Eq. (10) there): the decisions that meet the demand D, keep every hazard within its certified limit and cause no new permanent subsidence,

$$W_{\alpha}(R)=\left\{\mathbf{u}:\ Q_w\ge D,\quad \Pr_{\theta}\left[I_k(\mathbf{u},R;\theta)>\tau_k\right]\le\alpha_k\ (k=1,2,3),\quad h(\mathbf{x},\mathbf{u},R)\ge h_{\mathrm{pc}}(\mathbf{x})\right\} \tag{10}$$

Eqs. (1), (2), the compaction law of (3), (6) and the alarm (7), built from published conformal methods, are standard. Eqs. (4), (5) and (10) carry results of the preparatory work of this proposal (Parts 5, 6 and 3), and the assembly (8), with the shield (12) and the rule (13) for an empty window, is new here: the hazards, the certified warnings and the decisions in one system. The equations new in this proposal are set in red.

3. Deep reinforcement learning on the assembled system

3.1 The agent and its environment

Deep reinforcement learning [6] trains a neural policy π_{φ} that maps what is known at a bulletin, the assimilated state and its uncertainty b_t, to a decision $\mathbf{u}_t$. Its environment is the fast copy of the assembled system (8) with its certified error (Part 3, T2.4), driven by the forcing laws of Part 2 and by storylines of extremes: droughts, surges, earthquakes and their combinations. The reward is the negative cost $-c(\mathbf{x}_t,\mathbf{u}_t)$. Training runs on the model, never on the real wellfields; the theory of reinforcement learning with neural networks [11] and of tree search for rare, high-stakes choices [9] supports the two learning modes used, policy optimisation for routine operation and search for the extreme event.

3.2 Training with the constraints

The chance constraints of (9) enter the training through Lagrange multipliers $\lambda_k\ge 0$, one per hazard: the policy descends and the multipliers ascend [1, 8],

$$\mathcal{L}(\varphi,\boldsymbol{\lambda})=\mathbb{E}_{\pi_{\varphi}}\left[\sum_{t}\gamma^{t}\, c(\mathbf{x}_t,\mathbf{u}_t)\right]+\sum_{k}\lambda_k\left(\mathbb{P}_{\pi_{\varphi}}(\mathrm{miss}_k)-\alpha_k\right) \tag{11}$$

and the model uncertainty is met by training over the ensemble of parameters θ and storylines with a distributionally robust objective [12, 4].

3.3 The certified shield

A trained network can still propose a decision outside the safe set. The shield removes that risk: every proposed decision is projected onto the certified safe operating window (10) before it is recommended [2, 13],

$$\mathbf{u}_t=\underset{\mathbf{u}\in W_{\alpha}(R(t))}{\arg\min}\ \left\|\mathbf{u}-\pi_{\varphi}(b_t)\right\| \tag{12}$$

Because the window is built from the certified margins, every recommended decision keeps each hazard within its stated miss rate, whatever the network has learned; the network only chooses the best decision among the safe ones. Where the window is empty, the agent reports it, and that is the closing point of the window that Part 3 computes for planning. The reach-avoid probability of the neural policy is checked independently before live use [14].

3.4 When no decision is safe: the hardest decision

In the worst events the window (10) is empty: no decision keeps every hazard within its tolerance, and every choice moves one hazard above its limit to protect another. The agent then does not choose silently. It returns the decision that exceeds the tolerances least, weighted by priorities ω_k that the end-user and the operators agree before the season, over the set U of decisions the wells, the berths and the landfall can physically carry out:

$$\mathbf{u}_t^{\dagger} = \arg\min_{\mathbf{u}\in U} \sum_{k=1}^{3} \omega_k \left[\Pr_{\theta}\left(I_k(\mathbf{u}, R; \theta) > \tau_k\right) - \alpha_k \right]_+, \qquad \omega_k > 0, \quad [z]_+ = \max(z, 0) \tag{13}$$

With it the bulletin shows, for each hazard, by how much its tolerance is exceeded and for how long, under $\mathbf{u}_t^{\dagger}$ and under the other decisions on the trade-off between the hazards. The decision itself stays with the people: IGJEO convenes the operators concerned, they choose which hazard to accept above its tolerance, and the choice is logged with the bulletin so that it can be audited. Storylines of the event [10] make the trade-off concrete for the people who decide.

3.5 Who decides what, and when

Phase	Who decides	What is decided	What the system gives
Before the season, once a year	IGJEO with the operators of the wellfields, the port and the landfall	The tolerances α_k, the thresholds τ_k, the priorities ω_k of (13) and the action agreed for each alarm	The certified miss rates, the value of the warning for each user and the closing year of the safe window (Part 3)
When an alarm fires	Each operator	The action agreed in advance for that alarm, taken on the forecast and not after the damage [3]	The recommended decision (12) with the margins (7) and the lead time
When the safe window is empty	The operators concerned, convened by IGJEO	Which hazard to accept above its tolerance, and for how long	The decision (13), the trade-off between the hazards and the storylines of the event
After the event	IGJEO with the project (post-event protocol, T5.4)	New tolerances and actions; the record of the decisions and their outcomes	The recalibrated margins (7), the earthquake read as a free pumping test (Part 6) and the decisions compared with the recommendations

3.6 Applications

Application	Decision of the agent	Kept by the shield	Used by
Wellfield operation in a drought with a storm surge	Weekly pumping of every well and field	Chloride at the supply screens below the limit (intrusion alarm)	Water utility
Port after an earthquake	Which berths to restrict, where to dewater, the order of the inspections	Factor of safety of the quay foundations (liquefaction alarm)	Port of Durrës
Energy landfall in a storm or an earthquake	Inspection and protection schedule	Extreme water level and liquefaction at the landfall	Pipeline operator
Warning bulletins	Issue, escalate or lift each bulletin	Joint miss rate at most $\sum_k \alpha_k$	IGJEO
Monitoring	Which well to sample next, which logger to read	The certified band of the warning between samples	IGJEO and the utility

In live operation (WP5) the recommendations are issued with each bulletin beside the certified margins and the value of the warning for that user, and are compared with the decisions the operators actually take; at the hand-over (WP6, WP7) the procedure goes to IGJEO with its trained staff. The agent and the shield are released in the open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast.

4. Deep reinforcement learning in each part of these files

Part	What it gives to the deep reinforcement learning agent
1. State of the art	The gaps the agent closes: decisions taken from one physical model, each with a stated miss rate (innovations M1, M2, P3 and V1).
2. Mathematical state of the art	The laws of the random forcing and the decision map that fix the simulator on which the agent is trained.
3. Technical annex	The certified margins (6)–(7) of the annex and the safe operating window (10), which the shield enforces.
4. The assembled system	The environment itself: the goal-graded assembly makes it fast enough for many training episodes, and its adjoint gives the gradients.
5. The learned boundary	It closes the environment at the inland cut, so the agent is trained on the aquifer beyond the model as well.
6. The earthquake in the aquifer	The jump of pore pressure at each earthquake and the liquefaction constraint; the earthquake as a free pumping test sharpens the model the agent learns on.

5. Results of the author's MATLAB code

The figures below are computed with the author's open-source MATLAB package CERTAIN-COAST, version 0.1.0 (github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.24148762), by the script run_all_figures.m, run here in GNU Octave 8.4. They show what the agent is trained on: the physics of the environment, the certified alarm, the warnings between samples, the learned boundary, the observation network and the forcing. All cases are synthetic tests. The code is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

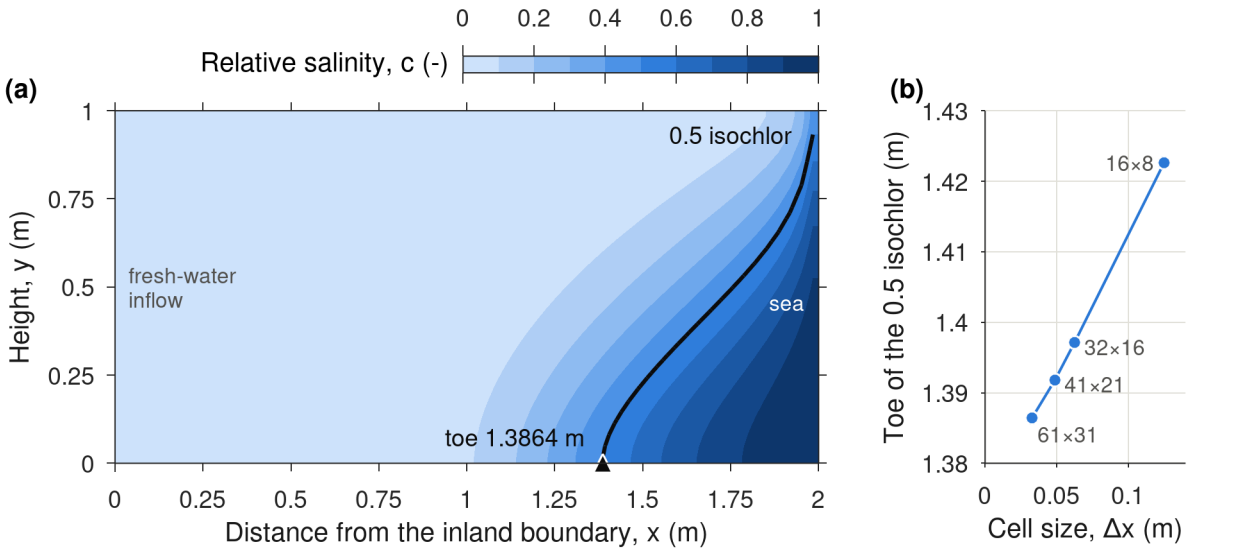


Figure 1. The environment of the agent: the variable-density solver of the package on the Henry benchmark of seawater intrusion (Henry number 0.1). (a) Relative salinity and the 0.5 isochlor on a 61 × 31 grid; its toe lies 1.386 m from the inland boundary. (b) The toe converges as the mesh is refined (1.423, 1.397, 1.392 and 1.386 m), with Newton residuals below 10^{-12}. Result of the author's MATLAB code.

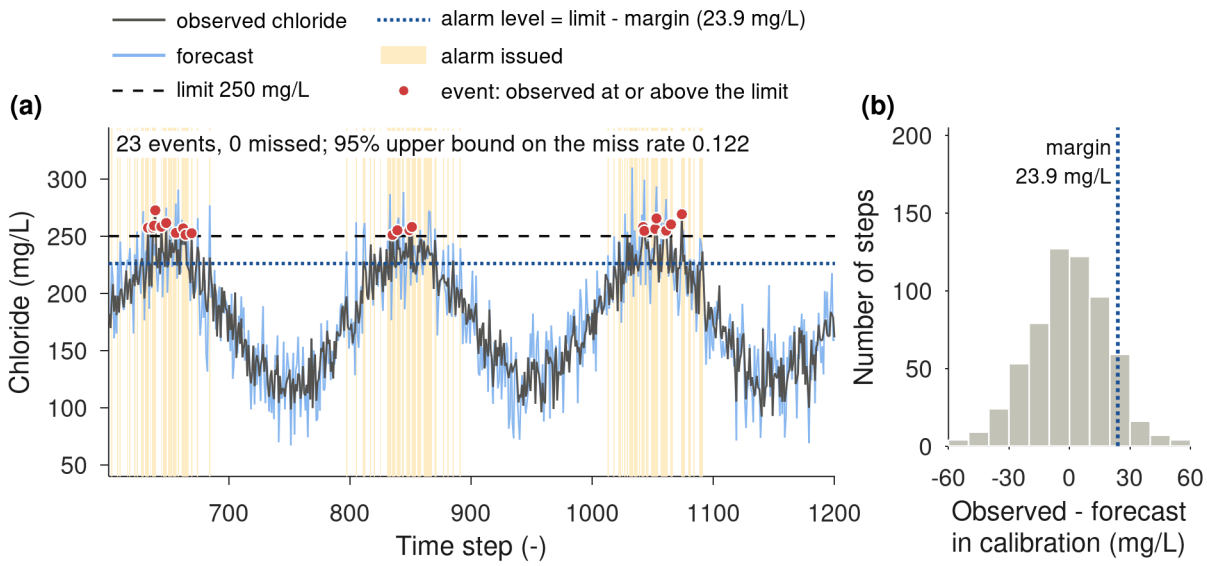


Figure 2. The certified alarm whose margins the shield uses, on a synthetic chloride record: a forecast, a margin of 23.9 mg/L calibrated on 600 earlier steps, and the alarm level of 226.1 mg/L. (a) In the 600 live steps all 23 events at or above 250 mg/L were warned (none missed; 95% upper bound on the miss rate 0.122). (b) The calibration errors and the margin. Result of the author's MATLAB code.

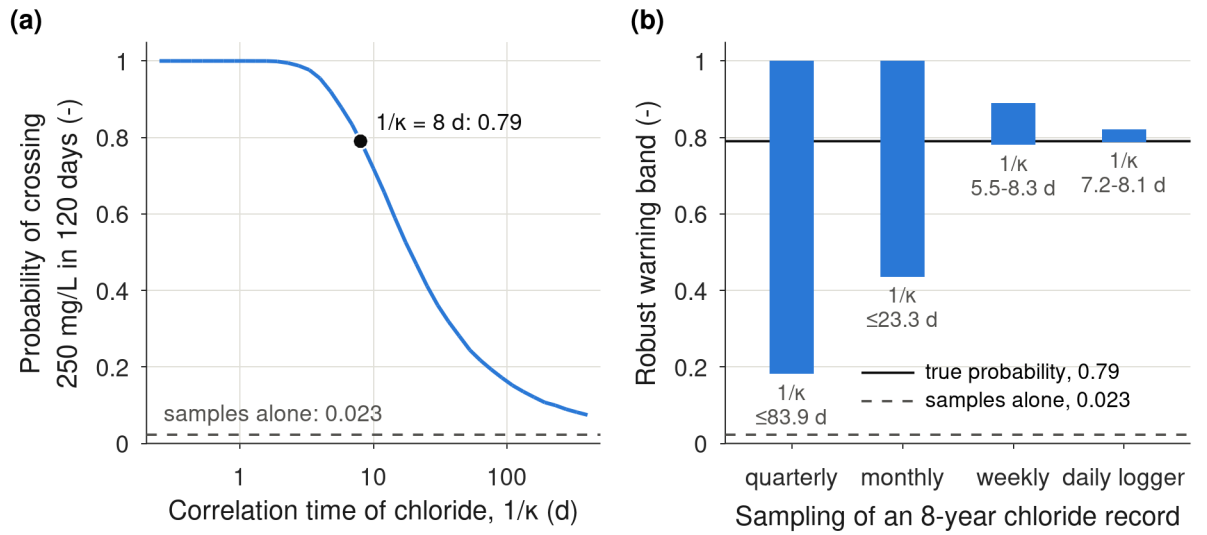


Figure 3. Warnings between samples. (a) The probability that chloride crosses 250 mg/L within a season of 120 days depends on its correlation time: 0.79 at 8 days, while the samples alone give 0.023. (b) The robust warning band from an 8-year record narrows from quarterly samples (0.18–1.00) to monthly (0.44–1.00), weekly (0.78–0.89) and a daily logger (0.79–0.82). Result of the author's MATLAB code.

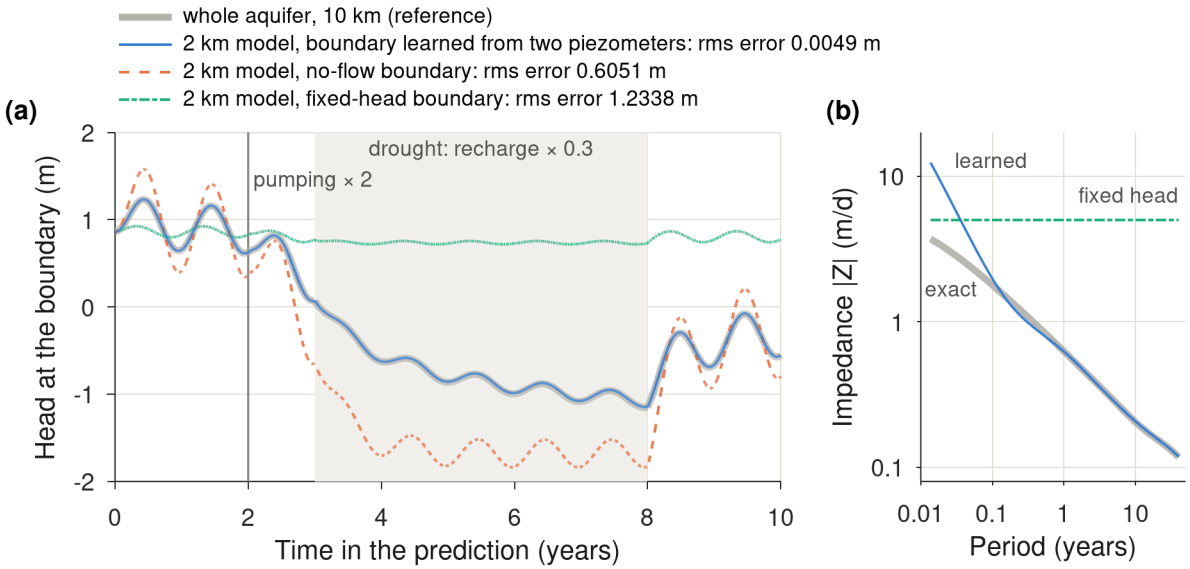


Figure 4. The learned boundary of Part 5 in the environment: a 2-km model of a 10-km aquifer predicts ten years of drought with doubled pumping. (a) With the boundary learned from two piezometers the head at the boundary cell stays within 0.0049 m (rms) of the whole aquifer, against 0.605 m with no flow and 1.234 m with a fixed head. (b) The impedance of the learned boundary matches the exact exterior within 1% at periods of one to forty years. Result of the author's MATLAB code.

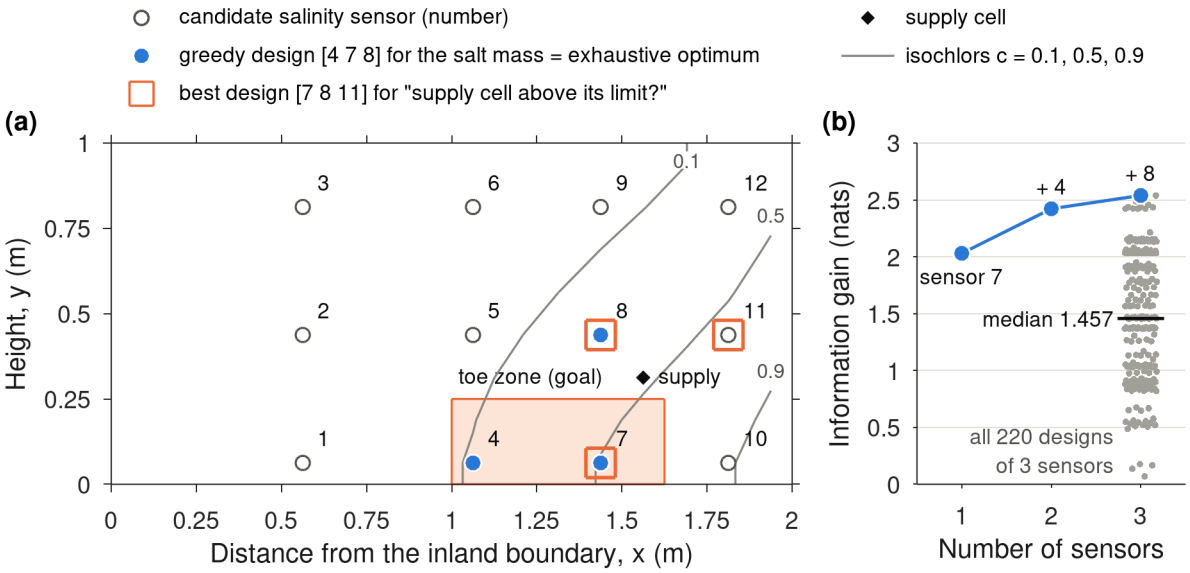


Figure 5. The network that observes the environment. (a) Among 12 candidate salinity sensors, the greedy design [4, 7, 8] for the salt mass near the toe equals the exhaustive optimum (2.539 nats) and gives 100% of the best information on whether the supply cell exceeds its limit. (b) The gain after each added sensor, against all 220 designs of three sensors (median 1.457 nats). Result of the author's MATLAB code.

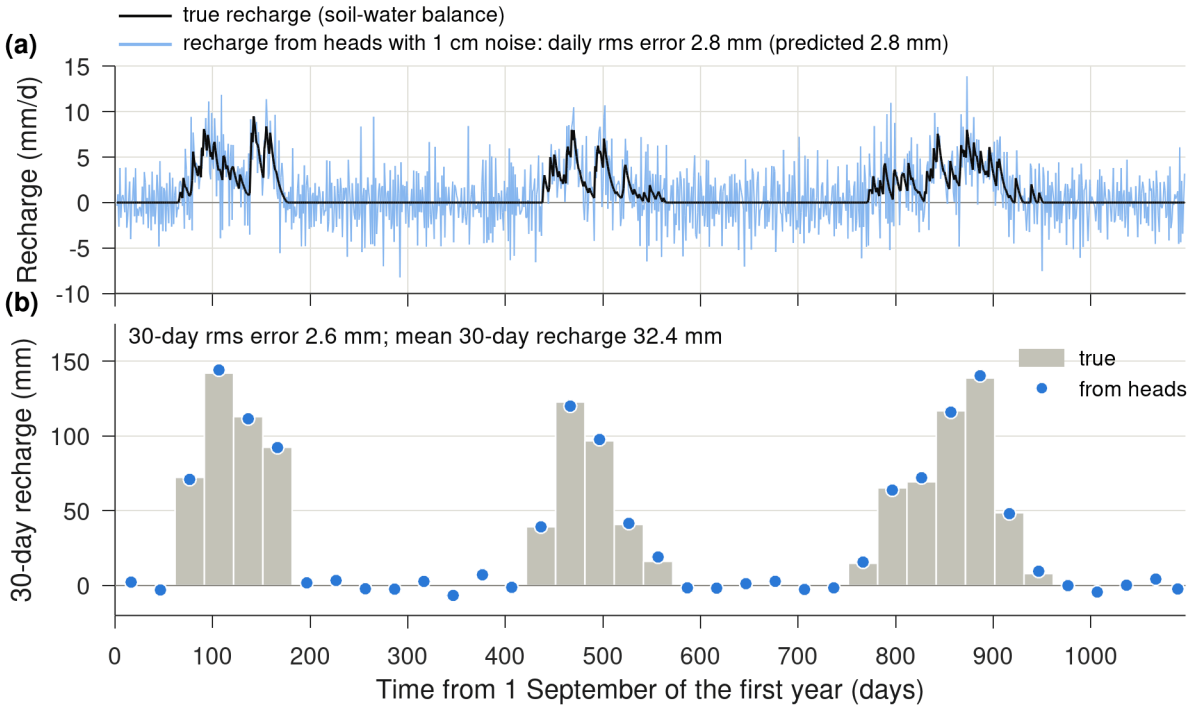


Figure 6. The forcing of the environment read from the heads. (a) Daily recharge reconstructed from heads with 1 cm noise (rms error 2.8 mm, as predicted). (b) Sums over 30 days: rms error 2.6 mm against a mean of 32.4 mm. The heads give the timing of the recharge and, with the specific yield from a pumping test, its amount. Result of the author's MATLAB code.

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Verification note. The references were checked in Crossref (DOI, authors, title, venue), November 2026.

PART 8

The project at a glance: structure, communication, team, deliverables and timeline

The work plan in five figures: who leads each work package and what passes between them, how the results reach each audience, who does the work, when each deliverable is due, and the Gantt chart with the evidence gates.

CERTAIN-COAST — The project at a glance

Structure, communication, team, deliverables and timeline of the work plan

The five figures show the work plan of the proposal: who leads each work package, what passes between them, how the results reach each audience, who does the work, when each deliverable is due and where the evidence gates stand on the critical path. They are drawn from the same tables as the form (work packages, tasks, deliverables, milestones, risks and participants), so the figures and the form cannot disagree.

Innovation

A work plan built around evidence gates: each certified result is tested at a gate with a stated pass test and a fallback before the next work package relies on it, and the gates stand on the critical path, so the plan shows where the project can fail early and what it does then.

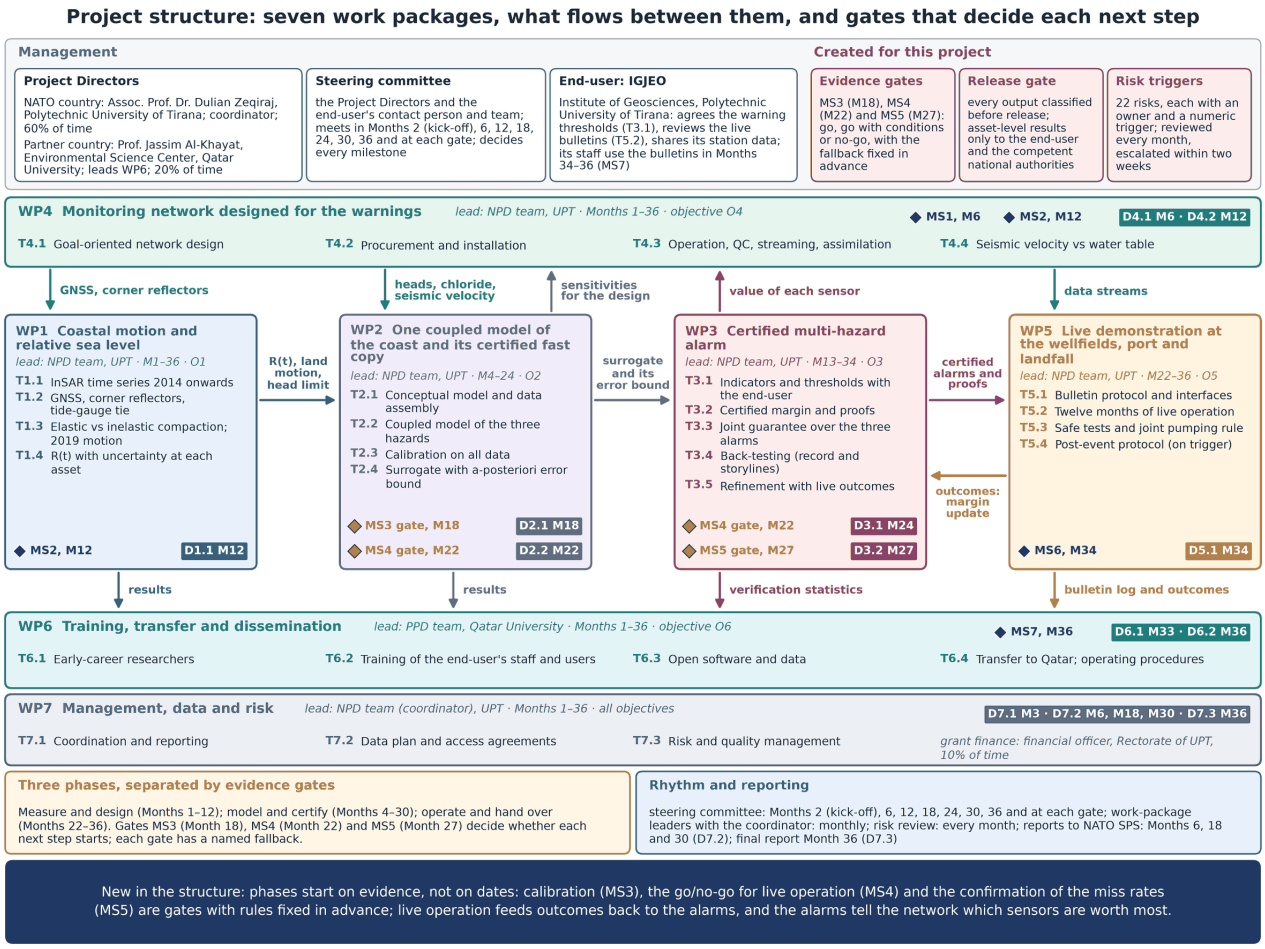


Figure 1. Project structure: the Project Directors, the steering committee and the end-user IGJEO; the seven work packages with their leads, months, tasks, milestones and deliverables; what flows between them; and the three evidence gates.

Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

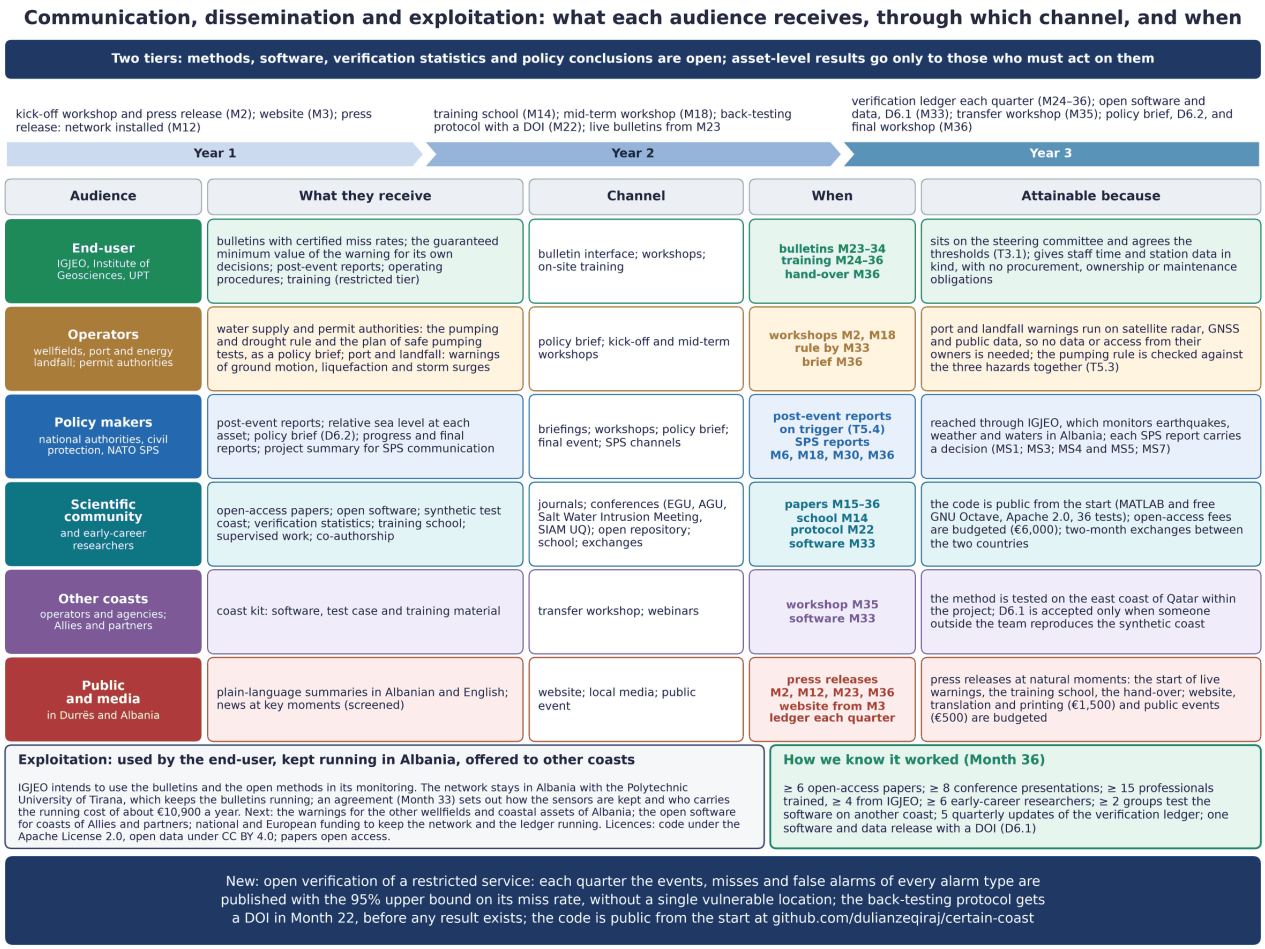


Figure 2. Communication, dissemination and exploitation for six audiences: what each receives, through which channel, when, and why it is attainable; the exploitation after the project and the indicators for Month 36. Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

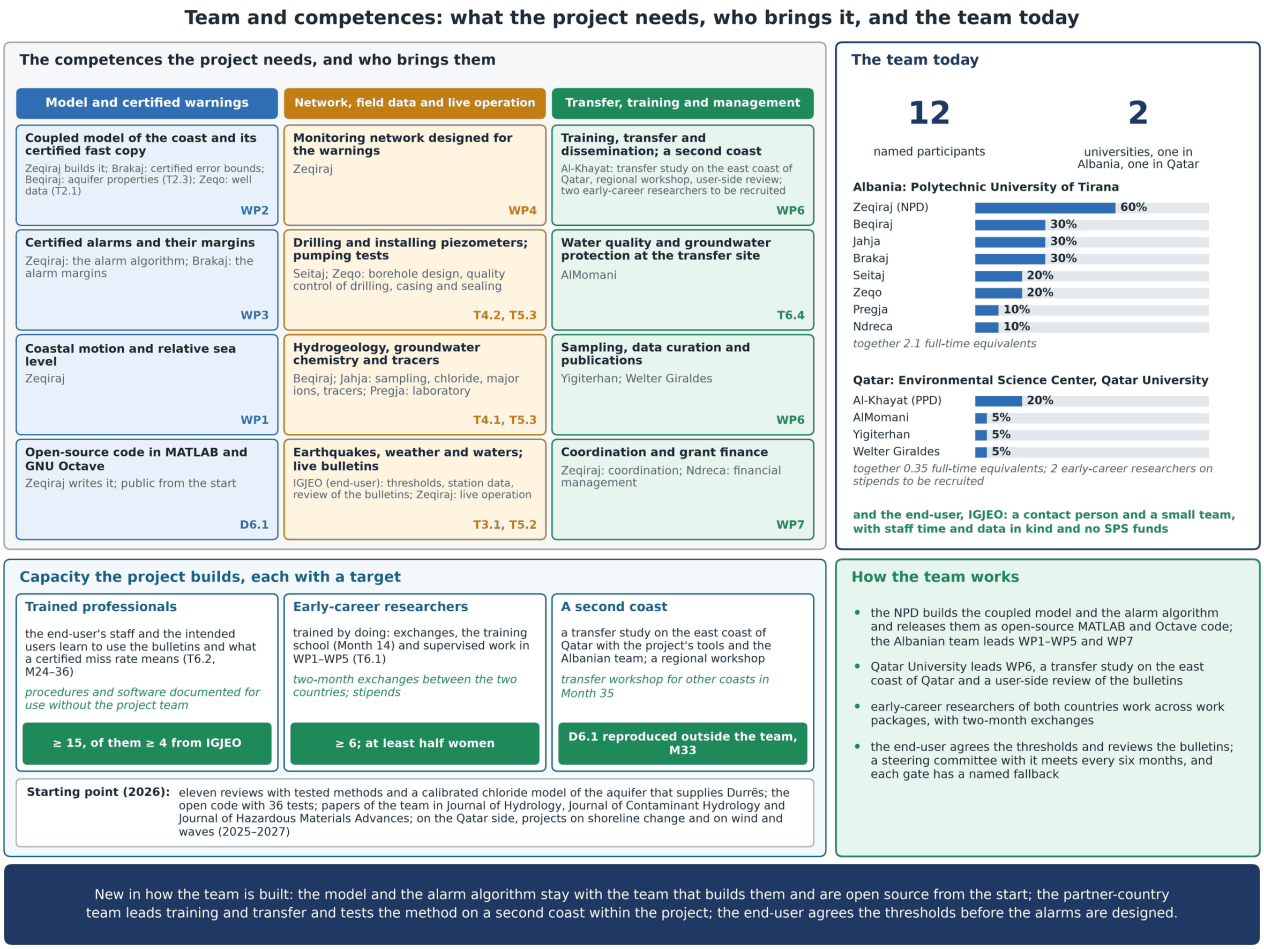
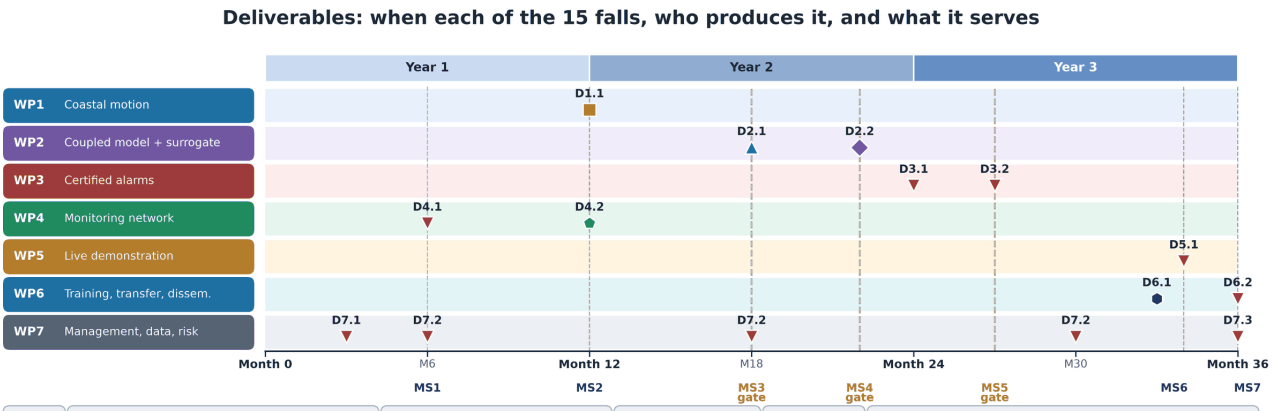


Figure 3. The team and its competences: the twelve competences the project needs and who brings them, the twelve named participants with their shares of time (2.1 full-time equivalents in Albania, 0.35 in Qatar), the capacity targets and how the team works.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.



D	Deliverable	Type · access	Lead	Month	Serves: milestone · feeds
D1.1	Coastal motion atlas and R(t) series	■ **data, report** · public + annex	NPD team	**M12**	**MS2** · WP2 sea boundary; WP3 extremes; WP5 pumping limit
D2.1	Calibrated coupled model	▲ **model** · public + annex	NPD team	**M18**	**MS3 gate** · D2.2; WP3; WP4 refinement
D2.2	Certified surrogate	◆ **software** · public + annex	NPD team	**M22**	**MS4 gate** · D3.1; live operation (WP5)
D3.1	Certified alarm algorithms and proofs	▼ **report** · public	NPD team	**M24**	D3.2; WP5 bulletins
D3.2	Back-testing report	▼ **report** · public + annex	NPD team	**M27**	**MS5 gate** · WP5; D5.1; papers
D4.1	Network design report	▼ **report** · restricted	NPD team	**M6**	**MS1** · D4.2; procurement (T4.2)
D4.2	Network installed and streaming	⬟ **demonstrator** · restricted	NPD team	**M12**	**MS2** · D1.1; D2.1; WP5
D5.1	Live demonstration report	▼ **report** · public + annex	NPD team	**M34**	**MS6** · D6.2; D7.3; papers
D6.1	Software and data release	⬢ **software, data** · public	PPD team	**M33**	Transfer workshop; other coasts
D6.2	Operating procedures and policy brief	▼ **report** · public + annex	PPD team	**M36**	**MS7** · Hand-over; national policy
D7.1	Data management plan and access agreements	▼ **report** · public + annex	NPD team (coordinator)	**M3**	All work packages
D7.2	Progress reports	▼ **report** · restricted	NPD team (coordinator)	**M6, M18, M30**	NATO SPS
D7.3	Final report	▼ **report** · public + annex	NPD team (coordinator)	**M36**	NATO SPS; follow-up funding

Lead: NPD team, Polytechnic University of Tirana (Albania); PPD team, Environmental Science Center, Qatar University (Qatar). Access: public; restricted; or public with a restricted annex for asset-level results. Months count from the start of the grant. D7.2 is the progress report at each SPS reporting milestone (Months 6, 18, 30), so the 13 deliverables count as 15.

New: every deliverable has a pass test stated in advance, and three of them decide the evidence gates (D2.1, D2.2 and D3.2 at Months 18, 22 and 27); the back-testing protocol of D3.2 is published with a DOI before the results; D6.1 is accepted only when someone outside the team installs the software and reproduces the synthetic coast.

Figure 4. Deliverables: the 13 deliverables (15 counting the three progress reports) on a timeline of Months 0–36 by work package, with their type and access, lead and month, and the milestone and work each one serves. Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

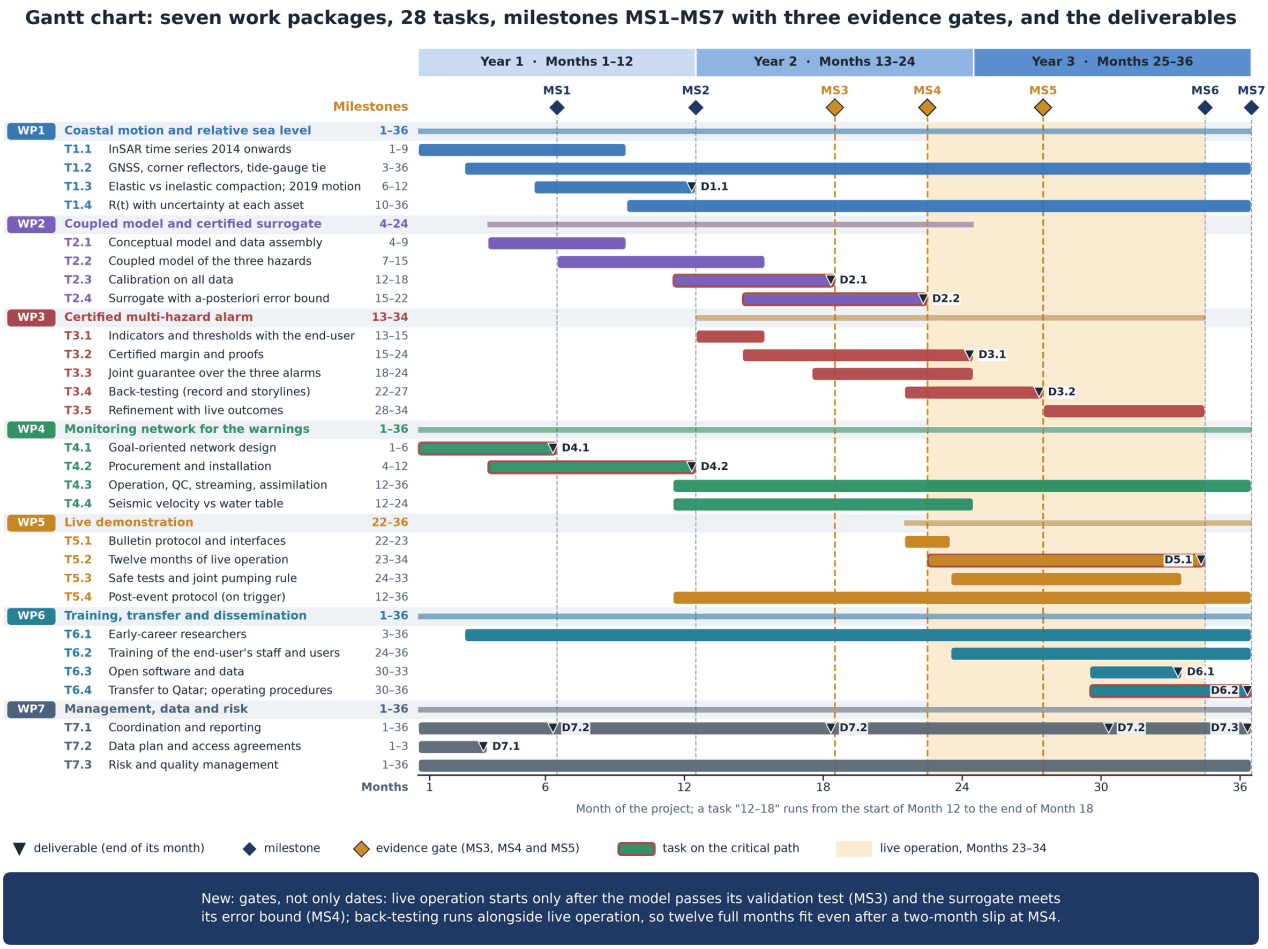


Figure 5. Gantt chart of the seven work packages and 28 tasks over 36 months: the milestones MS1–MS7, the evidence gates MS3–MS5, each deliverable at the end of the task that produces it, the critical path and the live operation in Months 23–34.
Result of the author's code. The open-source code of the project, github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast, is updated continuously; if the project is funded, its final stage is a three-dimensional open-source model.

PART 9

CV of the NATO-country Project Director

Assoc. Prof. Dr. Dulian Zeqiraj, Faculty of Geology and Mining, Polytechnic University of Tirana.

Dulian Zeqiraj

NATO-country Project Director · CERTAIN-COAST

1. Personal details

Item	Details
Name	Dulian Zeqiraj
Title and position	Associate Professor (Prof. Asoc.), PhD; Faculty of Geology and Mining (FGJM), Polytechnic University of Tirana
Department	Department of Energy Resources
Country	Albania (NATO member)
E-mail	dulian.zeqiraj@fgjm.edu.al
ORCID	https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5305-3048

2. Education

Year	Degree	Institution	Field
2017	Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)	Polytechnic University of Tirana, Albania	Numerical modelling and simulation of flow and geomechanics in petroleum reservoirs
1991–1996	Master of Science (five-year diploma)	Faculty of Geology and Mining, University of Tirana, Albania	Petroleum engineering (drilling and production wells)

3. Career

Years	Position	Institution
2024–	Associate Professor (Prof. Asoc.)	Faculty of Geology and Mining, Polytechnic University of Tirana
2008–	Lecturer, Department of Energy Resources	Faculty of Geology and Mining, Polytechnic University of Tirana
2006–2008	Staff member	Albanian Geological Survey (Shërbimi Gjeologjik Shqiptar), Tirana
1996–2006	Production wells and reservoirs	Albpetrol, the national oil company, Albania

4. Expertise relevant to CERTAIN-COAST

- **Seawater intrusion and monitoring design:** goal-oriented Bayesian design of monitoring networks and of managed-aquifer-recharge wells for variable-density seawater intrusion (Journal of Hydrology, 2026).
- **Inference and uncertainty in alluvial aquifers:** Bayesian porosity inference with dependent errors; groundwater vulnerability (DRASTIC) coupled with numerical transport models (2026).
- **Stochastic modelling of flow and transport:** coupled geomechanical, geochemical and flow models of fractured and karst media; fracture initiation and propagation under fluid injection (2021–2022).
- **Optimisation under uncertainty:** placement and rates of wells; scheduling of field projects.
- **Modelling software and field background:** C++, Python and MATLAB; ten years in oil production (Albpetrol) and two years at the Albanian Geological Survey.

5. Selected publications (peer-reviewed, with DOI)

First author of every publication listed below; all are published by Elsevier (the eight journal papers, and the two preprints on SSRN, an Elsevier service).

1. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2026). Goal-oriented Bayesian experimental design for variable-density seawater intrusion: Adjoint expected information gain for joint monitoring and managed-aquifer-recharge placement. Journal of Hydrology 680, 136559. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jhydrol.2026.136559
2. **Zeqiraj, D.**, Beqiraj, A. (2026). Adaptive stacked ensemble fusion: Bayesian porosity inference in alluvial aquifers when the errors are not independent. Journal of Contaminant Hydrology 283, 105086. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jconhyd.2026.105086

3. **Zeqiraj, D.**, Beqiraj, A., Jahja, A., Seitaj, B., Progni, F., Zeqo, E. (2026). Physical, biophysical, and chemical mechanisms of bidirectional coupling between DRASTIC vulnerability assessment and numerical transport modeling in heterogeneous aquifer systems. Journal of Hazardous Materials Advances 23, 101261. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.hazadv.2026.101261
4. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2022). Enhanced oil recovery (EOR) project scheduling with multiobjective of maximum net present value and minimum makespan. Results in Engineering 13, 100339. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rineng.2022.100339
5. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2022). 3D stochastic modeling of flow and solute transport in karst vadose zone. Case Studies in Chemical and Environmental Engineering 6, 100217. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cscee.2022.100217
6. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2022). Stochastic modeling of fracture initiation and propagation during fluid flow in carbonate reservoir. Results in Applied Mathematics 13, 100244. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rinam.2022.100244
7. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2022). Stochastic modeling of fluid flow in the simulation and quantification of fracture initiation and propagation in the oil carbonate reservoirs during water injection. Results in Control and Optimization 7, 100131. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rico.2022.100131
8. **Zeqiraj, D.** (2021). Fully coupled stochastic geomechanical - geochemical - reservoir modeling for fracture reservoirs. Results in Engineering 11, 100242. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rineng.2021.100242

Manuscripts under review and preprints

- **Zeqiraj, D.** (2026). Physics-informed deep learning for joint hydraulic conductivity–porosity mapping with Wasserstein optimal experimental design in alluvial aquifers. Under review at the Journal of Hydrology; preprint on SSRN. https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7528503
- **Zeqiraj, D.**, Beqiraj, A. (2026). Class probabilities for groundwater nitrate vulnerability maps: hierarchical Bayesian calibration of DRASTIC against monitoring data, and the value of new stations. Preprint on SSRN. https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7511860

6. Projects and grants

Years	Project	Funder	Role
2025–2026	Modelling, simulation and optimisation of formation treatment methods to maximise the net profit of the massive carbonate reservoir of the Amonicë oil field (with Albpetrol Sh.A.)	National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (AKKSHI), Albania	Principal investigator
	Reconstruction of the groundwater vulnerability map of Albania	Polytechnic University of Tirana (institutional research project)	Co-investigator

Other NATO SPS grants currently held: None

7. Work with end-users and in the field

• Albanian Geological Survey (SHGJSH): staff member, 2006–2008.

• Albpetrol, the national oil company: production wells and reservoirs, 1996–2006; since 2025 partner of his AKKSHI project, with field data, well records and the validation of a 3D reservoir model (MATLAB-MRST).

• Preparatory work for CERTAIN-COAST (2026): reviews with numerical tests and a calibrated chloride model of the Fushë-Kuqe aquifer, which supplies Durrës.

8. Teaching and supervision

• Master courses: Reservoir Engineering (well stimulation and enhanced oil recovery); Energy Resources (fossil and renewable); Physics of Energy Resources.

9. Role in CERTAIN-COAST

As NATO-country Project Director, coordinates CERTAIN-COAST and is accountable for the SPS funds (WP7). **He builds the mathematical model of the project himself, the coupled model (WP2) and the certified alarms (WP3), and does all the programming**, released as open-source code in MATLAB (github.com/dulianzeqiraj/certain-coast). He leads the monitoring network designed for the warnings (WP4) and the live demonstration with the Institute of Geosciences (IGJEO), the end-user (WP5), and contributes to the measurement of coastal motion and relative sea level (WP1). Chairs the steering committee, signs the access agreements for the wells (T7.2, Month 3) and oversees the hand-over to IGJEO at Month 36.

10. Other

• Languages: Albanian (native); English (professional working proficiency)

• Programming: C++, Python, MATLAB

• Conference talks: 4th International Conference on Applied Sciences, Munich, 2021 (three); 3rd International Conference on Advanced Research in Applied Science and Engineering, Oxford (two).

PART 10

CV of the partner-country Project Director

Prof. Jassim Al-Khayat, Environmental Science Center, Qatar University.

Jassim Al-Khayat

Partner-country Project Director · CERTAIN-COAST

1. Personal details

Item	Details
Name	Prof. Jassim Abdulla Al-Khayat
Title and position	Research Professor and Manager of the research vessel Janan
Institution	Environmental Science Center, Qatar University, Doha
Country	Qatar (NATO partner country, Istanbul Cooperation Initiative)
Nationality	Qatari

2. Education

Year	Degree	Institution	Field
1993–1996	PhD, Marine Biology	University of Wales, United Kingdom	Marine biology
1991–1992	MSc, Marine Biology and Fisheries	University of Aberdeen, United Kingdom	Marine biology and fisheries
1979–1983	BSc, Marine Science / Geology	Qatar University	Marine science and geology

3. Career

Years	Position	Institution
2021–	Research Professor and Manager of the research vessel Janan	Environmental Science Center, Qatar University
2007–2021	Associate Professor and Coordinator of the Marine Sciences Program; Research Associate Professor	Qatar University
1996–2007	Assistant Professor, then Associate Professor and Head of the Marine Sciences Department	Qatar University

4. Expertise relevant to CERTAIN-COAST

- **Coastal and marine ecology:** mangroves, intertidal habitats, marine biodiversity and benthic communities; mangrove loss, restoration and adaptation to climate change.
- **Coastal sediments and carbon:** carbon storage and cycling in the sabkhas and mudflats of Qatar; microbial processes in carbonate mineral formation; carbon mineralisation in sabkhas.
- **Coastal pollution and monitoring:** oil residues, metals in mangrove sediments, microplastics in beach sediments; satellite-based assessment of suspended sediments and shorelines.
- **Field research and leadership:** head of the Marine Sciences Department, coordinator of the marine science programmes and manager of the research vessel Janan.

5. Selected publications (peer-reviewed, with DOI)

1. Haseeba, K. P., Vethamony, P., Veerasingam, S., Aboobacker, V. M., **Al-Khayat, J. A.** (2025). A comprehensive review of oil residues in the world oceans: types, characteristics, sources and distribution. Marine Pollution Bulletin 217, 118106. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marpolbul.2025.118106
2. Backer, S. A., Sankaran, R., Maruthavanan, R., **Al-Khayat, J.**, Vethamony, P., et al. (2026). The shoreline shifts: a comprehensive review of change analysis focusing Arabian Gulf within global context. Regional Studies in Marine Science 102, 105433. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rsma.2026.105433
3. Ibrahim, S. B. M., Sankaran, R., Backer, S. J., Al Absi, R., Mohammed, A. V., **Al-Khayat, J. A.**, et al. (2026). Evaluation of mangrove ecosystem dynamics in the arid environment: for restoration on the Qatar coast using satellite data and hyperspectral imaging. Marine Pollution Bulletin 231, 119961. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.marpolbul.2026.119961
4. Backer, S. J., Sankaran, R., **Al-Khayat, J. A.**, Vethamony, P., Rahman, M. M., Aravinth, J. (2026). Multi-decadal Landsat monitoring of shoreline dynamics in an enclosed arid gulf: comparison of 3-year and 10-year sampling

designs. IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Applied Earth Observations and Remote Sensing. https://doi.org/10.1109/JSTARS.2026.3747055

5. **Al-Khayat, J.**, Veerasingam, S., Aboobacker, V. M., Vethamony, P. (2021). Hitchhiking of encrusting organisms on floating marine debris along the west coast of Qatar, Arabian/Persian Gulf. Science of the Total Environment 776, 145985. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2021.145985
6. **Al-Khayat, J. A.**, Vethamony, P., Nanajkar, M. (2021). Molluscan diversity influenced by mangrove habitat in the Khors of Qatar. Wetlands 41, 45. https://doi.org/10.1007/s13157-021-01441-6

6. Projects and grants

• Leads a five-year mangrove restoration project that assesses its environmental and socio-economic benefits.

• Has led a project on carbon mineralisation in sabkhas (microbial mats, minerals and carbon sequestration).

• Has led marine turtle conservation and monitoring programmes, and collaborative research with international institutions.

Other NATO SPS grants currently held: None

7. Work with end-users and in the field

• Manager of the research vessel Janan of Qatar University: field campaigns, research teams and institutional collaboration.

• Environmental monitoring, conservation and habitat restoration on the coasts of Qatar.

8. Teaching and supervision

• Head of the Marine Sciences Department (to 2007) and Coordinator of the Marine Sciences Program (2007–2021), Qatar University.

9. Role in CERTAIN-COAST

As partner-country Project Director, leads training, transfer and dissemination (WP6) for the team of the Environmental Science Center of Qatar University: the transfer study on the east coast of Qatar (selection and characterisation of the site, local environmental knowledge and public data, and the interpretation of the outputs with the Tirana team), the two-month exchanges of early-career researchers to the Durrës coast, a regional workshop, and a user-side review of the bulletins and operating procedures.

10. Other

• Honours: Outstanding Teaching Award, Qatar University (2015); National Incentive Award for Research, Qatar (2026).